

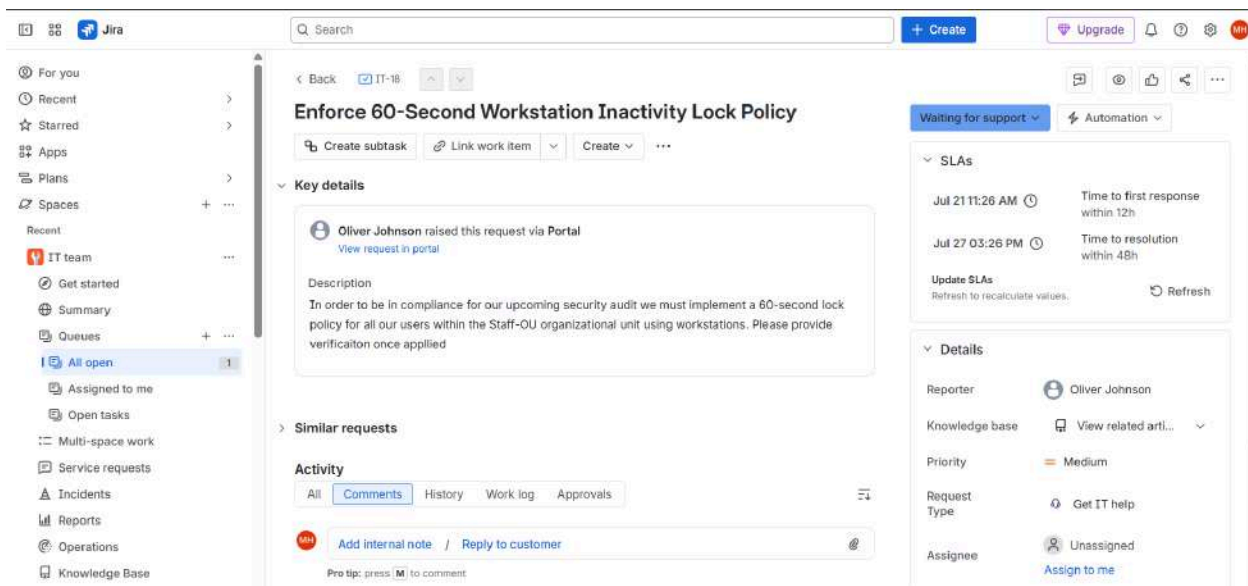
Project 3: Active Directory Group Policy Management

Tickets:

- GPO-001: Create Workstation Lock Policy
- GPO-002: Configure Password Complexity Policy
- GPO-003: Deploy Desktop Wallpaper Policy
- GPO-004: Restrict Control Panel Access

Create Workstation Lock Policy

Looks like I've received a ticket requesting a work station lock policy for the users within the Staff-OU.



I will respond to the requester and assign the ticket to myself and change the ticket status to in progress.

In Progress ▾

⚡ Automation ▾

▾ SLAs

Jul 21 11:26 AM ⌚

Time to first response within 12h

Jul 27 03:26 PM ⌚

Time to resolution within 48h

Update SLAs

Refresh to recalculate values.

↻ Refresh

▾ Details

Reporter

👤

Oliver Johnson

Knowledge base

📖

View related arti... ▾

Priority

==

Medium

Request Type

🎧

Get IT help

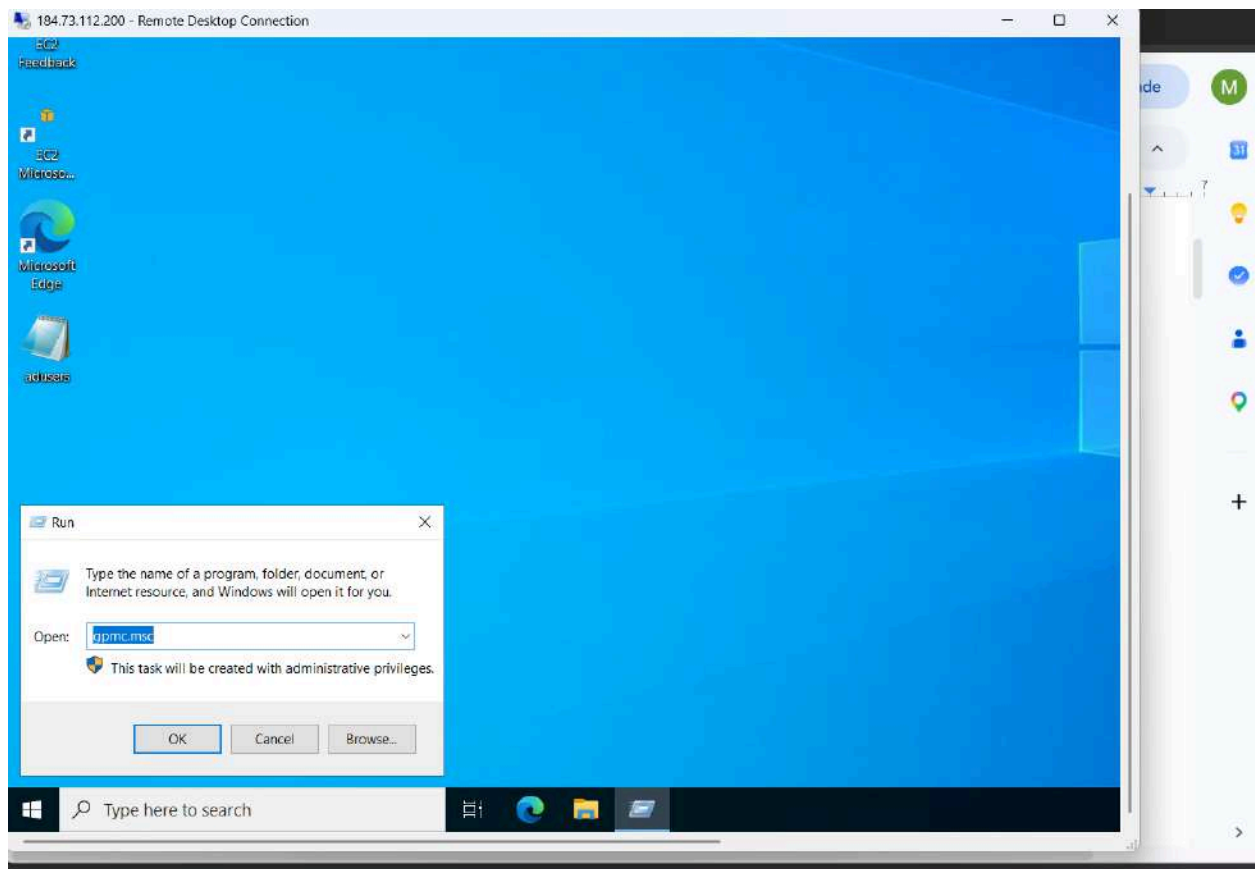
Assignee

🔴 MH

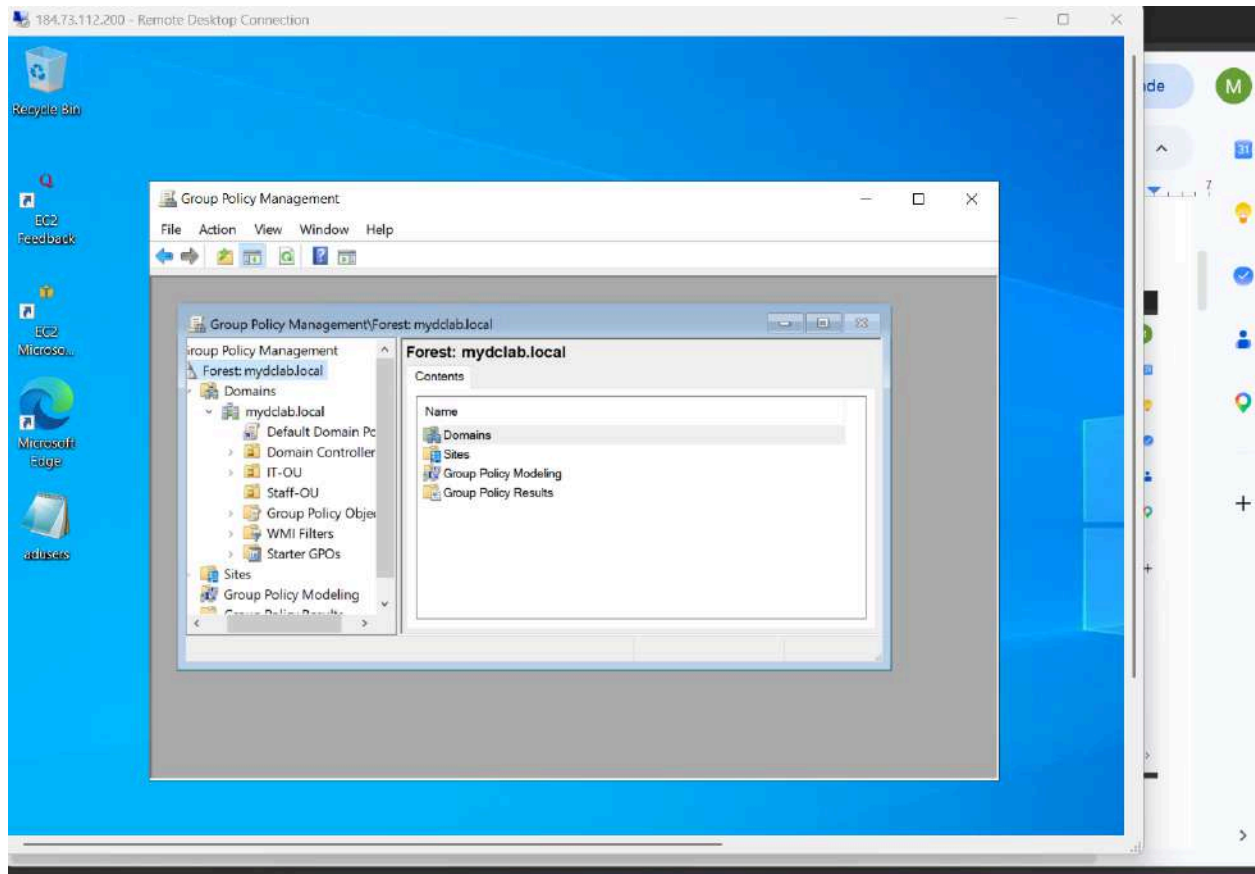
Mo H

Manual Method

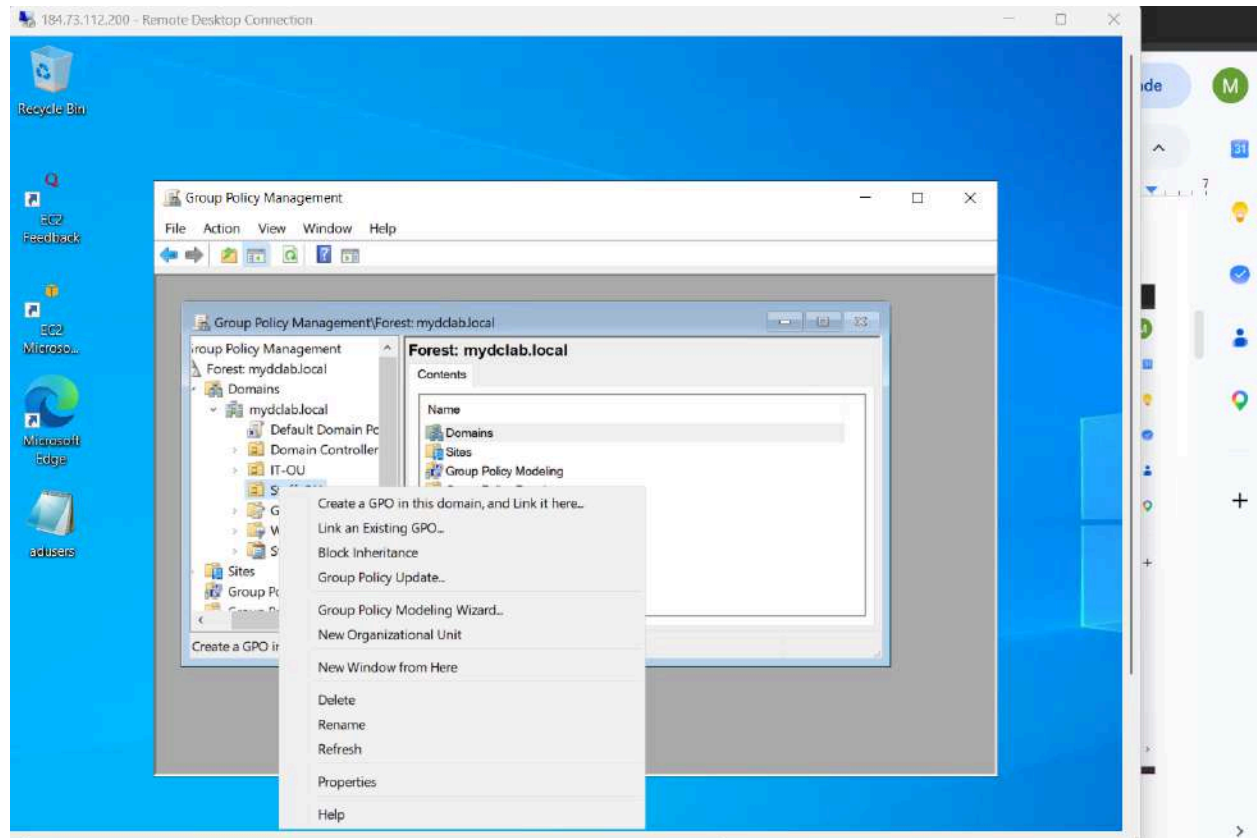
First thing I do is run gpmmc.msc which is the group policy management tool.



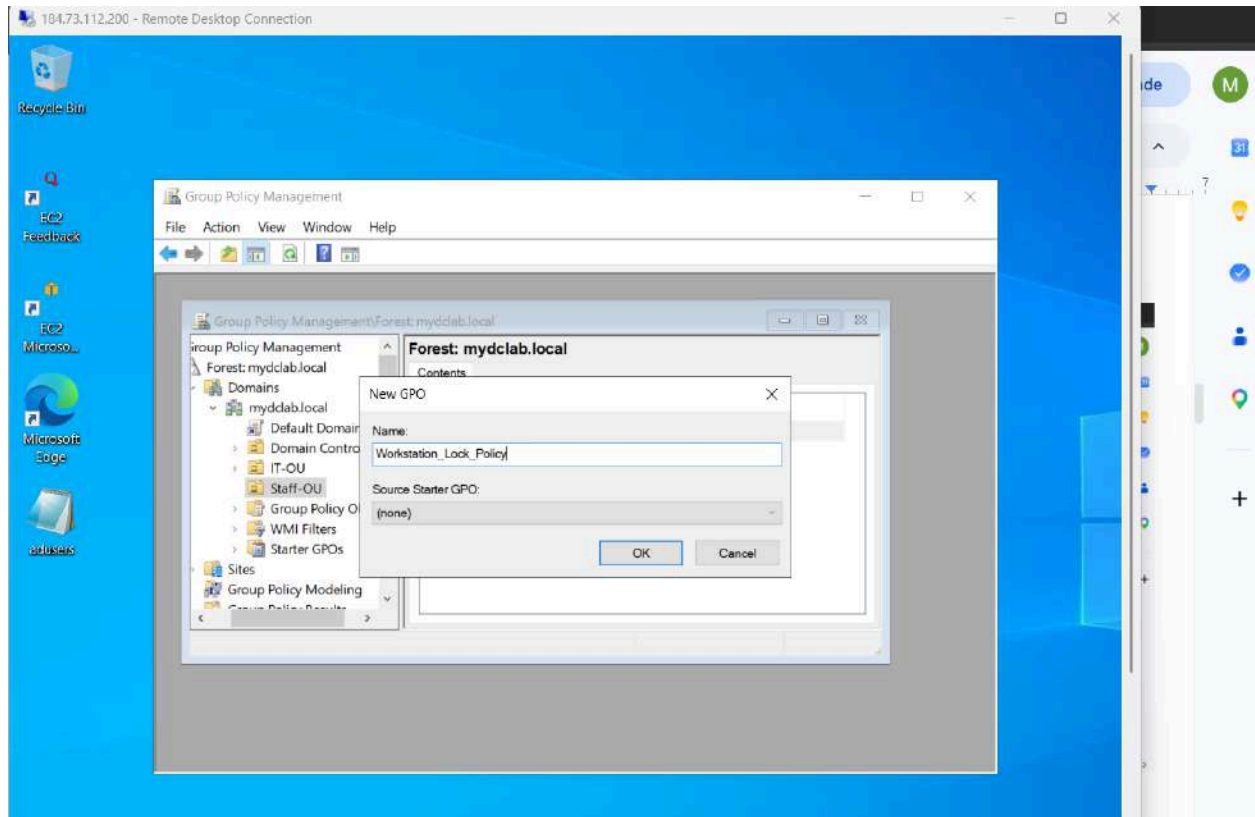
I expand the tree on the left from **Forest:mydclab.local** > **Domains** > **mydclab.local** to reveal **Staff-OU**.



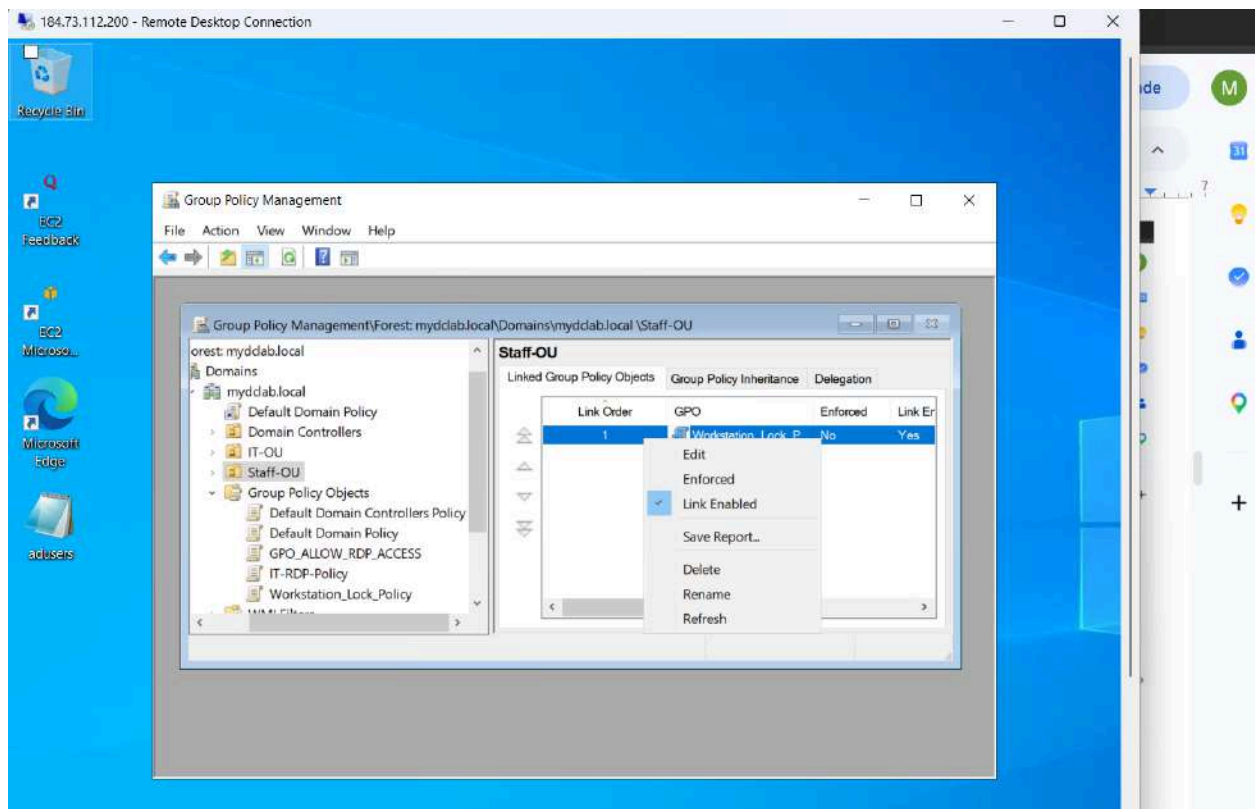
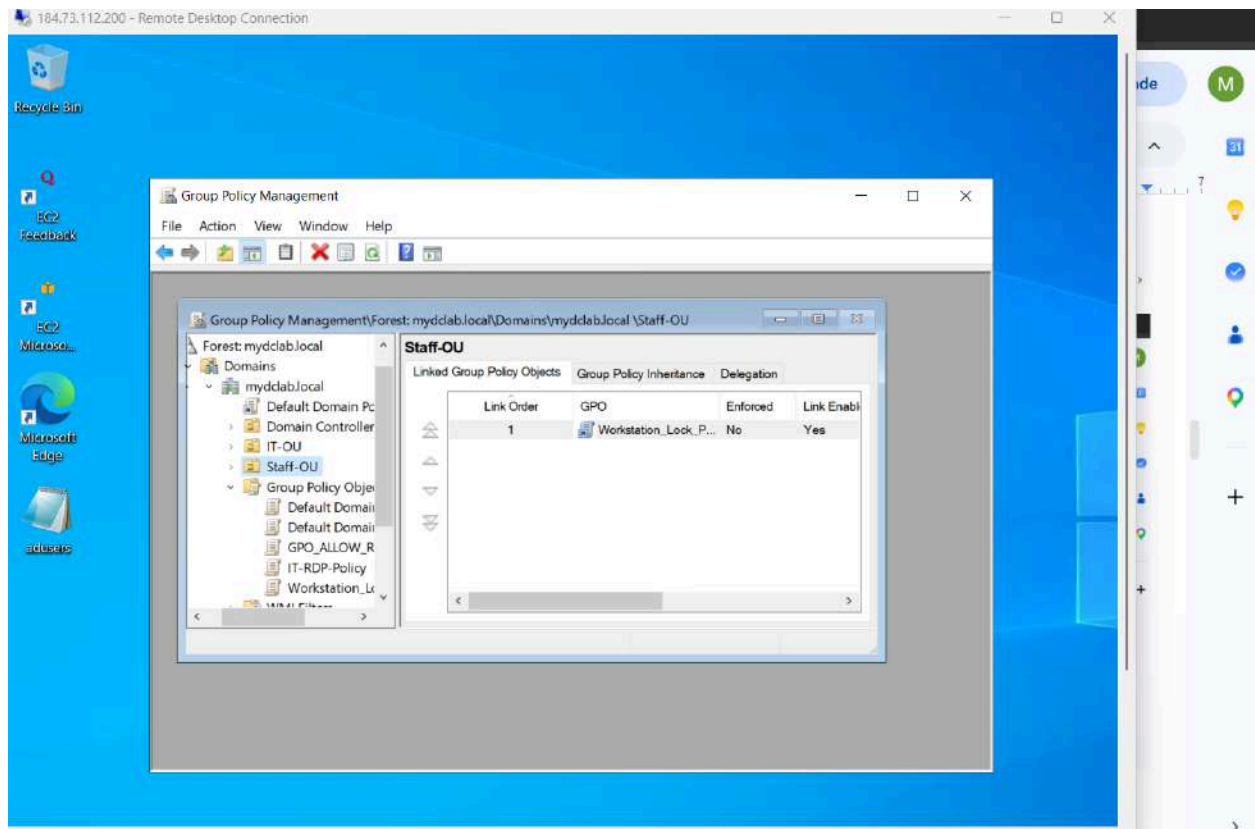
I right click **Staff-OU** and select **Create a GPO in this domain, and Link it here**.



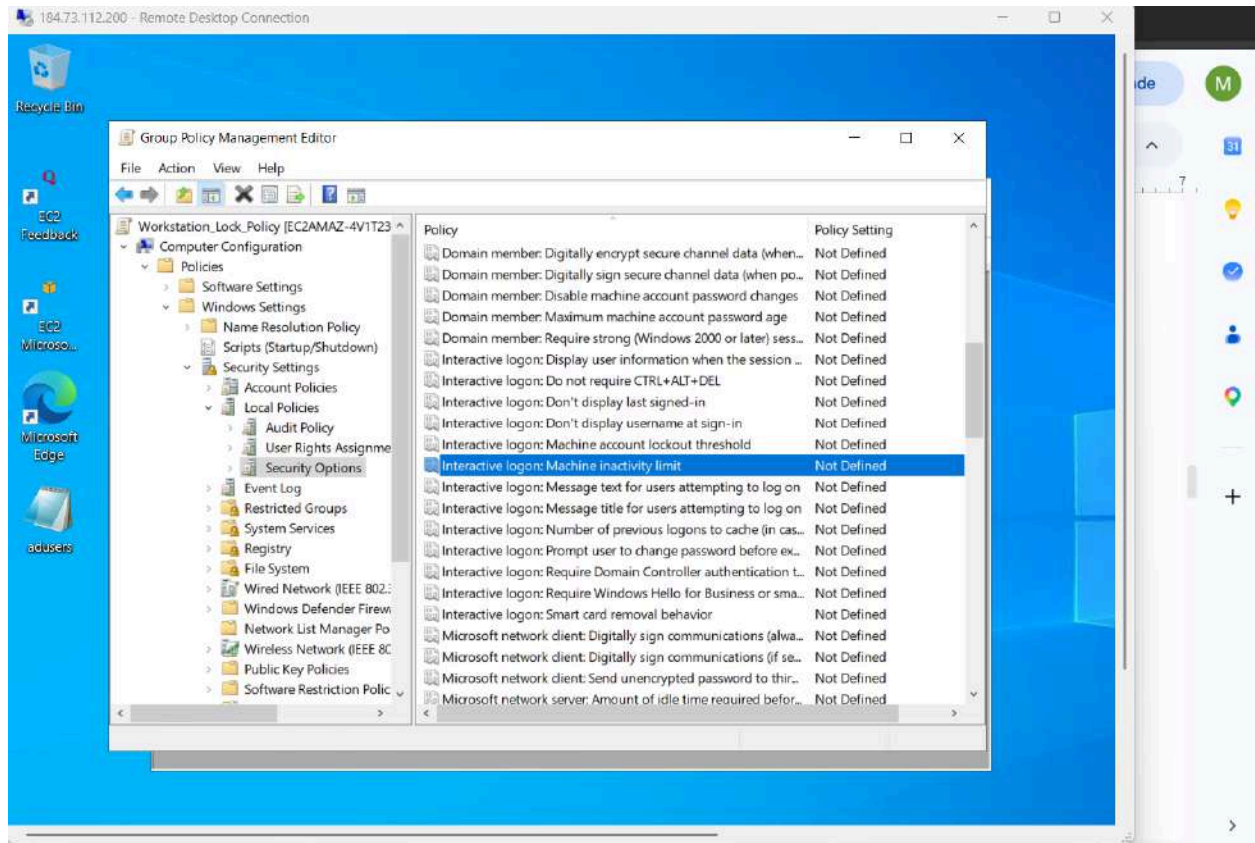
I name the group policy object Workstation_Lock_Policy and then hit **OK**.



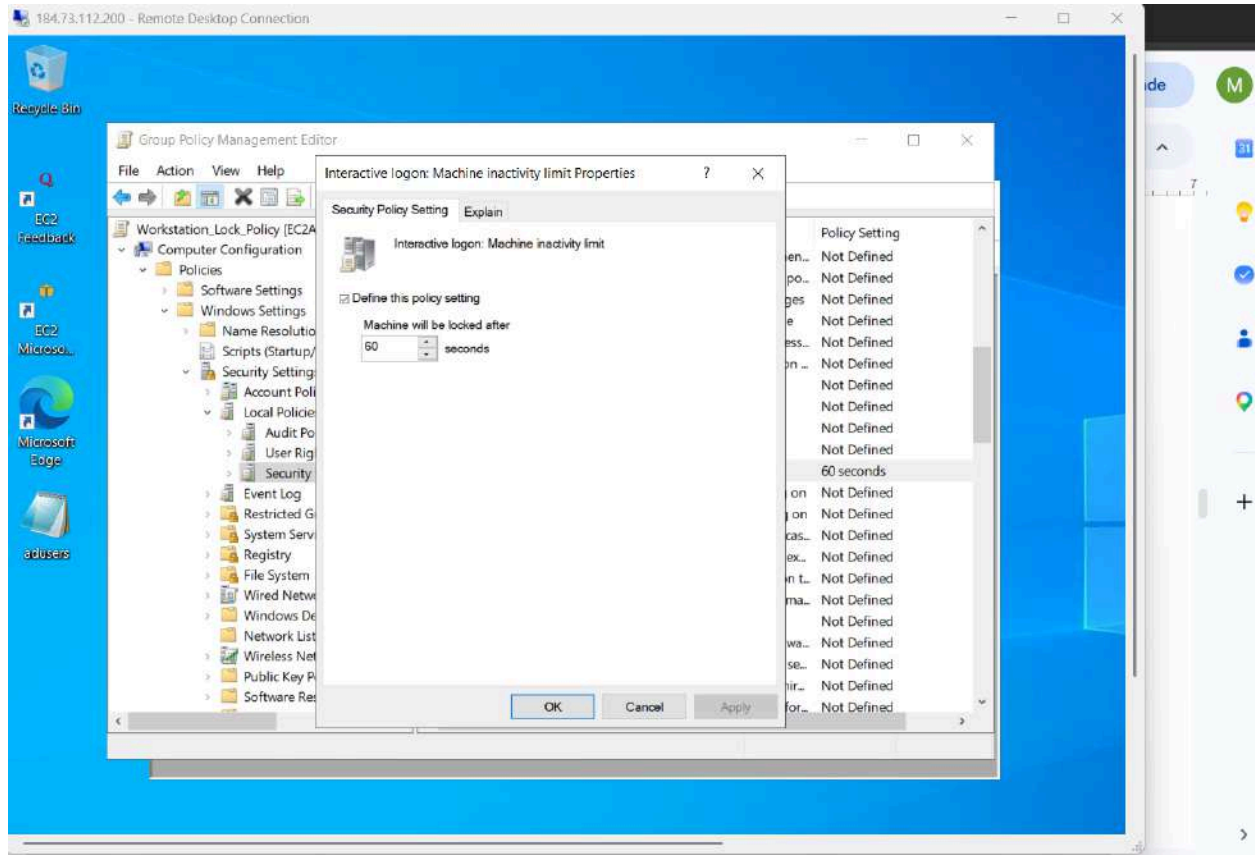
As you can see the group policy object has been made and linked to Staff-OU, I will now right click on it and click **Edit** to open the Group Policy Management Editor.



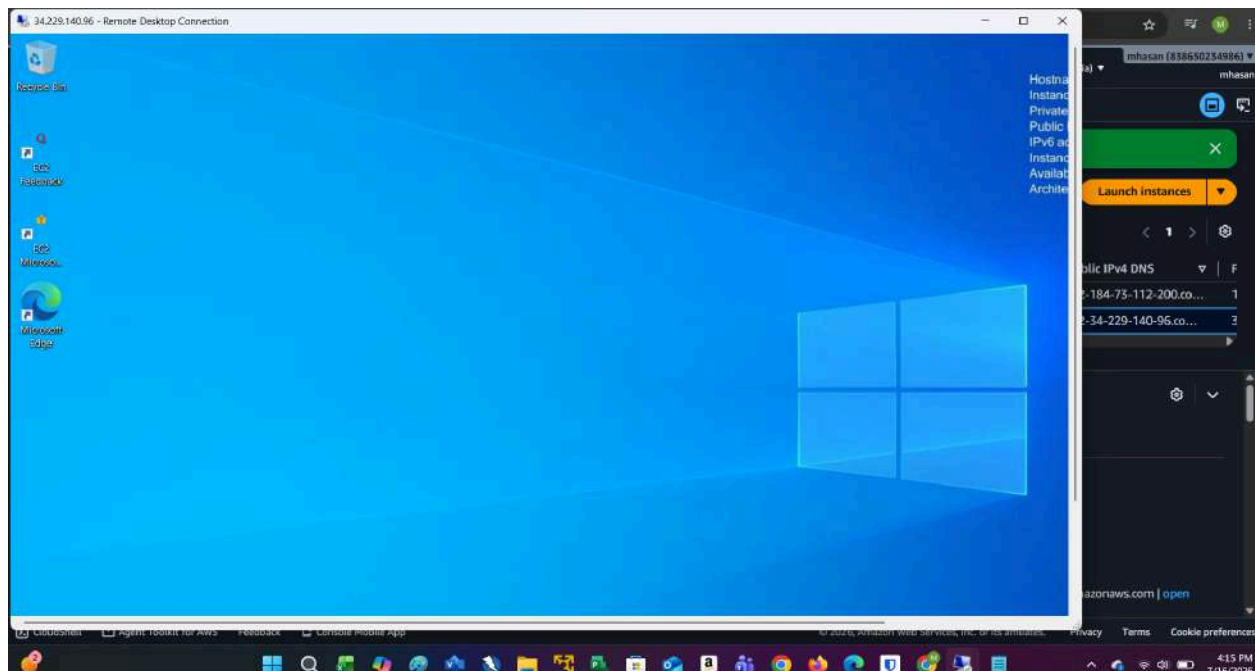
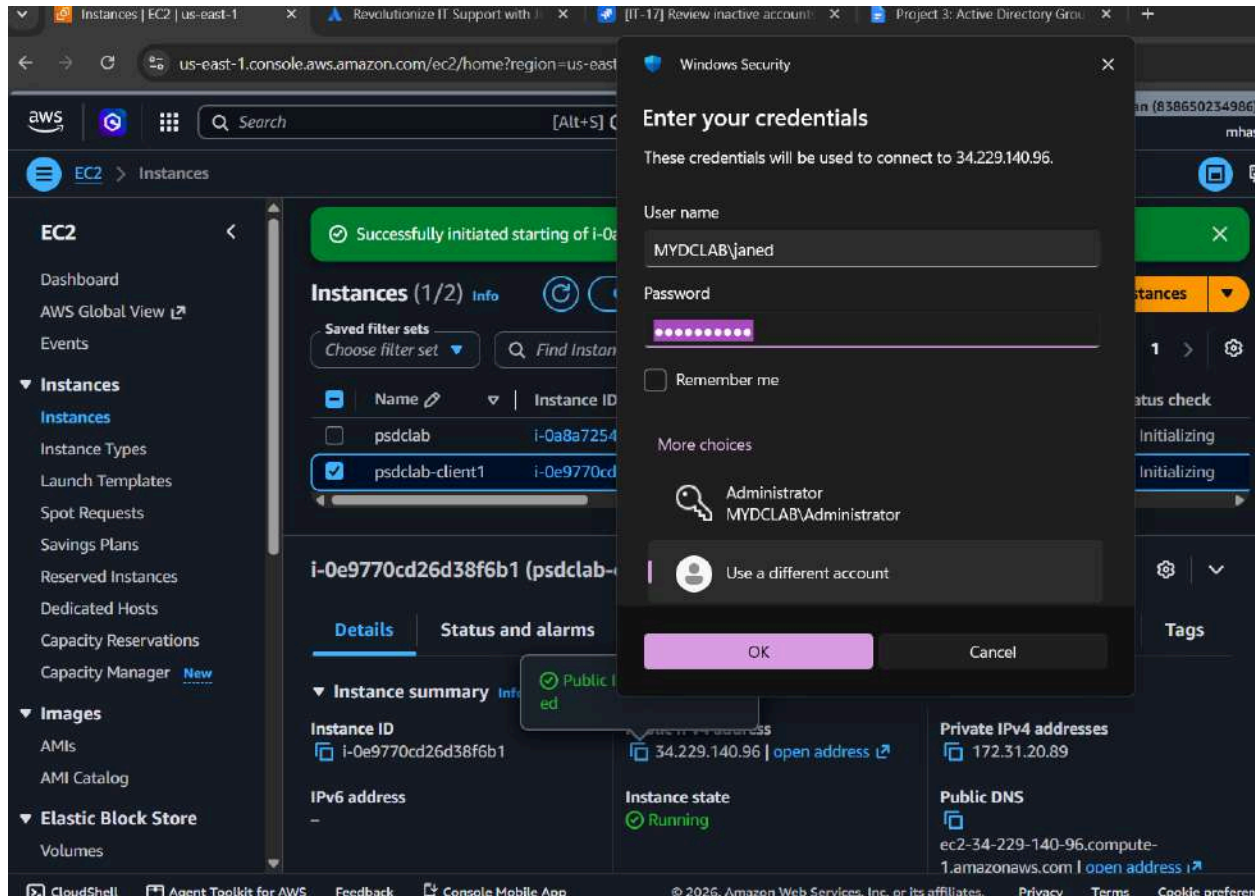
Once that opens, I go to the following directories in the left pane: **Computer Configurations > Policies > Windows Settings > Security Settings > Local Policies > Security Options** and then I will scroll in the center till I can find and **select Interactive Logon: Machine Inactivity limit**.

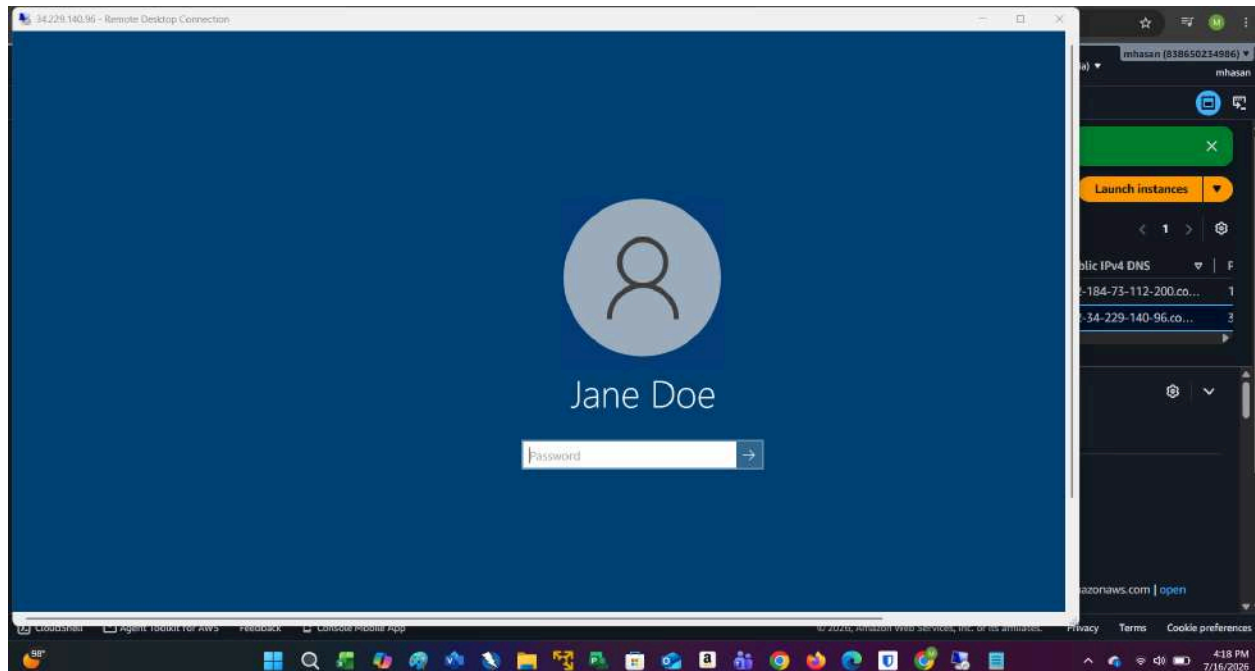


I select **Define this policy setting** and then set it to 60 seconds, I then press **Apply** then **OK**, successfully defining the policy.



I will now login into the client machine as Jane Doe and wait 60 seconds to show proof that the policy is working. (**The time displayed in the bottom right corner in both pictures show 4:15 and 4:18, a difference of 3 mins. It is actually one minute but the time increased due to accidental movement of the mouse and other activity resetting the timer.**)





PowerShell Method

I go to my domain controller instance and run powershell as administrator and run these commands:

\$gpoName = "Workstation_Lock_Policy"

\$gpo = New-GPO -Name \$gpoName # this will not get reused in the rest of the script but it was created so the output of the New-GPO -Name doesn't populate the screen making things messy

\$targetOU = "OU=Staff-OU,DC=mydclab,DC=local"

New-GPLink

-Name

\$gpoName

-Target \$targetOU

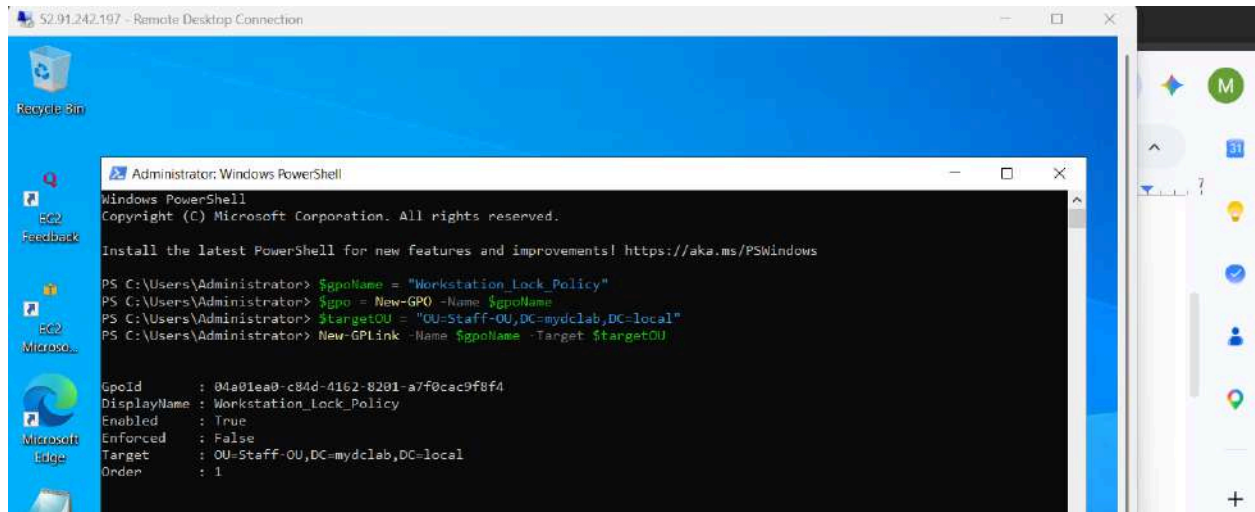
Set-GPRegistryValue -Name "Workstation_Lock_Policy" `

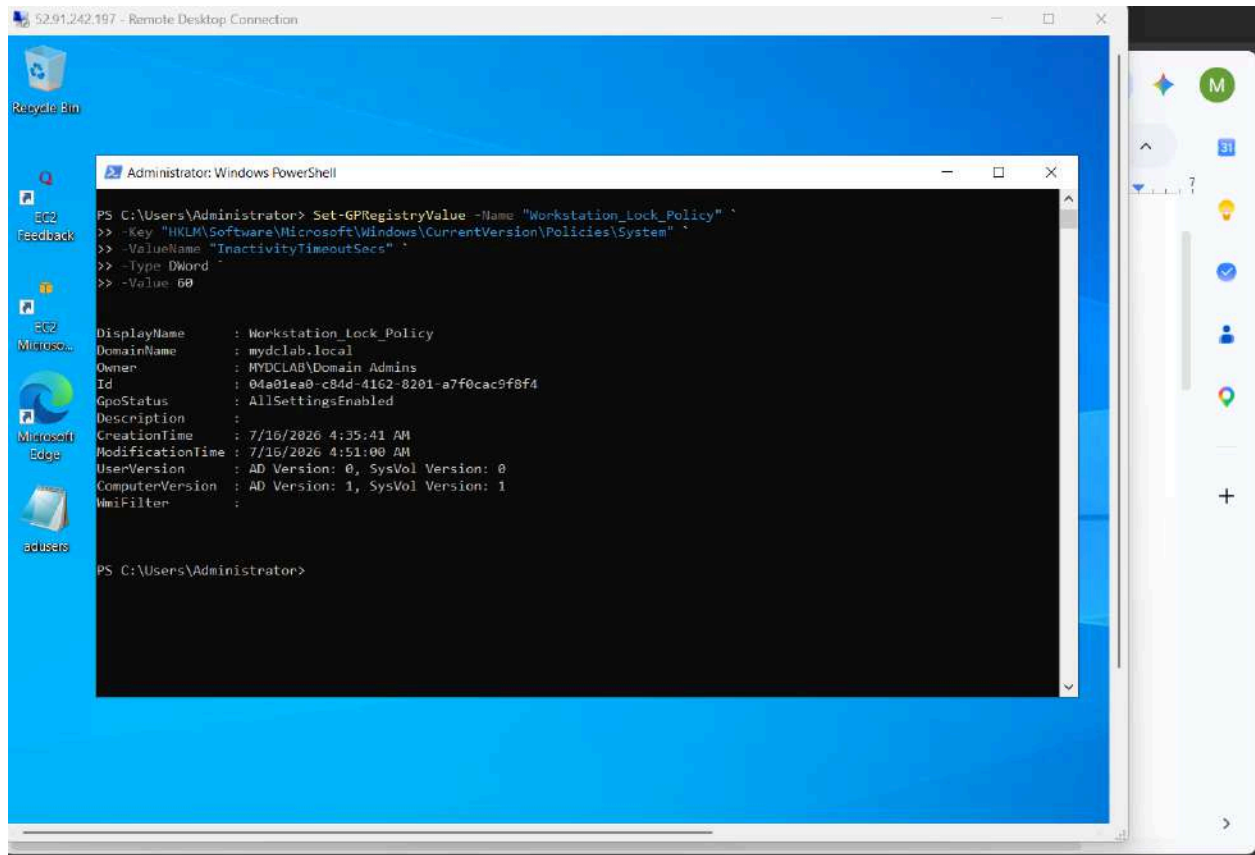
-Key "HKLM\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System" `

-ValueName "InactivityTimeoutSecs" `

-Type DWord `

-Value 60

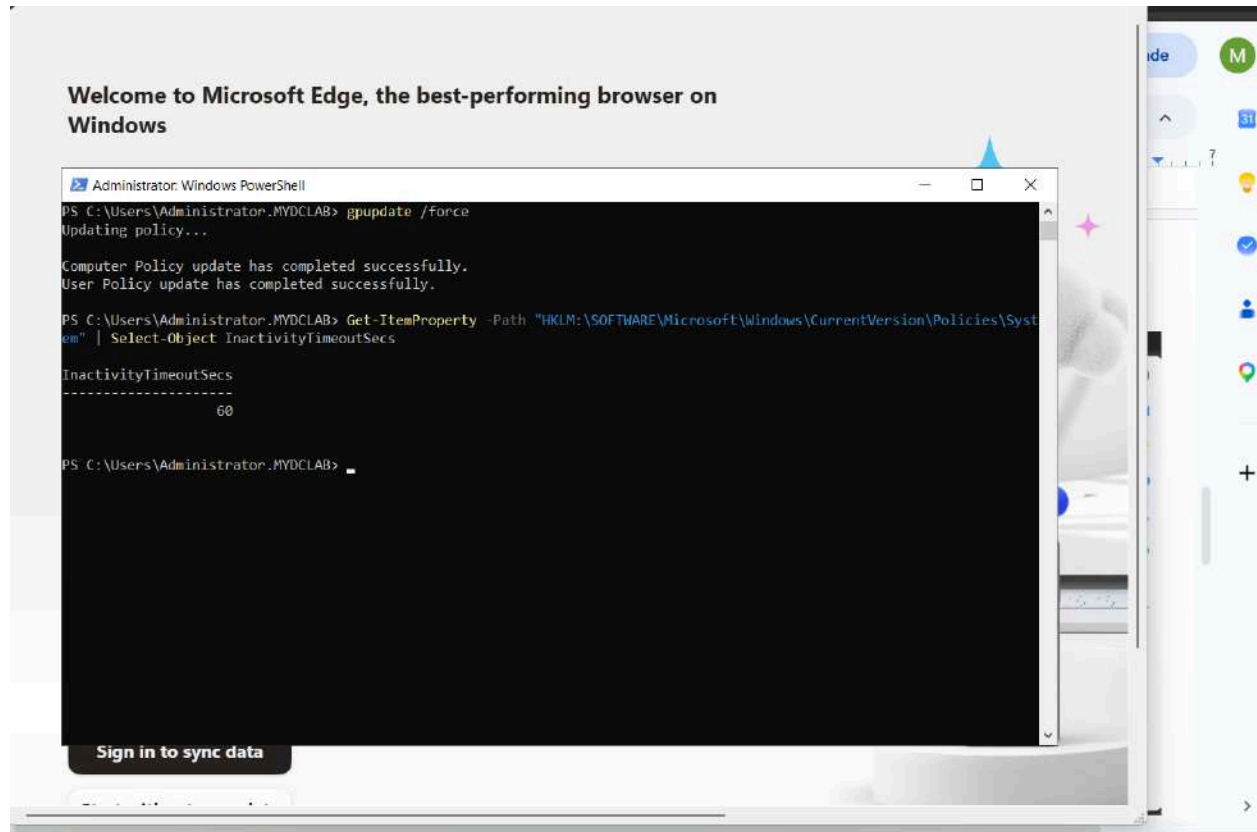




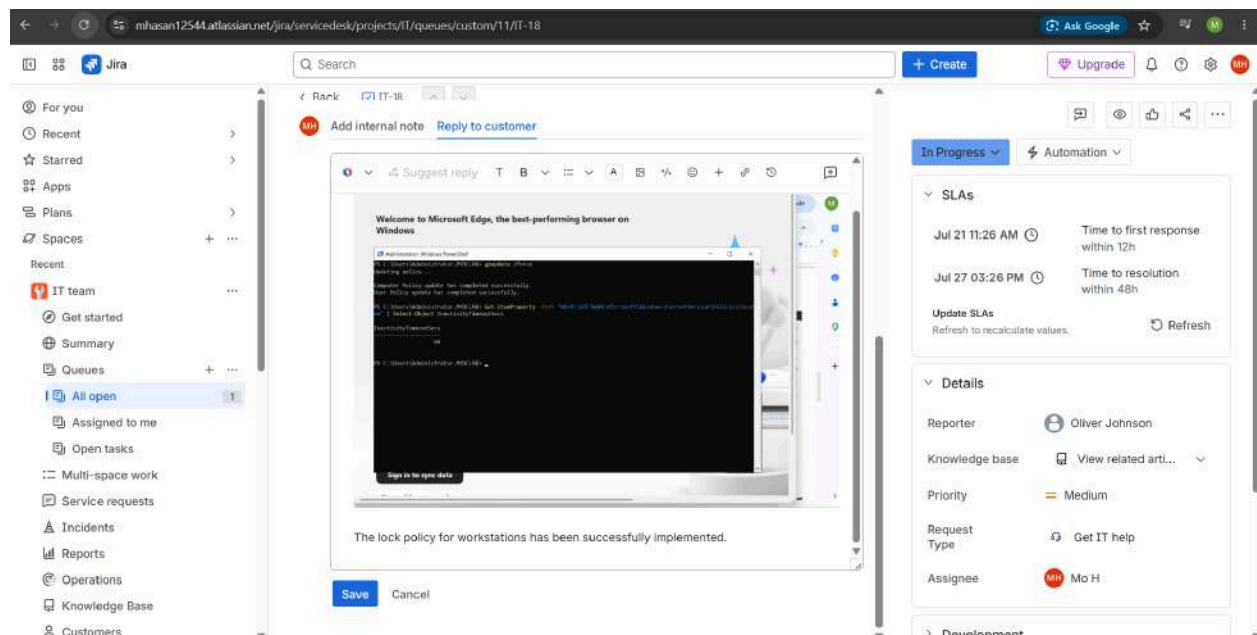
For proof I login to the client machine as administrator and use my privileges to run **gpupdate /force** so the client instance can get the latest policies from the domain controller and then I run this command:

Get-ItemProperty -Path

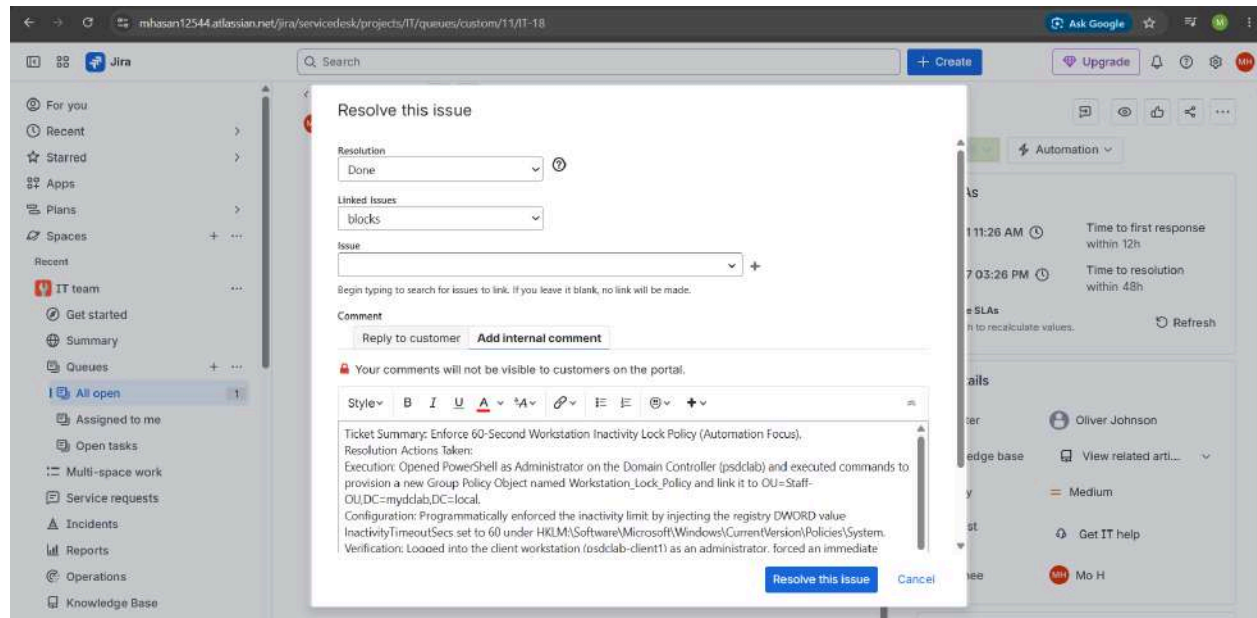
"HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System" | Select-Object InactivityTimeoutSecs



Next thing I do is provide evidence to the requester that the workstation lock policy is in place, I decide to use the proof I've gathered from the powershell method.



I then change the status of the ticket to resolved and I provide a resolution summary to the internal team.



I finally close the ticket.

+ Create

 Upgrade



 1



Closed 

✓ Done

⚡ Automation 

▼ SLAs

Jul 21 11:26 AM 

Time to first response
within 12h

Jul 27 03:26 PM 

Time to resolution
within 48h

Update SLAs

Refresh to recalculate values.

 Refresh

▼ Details

Reporter



Oliver Johnson

Knowledge base



View related arti...



Priority



Medium

Request
Type



Get IT help

Assignee



Mo H

> Development

Ticket Resolution Summaries Powershell and Manual(GUI) Methods:

PowerShell Method Resolution Summary

Ticket Summary: Enforce 60-Second Workstation Inactivity Lock Policy (Automation Focus).

Resolution Actions Taken:

- **Execution:** Opened PowerShell as Administrator on the Domain Controller (psdclab) and executed commands to provision a new Group Policy Object named `Workstation_Lock_Policy` and link it to `OU=Staff-OU, DC=mydclab, DC=local`.
 - **Configuration:** Programmatically enforced the inactivity limit by injecting the registry DWORD value `InactivityTimeoutSecs` set to 60 under `HKLM:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System`.
 - **Verification:** Logged into the client workstation (psdclab-client1) as an administrator, forced an immediate policy update via `gpupdate /force`, and ran a registry query to validate that the key successfully updated to 60.
-

Manual (GUI) Method Resolution Summary

Ticket Summary: Enforce 60-Second Workstation Inactivity Lock Policy (GUI Focus).

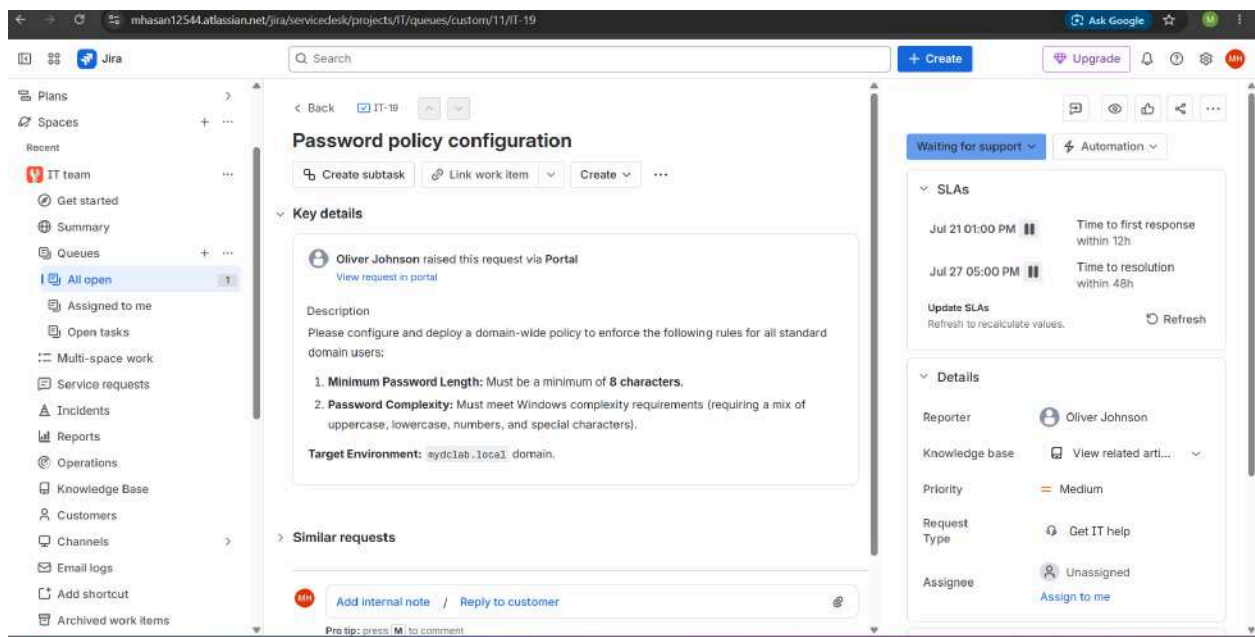
Resolution Actions Taken:

- **Console Navigation:** Launched the **Group Policy Management Console** (`gpmc.msc`) on the Domain Controller.
- **Policy Creation:** Right-clicked the target container (Staff-OU), initialized the new GPO wizard, and created/linked `Workstation_Lock_Policy`.
- **Configuration:** Edited the GPO and navigated to *Computer Configuration* → *Policies* → *Windows Settings* → *Security Settings* → *Local Policies* → *Security Options*. Located **Interactive logon: Machine inactivity limit**, enabled the definition checkbox, and assigned a threshold value of 60 seconds.

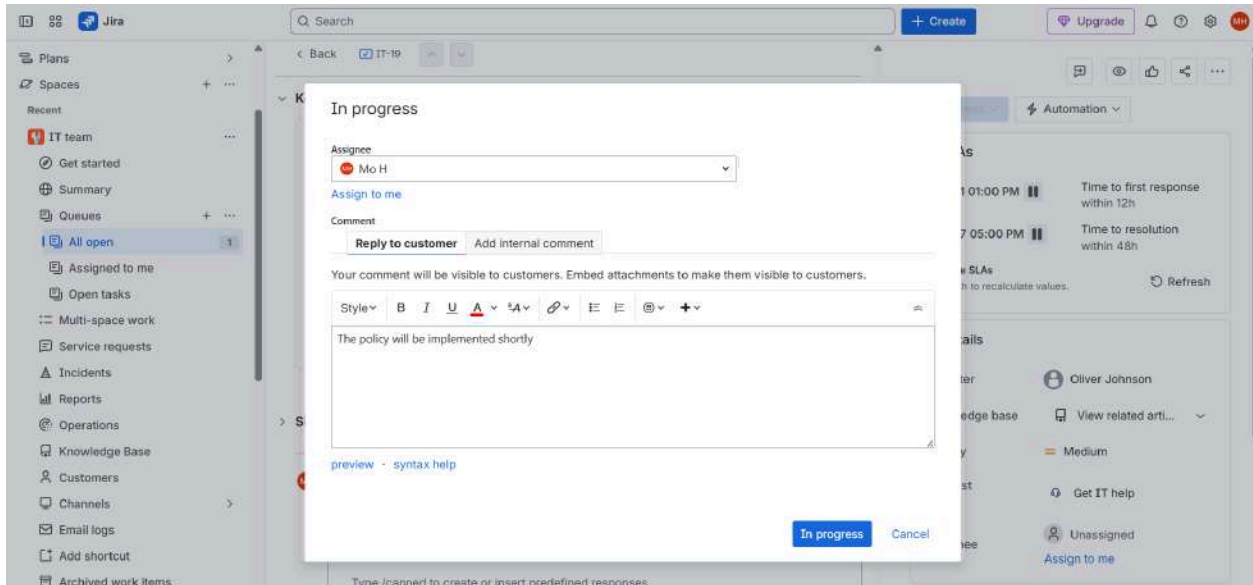
- **Verification:** Switched to the client machine, triggered gpupdate /force in an elevated command window, and confirmed that the workstation locked automatically after 60 seconds of complete user inactivity.

Configure Password Complexity Policy

It looks like I've received a request to implement a policy that enforces password complexity.

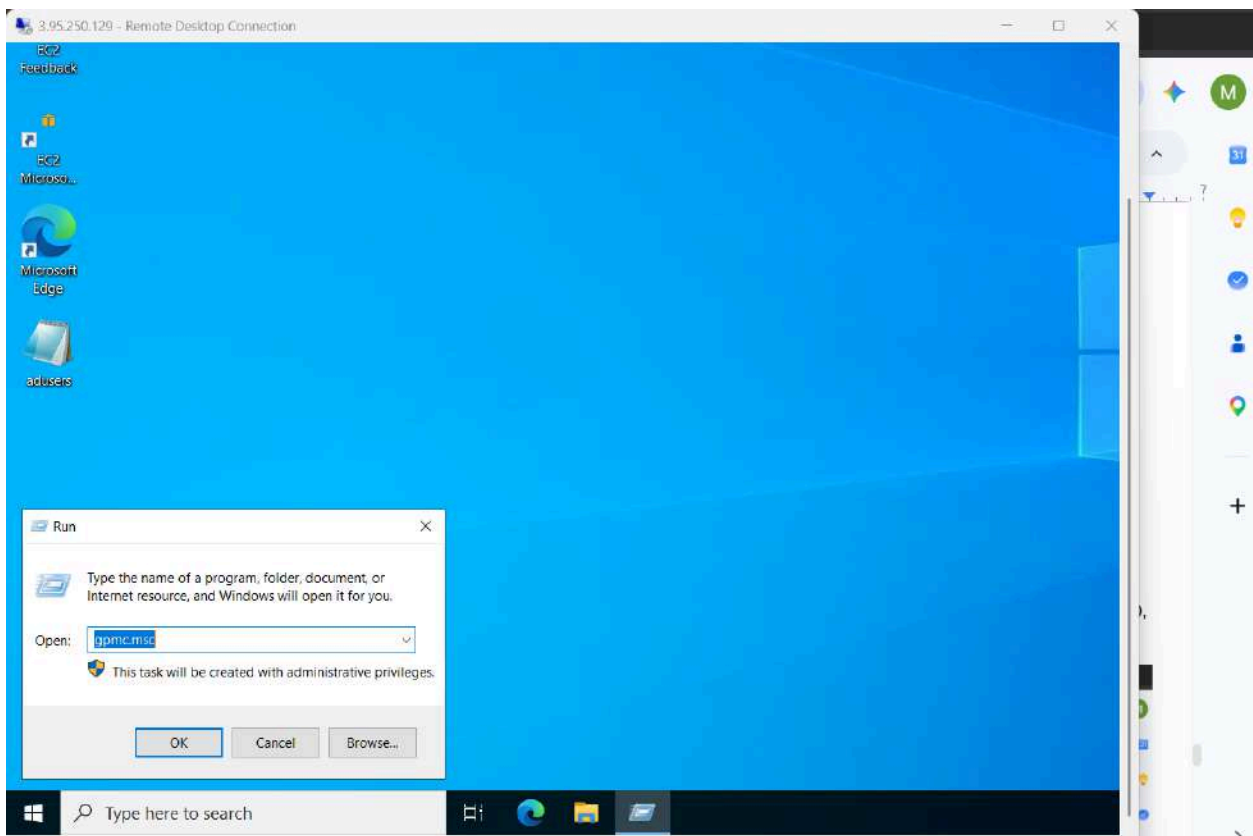


I assign the ticket to myself, respond to the requester, and change the status of the ticket to in progress.

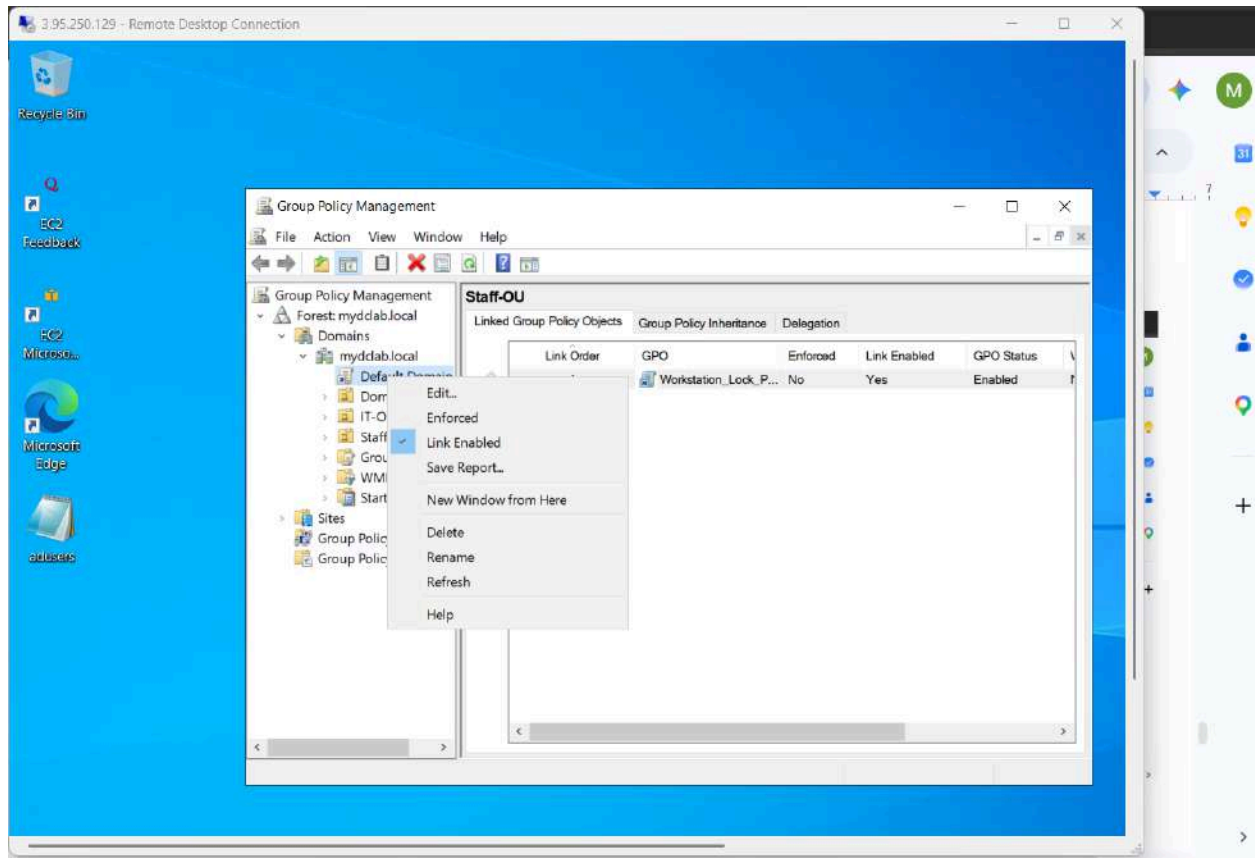


Manual Method

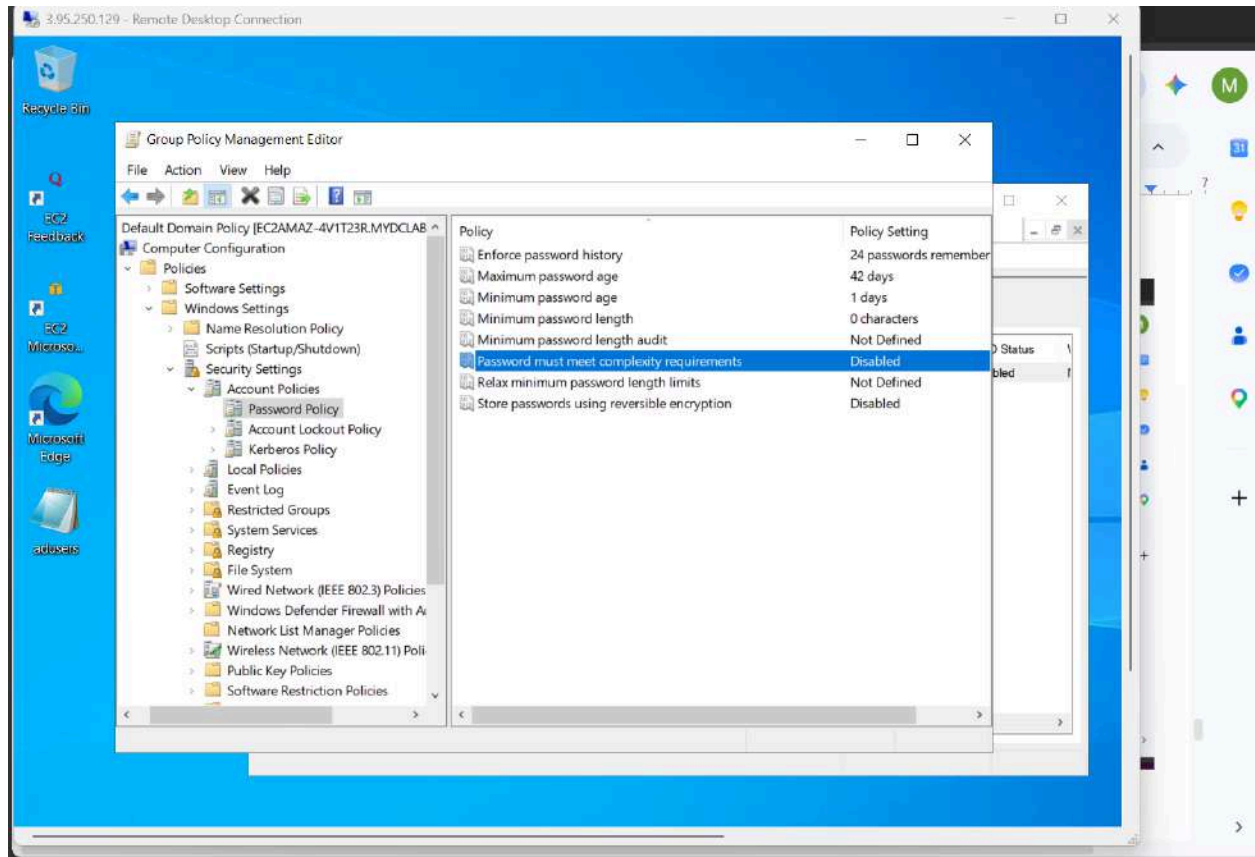
First I run gpmmc.msc.

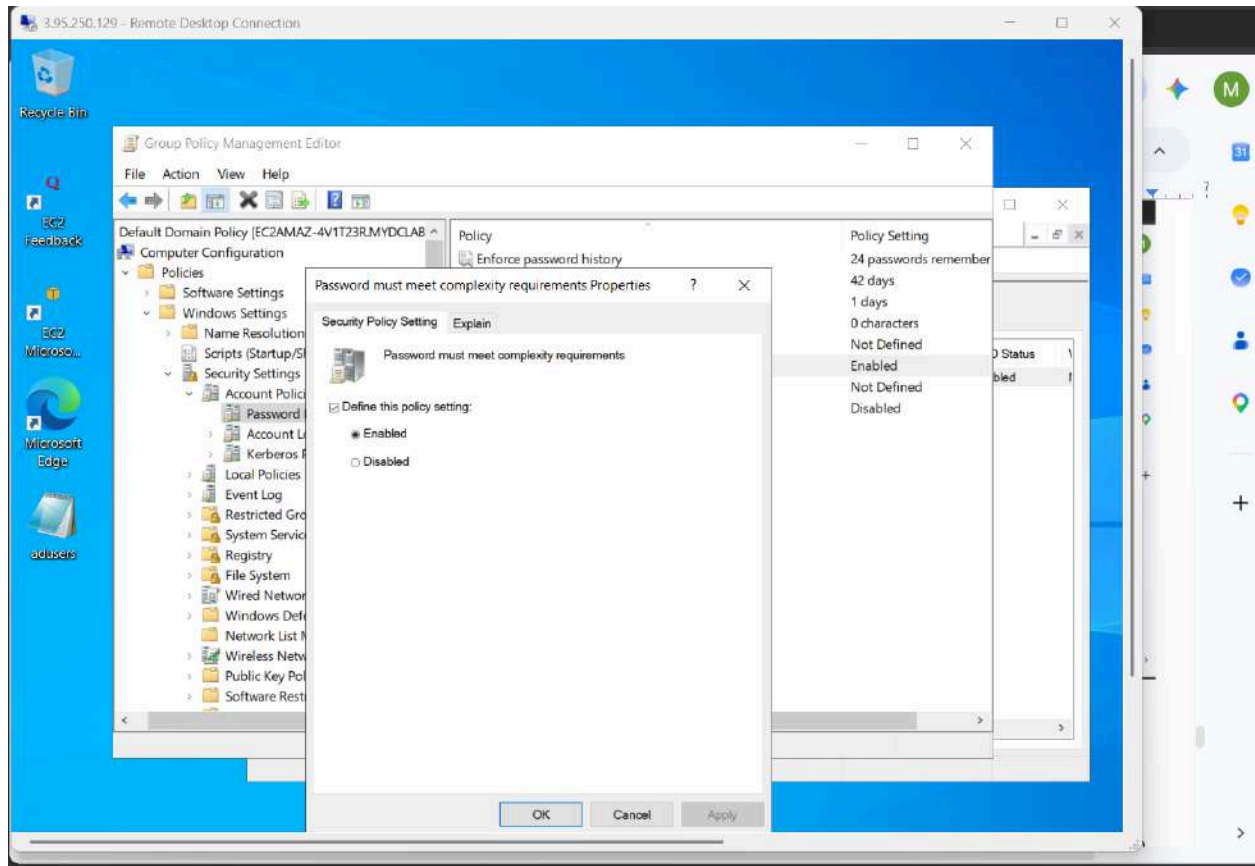


I identify my domain name **mydclab.local** in the panel on the left, and then I right click **default domain policy** and select **Edit**.

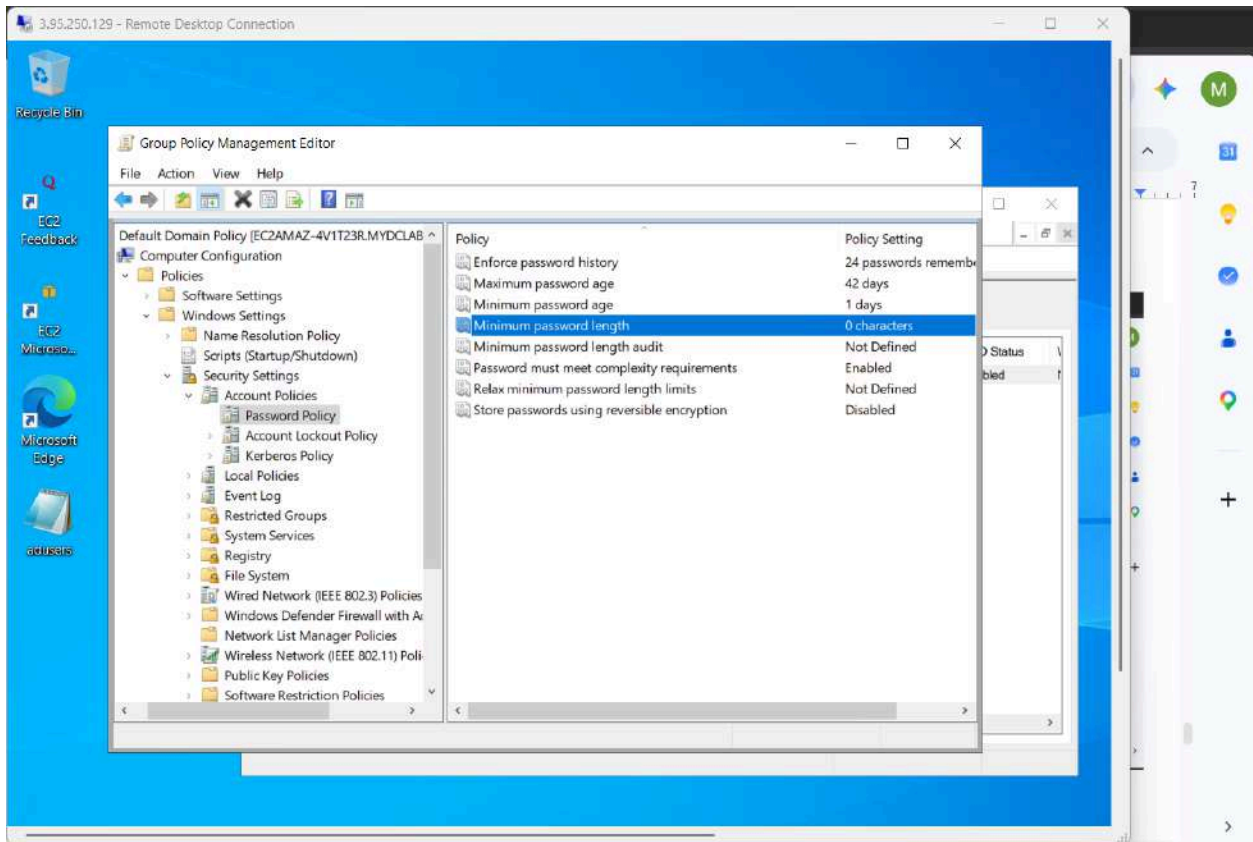


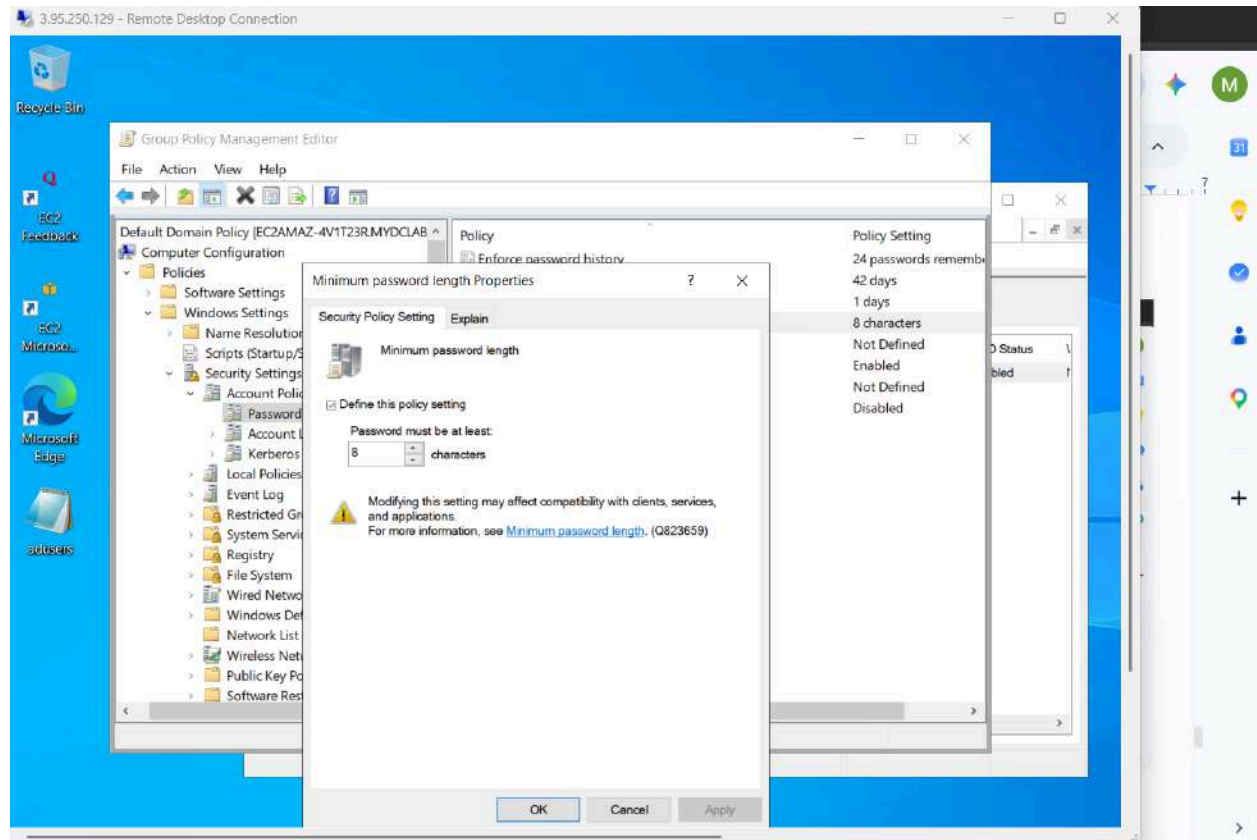
I go to **Default Domain Policy > Computer Configurations > Policies > Windows Settings > Security Settings > Account Policies > Password Policy** double click **Password must meet complexity requirements** on the right, I make sure **Define this policy setting** is selected and then I set it to **Enabled**, then I press **Apply** and **OK**.



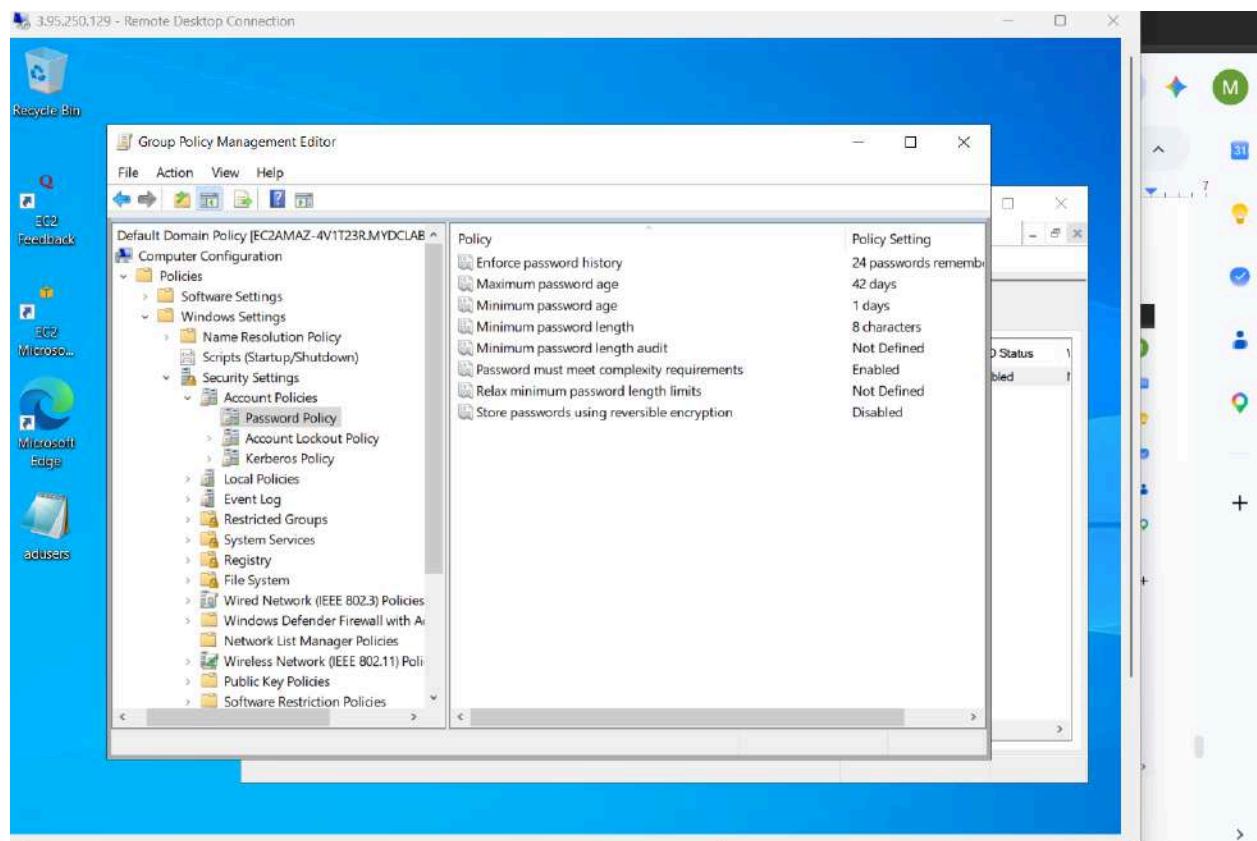


I then double click on **Minimum Password Length**, select **Define this policy setting** and then set the value to 8 characters, and then I hit **Apply** and **OK**.





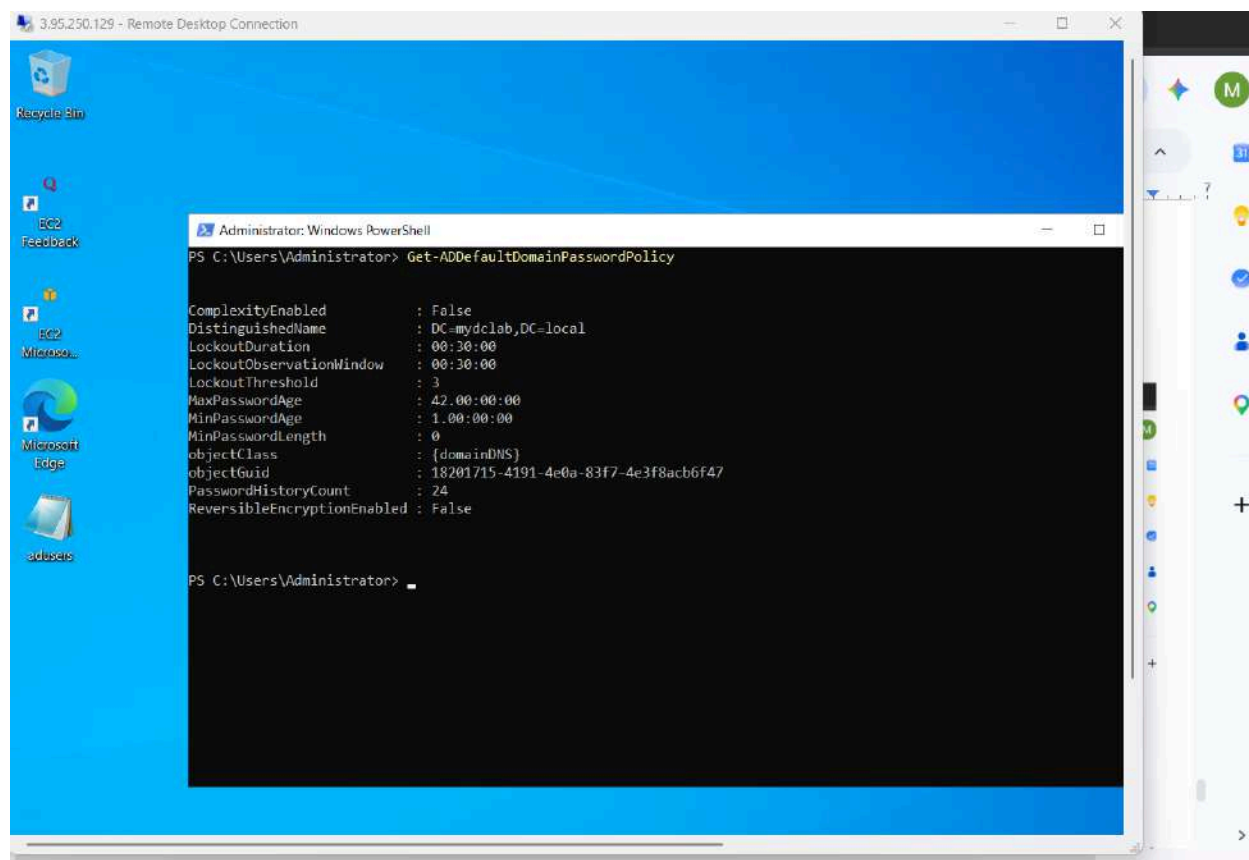
Below as you can see is the proof that the policies are active.



PowerShell Method

First I run this command to see what is already configured for the passwords policy:
Get-ADDefaultDomainPasswordPolicy.

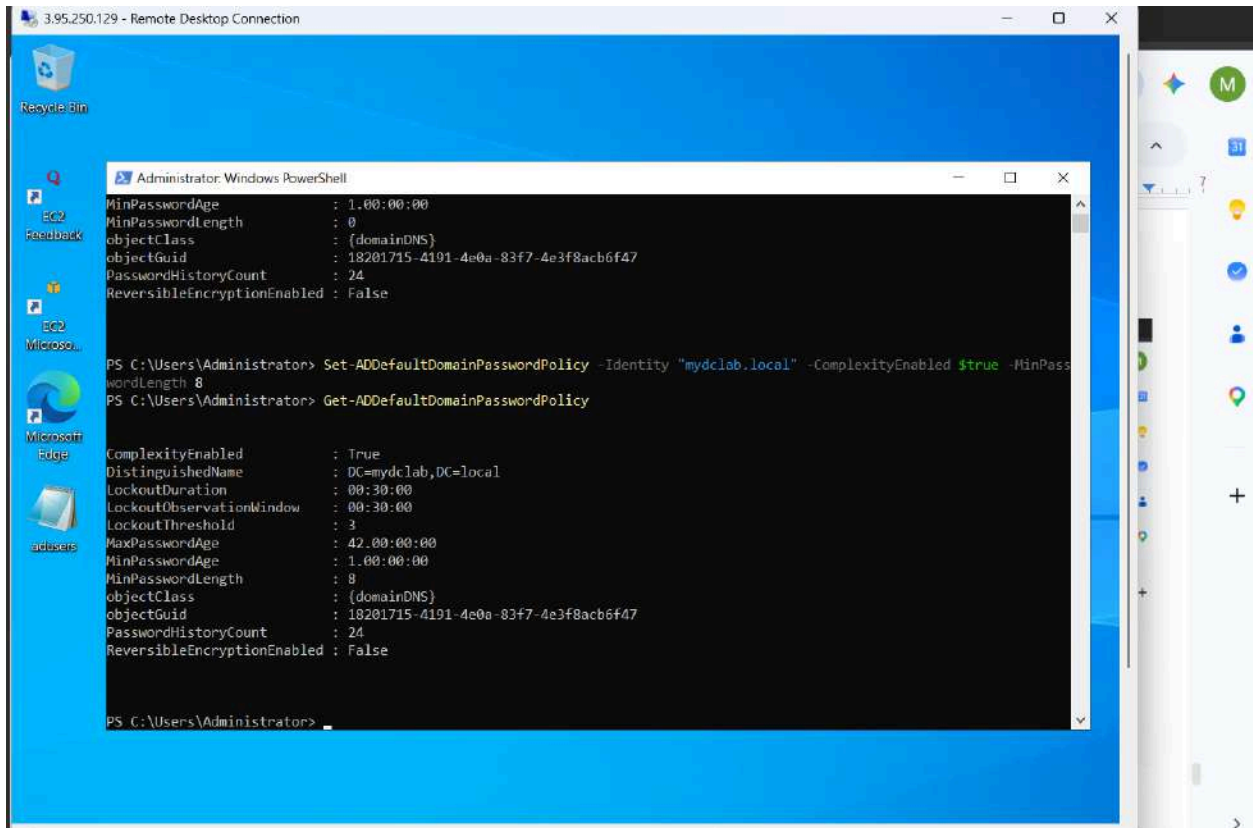
As you can see that password complexity is disabled due to this **ComplexityEnabled** being set to **false** and the **minimum password length** is literally **0**, these need to be changed.



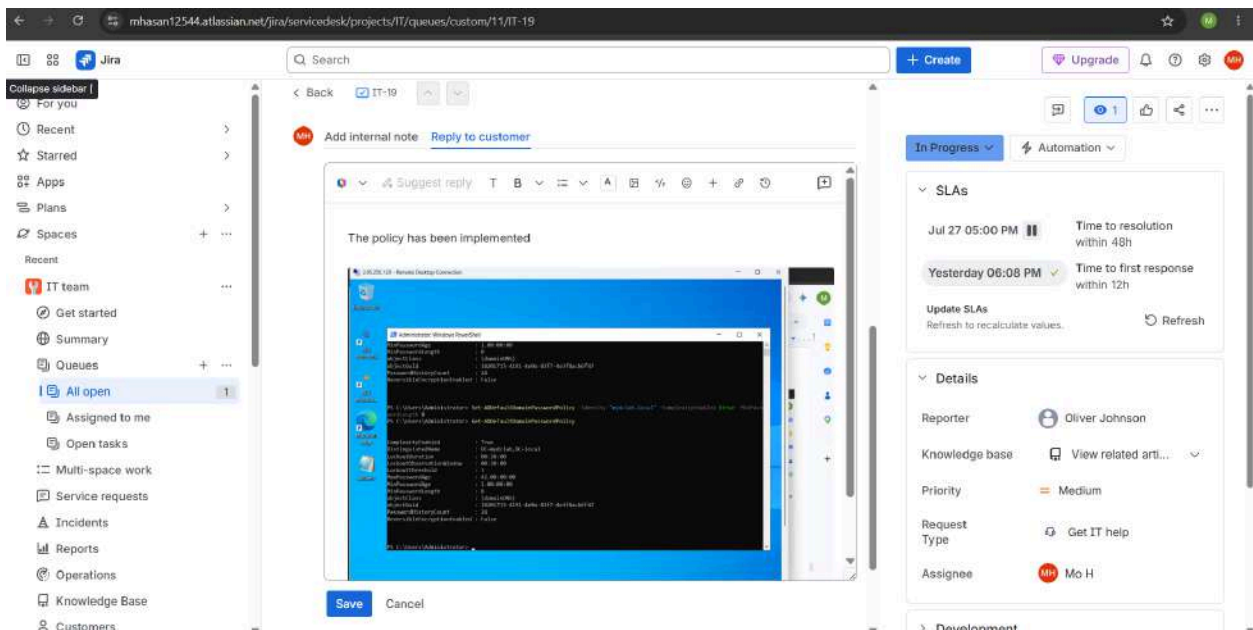
Now I enable the password complexity and set the minimum password length to 8 via this command

Set-ADDefaultDomainPasswordPolicy -Identity "mydclab.local" -ComplexityEnabled \$true -MinPasswordLength 8

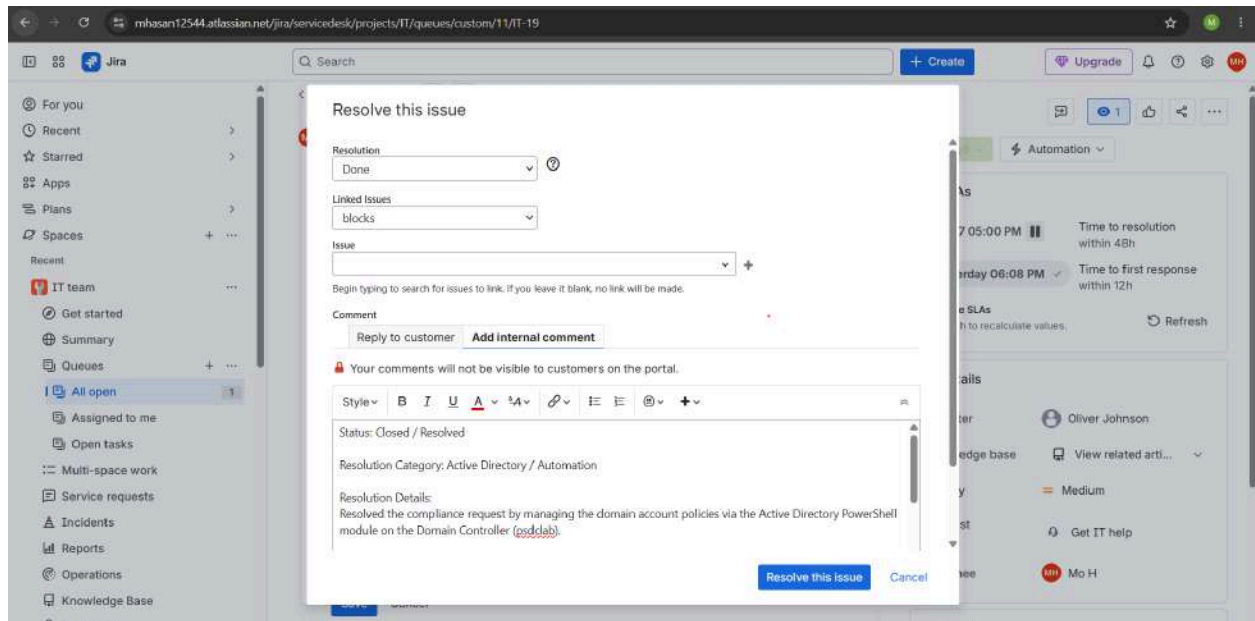
Once I've done that I show proof that the policy has been successfully configured once again through this command, as you can see the **ComplexityEnabled** parameters has been updated to **True** and the **MinPasswordLength** has been set to 8.



Now I reply to the requester with proof that the policy has been implemented.



Now I resolve the ticket with a resolution summary.



Now I can close the ticket.

Closed

Done

Automation

SLAs

Jul 27 05:00 PM

Time to resolution within 48h

Yesterday 06:08 PM

Time to first response within 12h

Update SLAs
Refresh to recalculate values.

Refresh

Details

Reporter

Oliver Johnson

Knowledge base

View related arti...

Priority

Medium

Request Type

Get IT help

Assignee

Mo H

> Development

Ticket Resolution Summaries Powershell and Manual(GUI) Methods:

PowerShell Method Resolution Summary

Status: Closed / Resolved

Resolution Category: Active Directory / Automation

Resolution Details: Resolved the compliance request by managing the domain account policies via the Active Directory PowerShell module on the Domain Controller (psdclab).

- **Action Taken:** Executed `Set-ADDefaultDomainPasswordPolicy` targeting the default domain policy to enforce strict compliance metrics.
 - **Configuration Applied:** Enabled domain-wide password complexity requirements (`-ComplexityEnabled $true`) and increased the minimum password length parameter to 8 characters (`-MinPasswordLength 8`).
 - **Verification:** Successfully verified the updated Active Directory database properties using `Get-ADDefaultDomainPasswordPolicy`. Executed a group policy update (`gpupdate /force`) on the client workstation (psdclab-client1) and verified local operating system enforcement via the `net accounts` command.
-

Manual (GUI) Method Resolution Summary

Status: Closed / Resolved

Resolution Category: Group Policy Management / Security

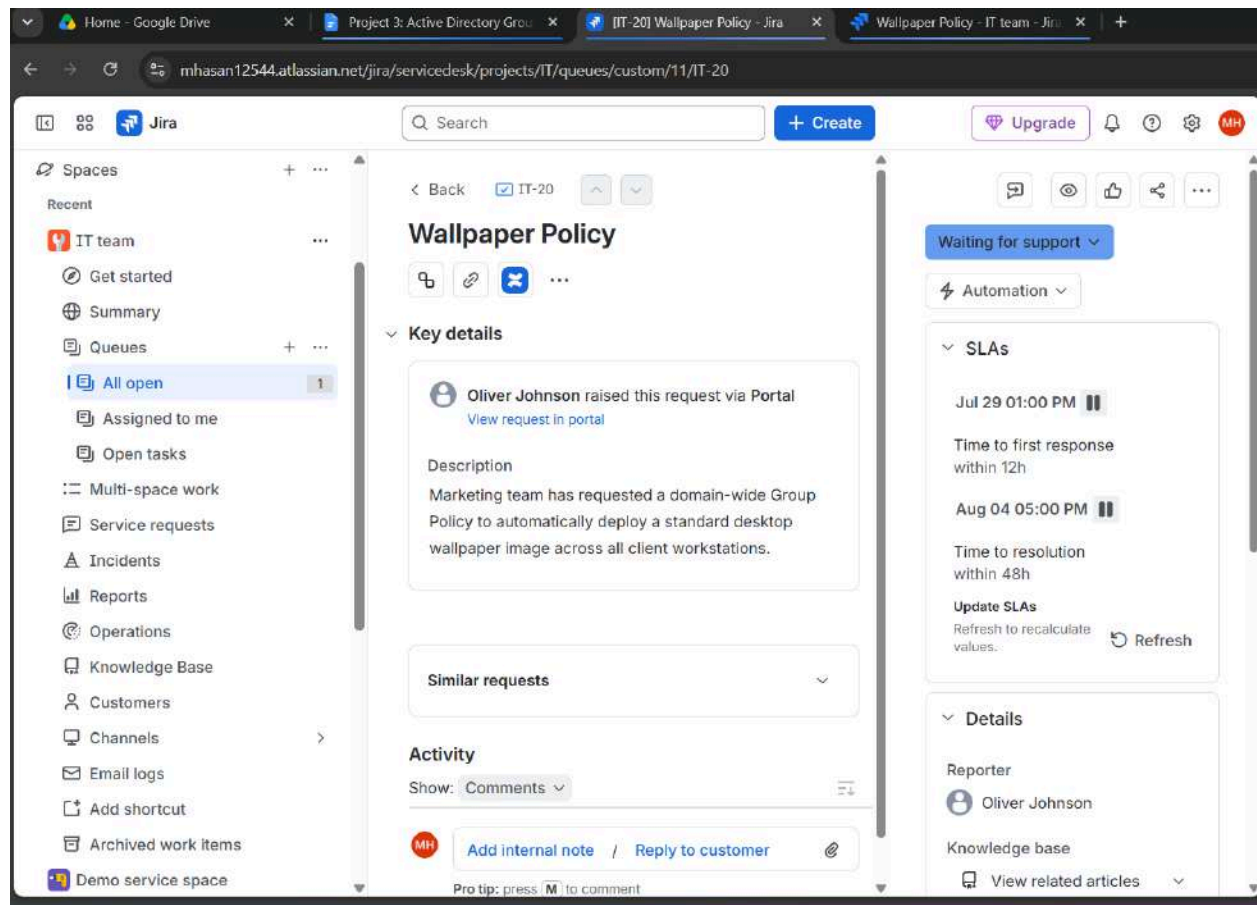
Resolution Details: Manually configured and deployed the requested password security rules via the central management console on the Domain Controller (psdclab).

- **Action Taken:** Opened the Group Policy Management Console (`gpmc.msc`), located the `mydclab.local` domain hierarchy, and opened the **Default Domain Policy** for editing.
- **Configuration Applied:** Navigated to `Computer Configuration > Policies > Windows Settings > Security Settings > Account Policies > Password Policy` and modified the following security nodes:
 1. **Password must meet complexity requirements:** Set to **Enabled**.
 2. **Minimum password length:** Configured to **8 characters**.
- **Verification:** Confirmed settings application via the Local Security Policy console (`secpol.msc`). Switched to the endpoint workstation (psdclab-client1),

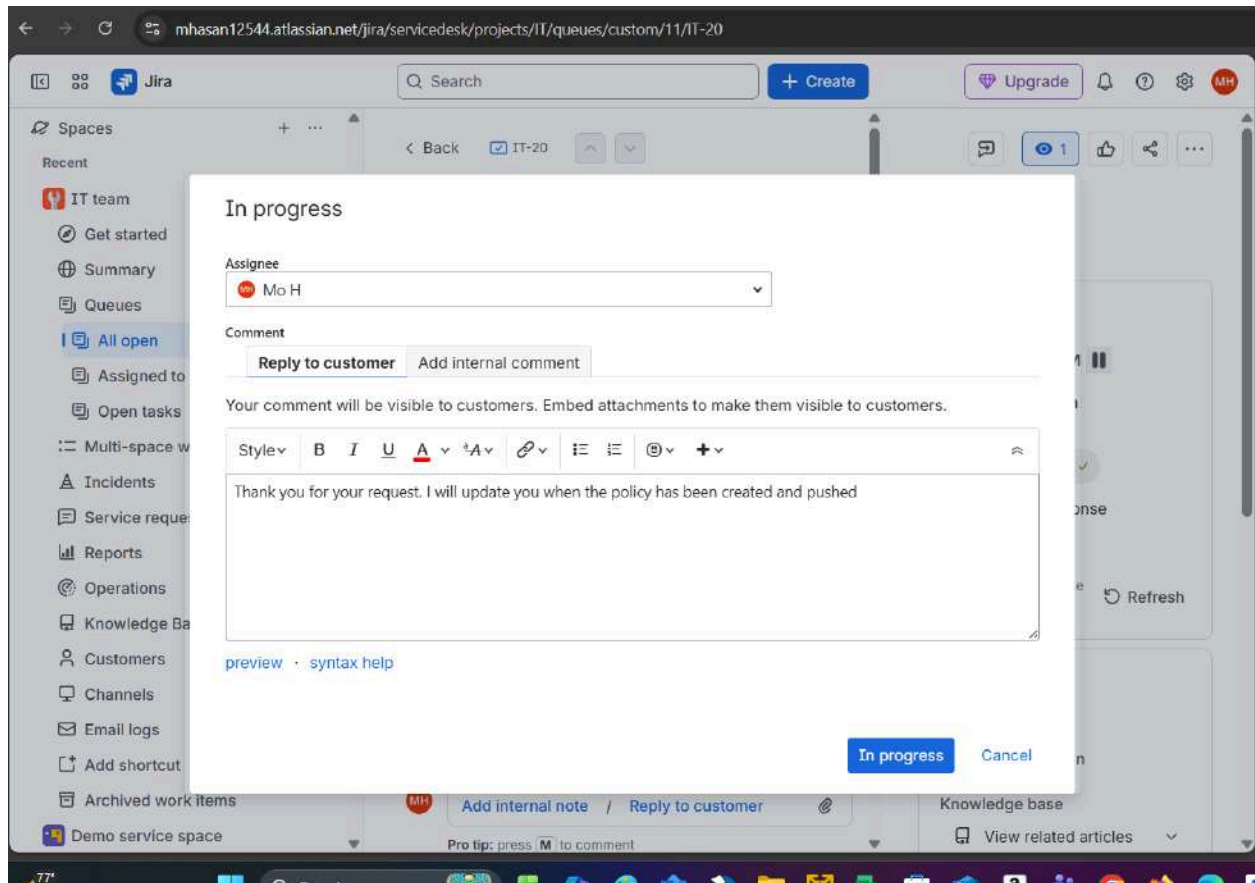
triggered a manual network policy synchronization via `gpupdate /force`, and confirmed the endpoint successfully inherited the new domain constraints.

Deploy Desktop Wallpaper Policy

It looks like I've received a ticket to create a policy for deploying a standard desktop image for all work stations.



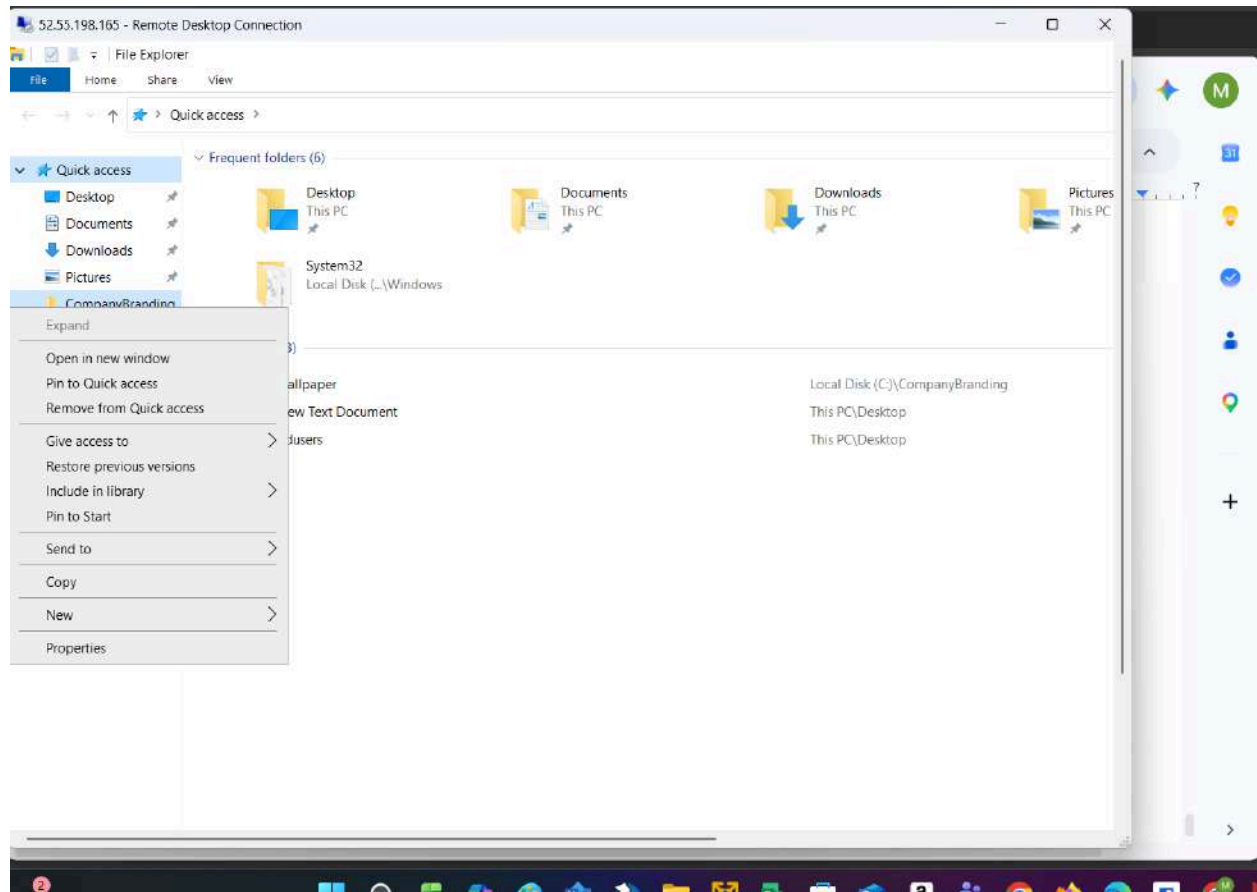
I assign the ticket to myself and reply to the requester and change the status to in progress.



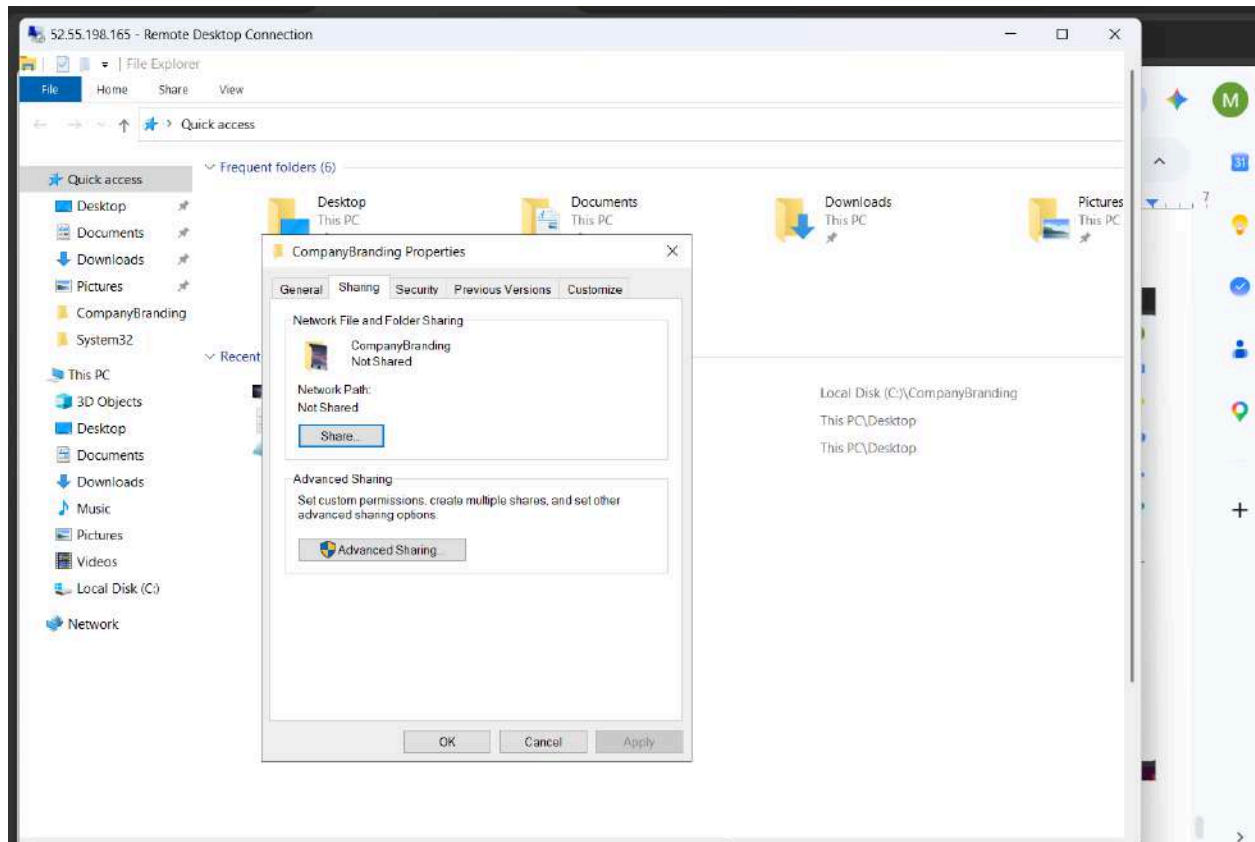
Manual Method

note ** It was redundant for me to create the shared folder again because I did the powershell version first and already created it there. I've decided to skip that step when showcasing the manual method.

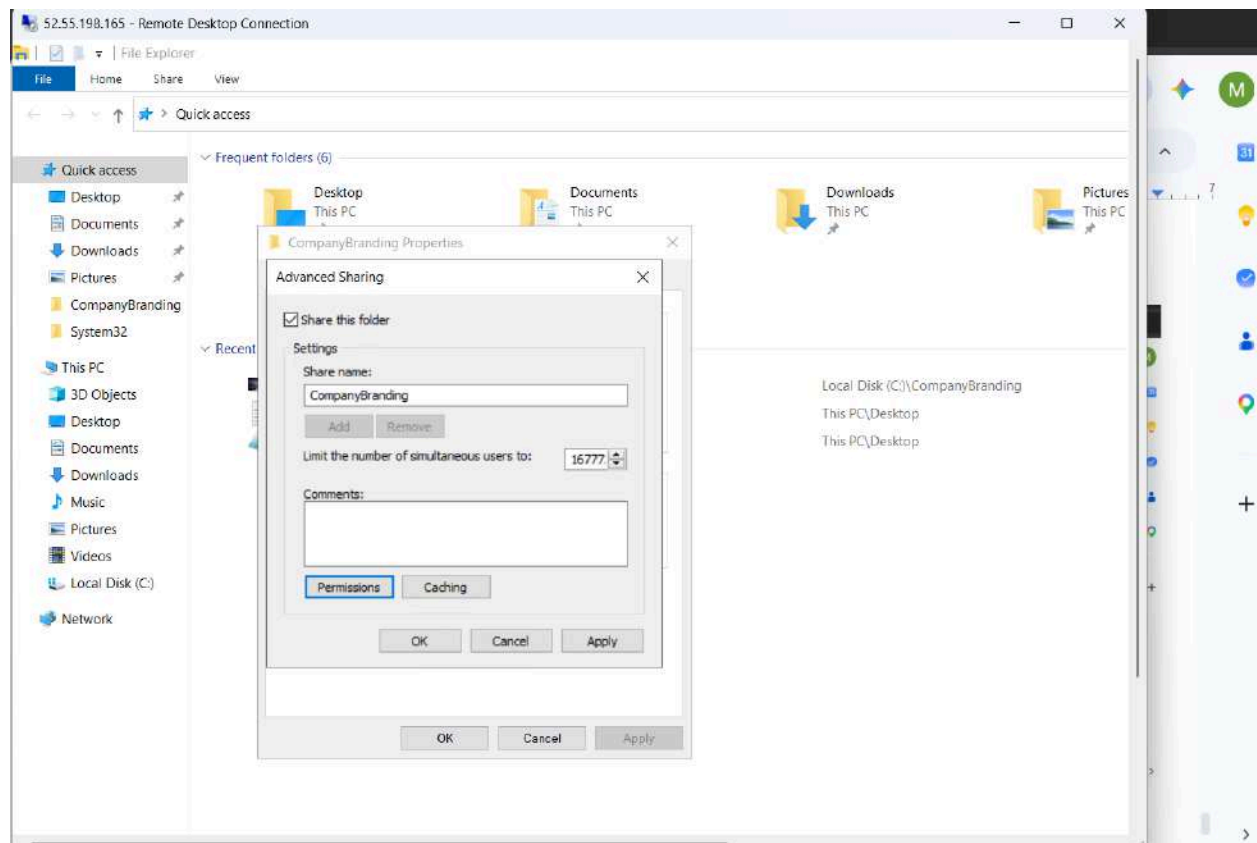
I open file explorer and right click the directory that contains my wallpaper and click **Properties**.



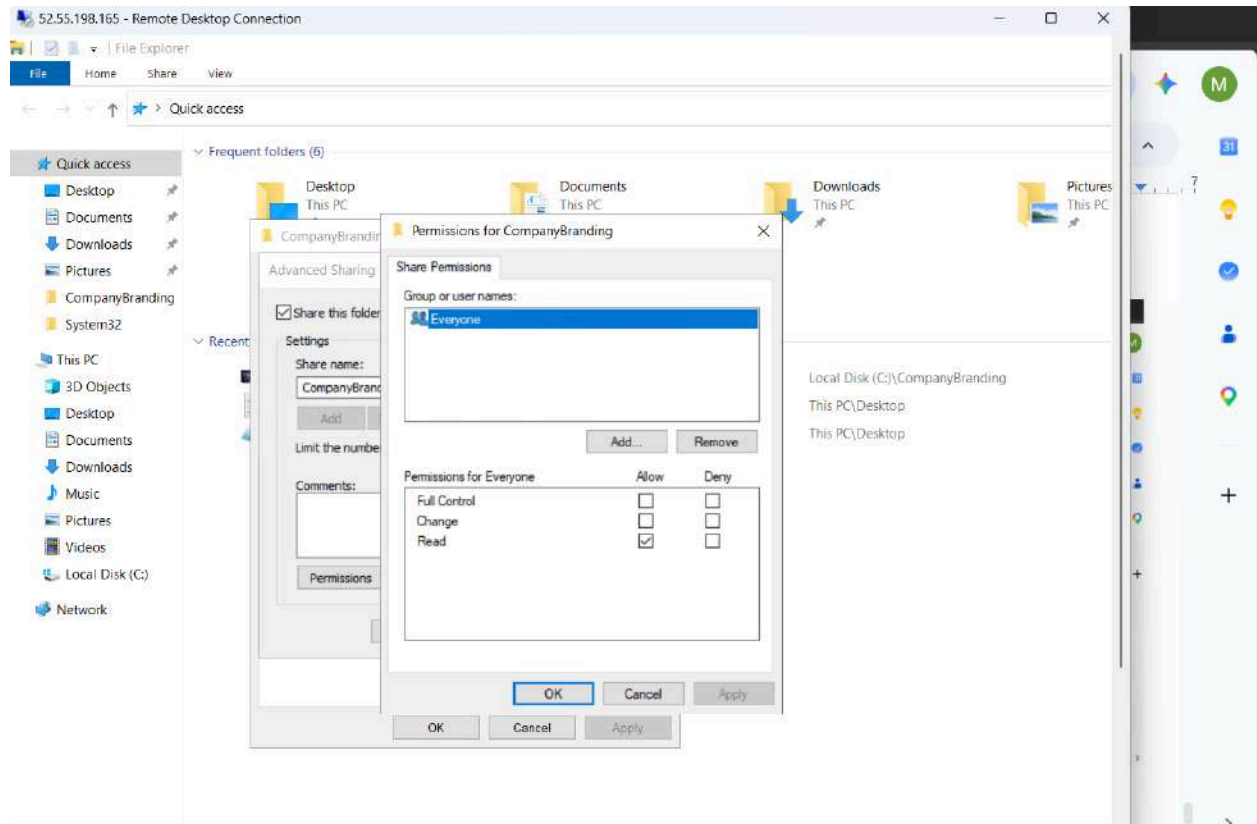
In the properties window I click **Sharing** then **Advanced Sharing**.



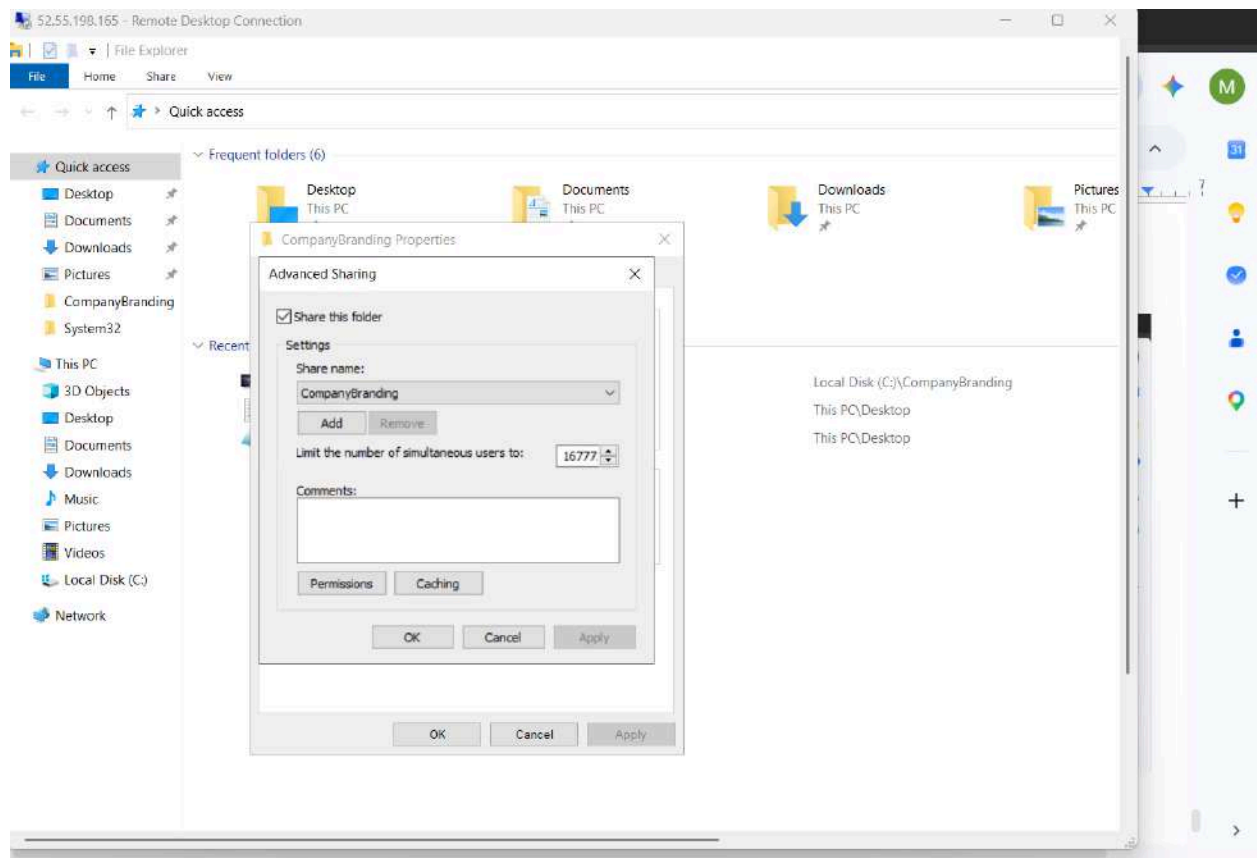
I check the box for **Share this folder**.



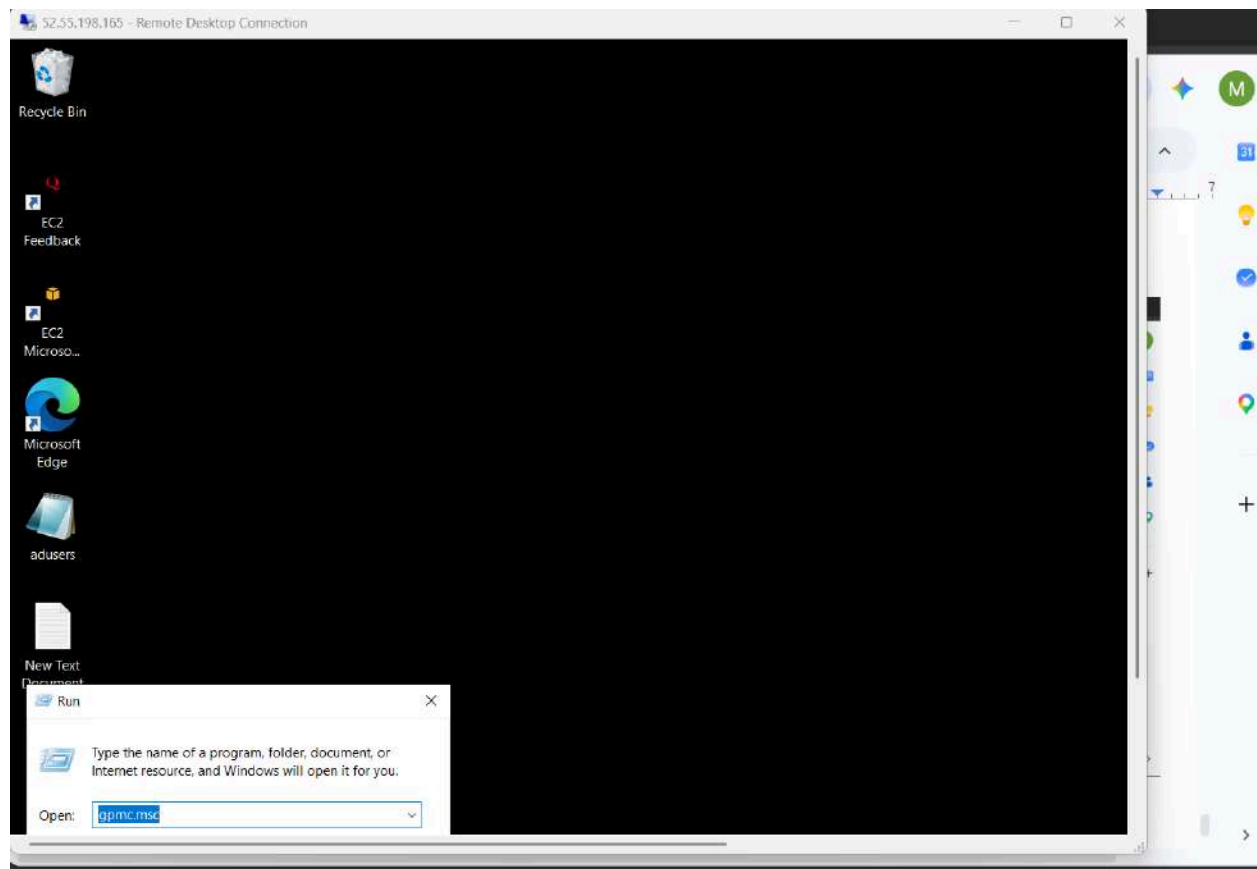
I then click **Permissions** make sure **Everyone** is selected so the policy applies to everyone in the domain and I make sure they have read permissions and then I select **OK**.



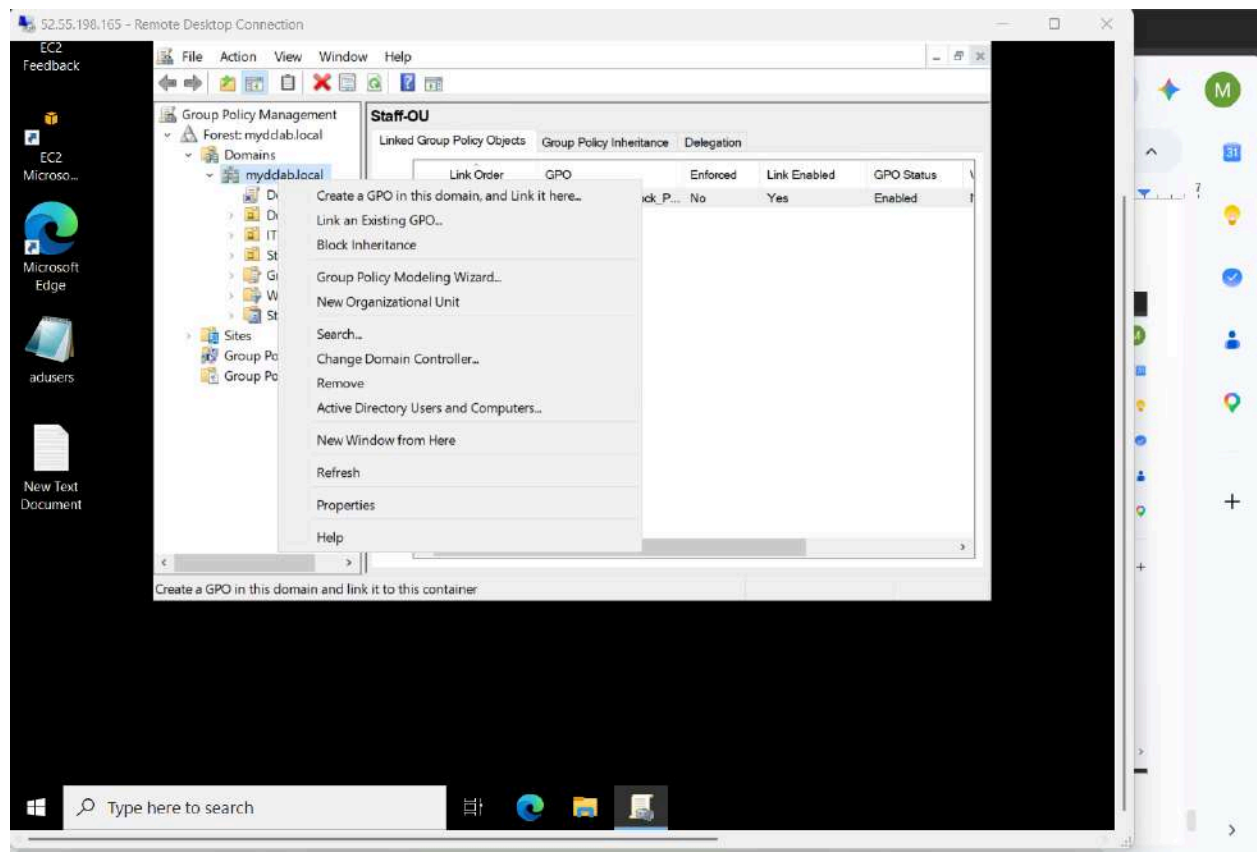
Hit **OK** again and then exit the properties window and the file explorer.



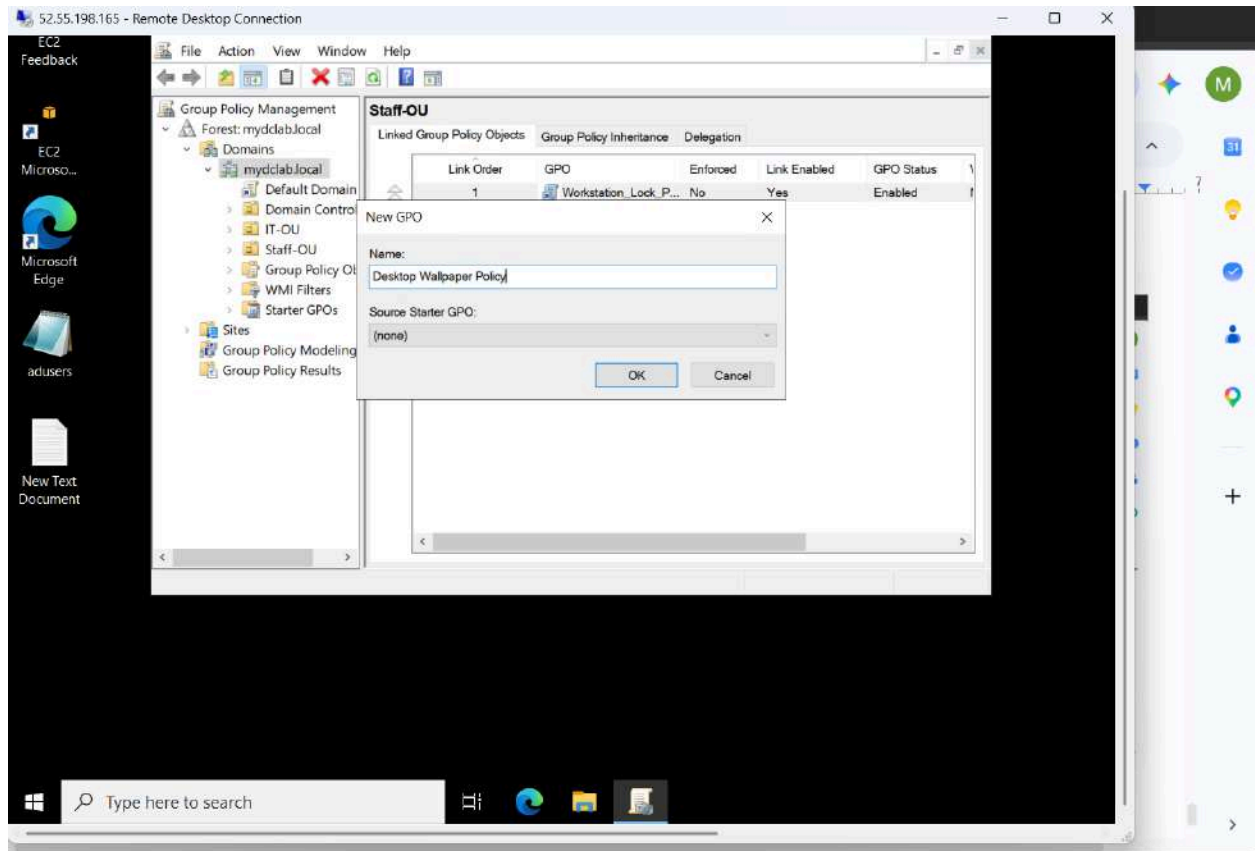
I run gpmmc.msc.



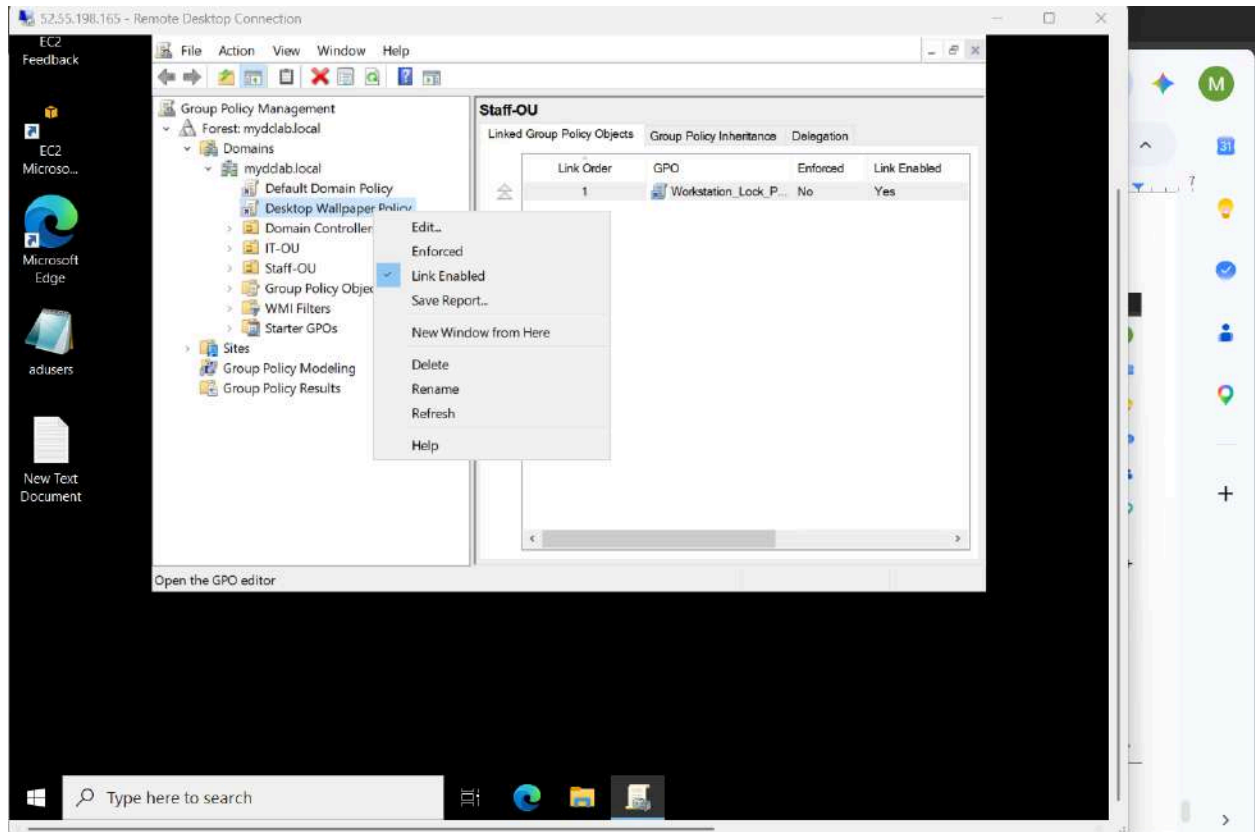
I right click my domain name in the panel on the left and select **Create a GPO in this domain,** and **Link it here.**



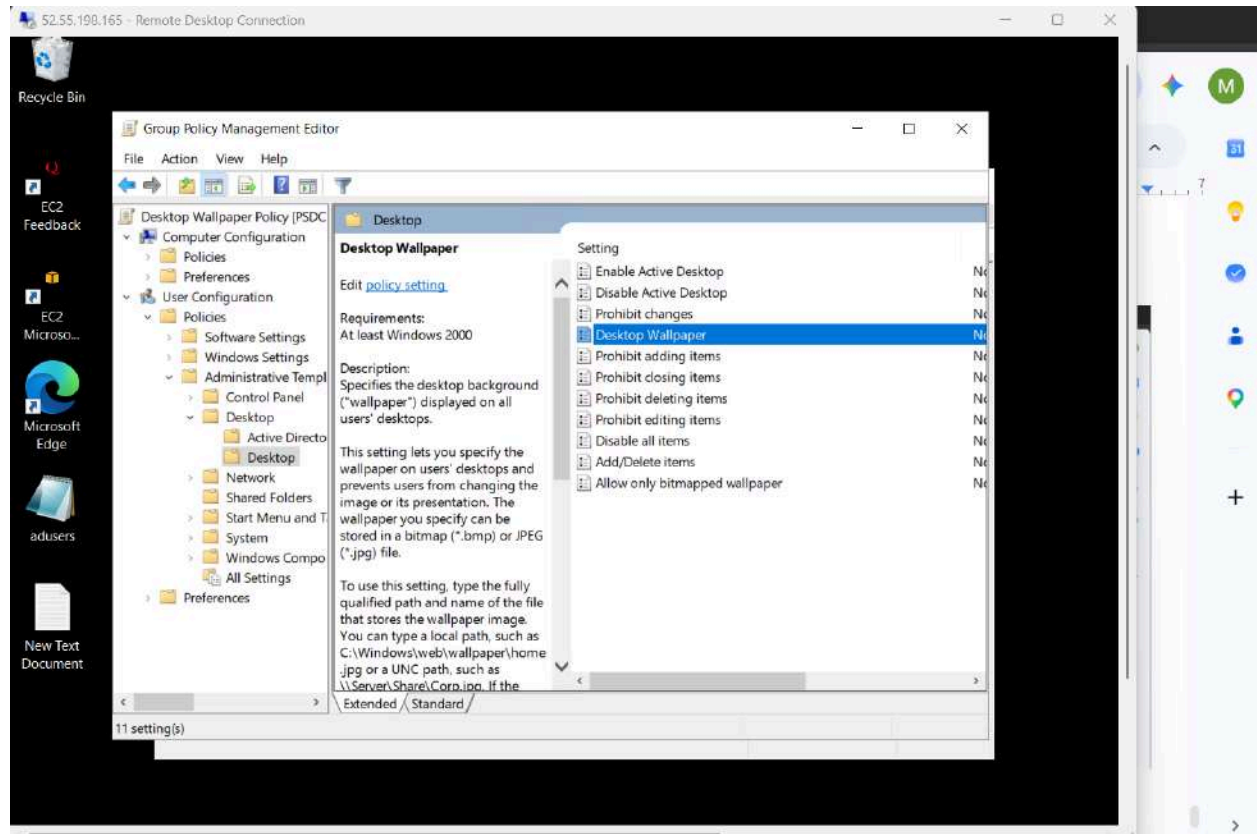
I name the group policy object Desktop Wallpaper Policy and then hit **OK**.



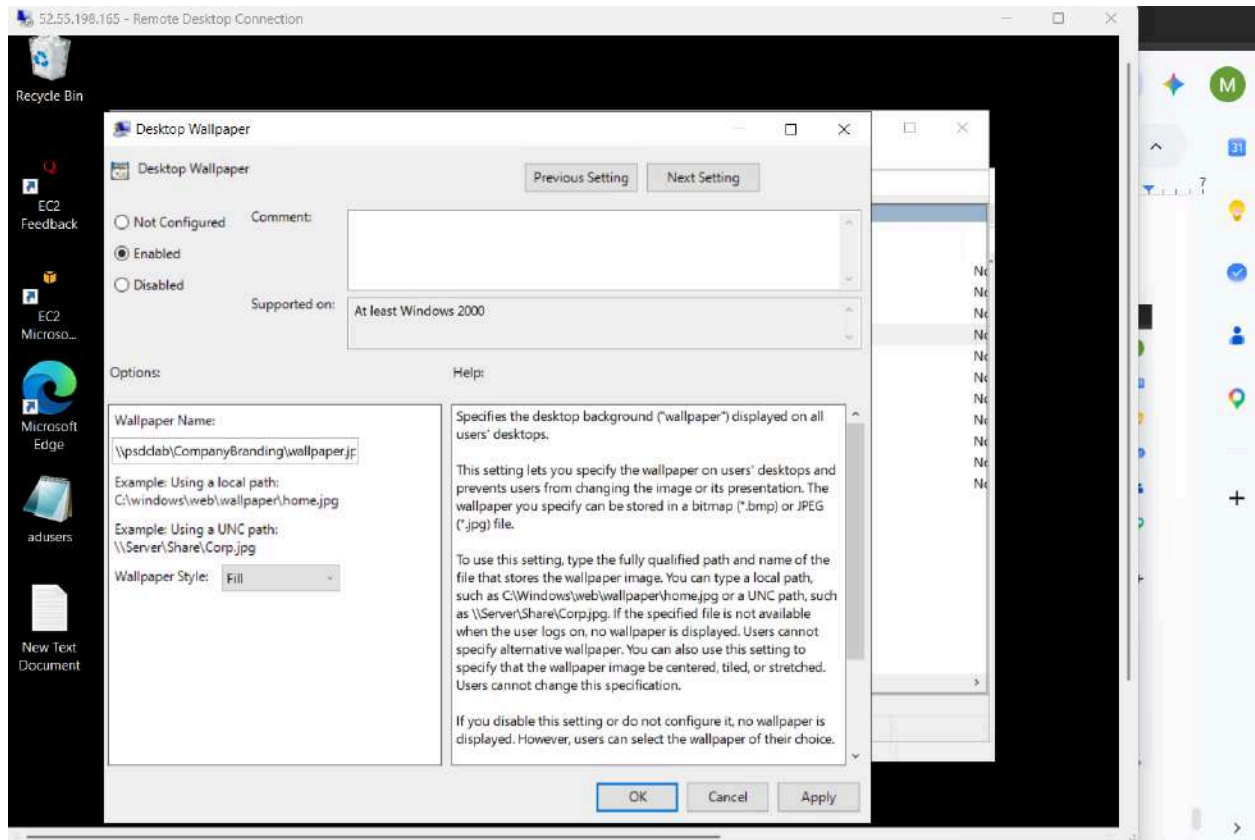
Then on the left pane, underneath my domain name, the policy will be seen so I right click it and hit **Edit**.



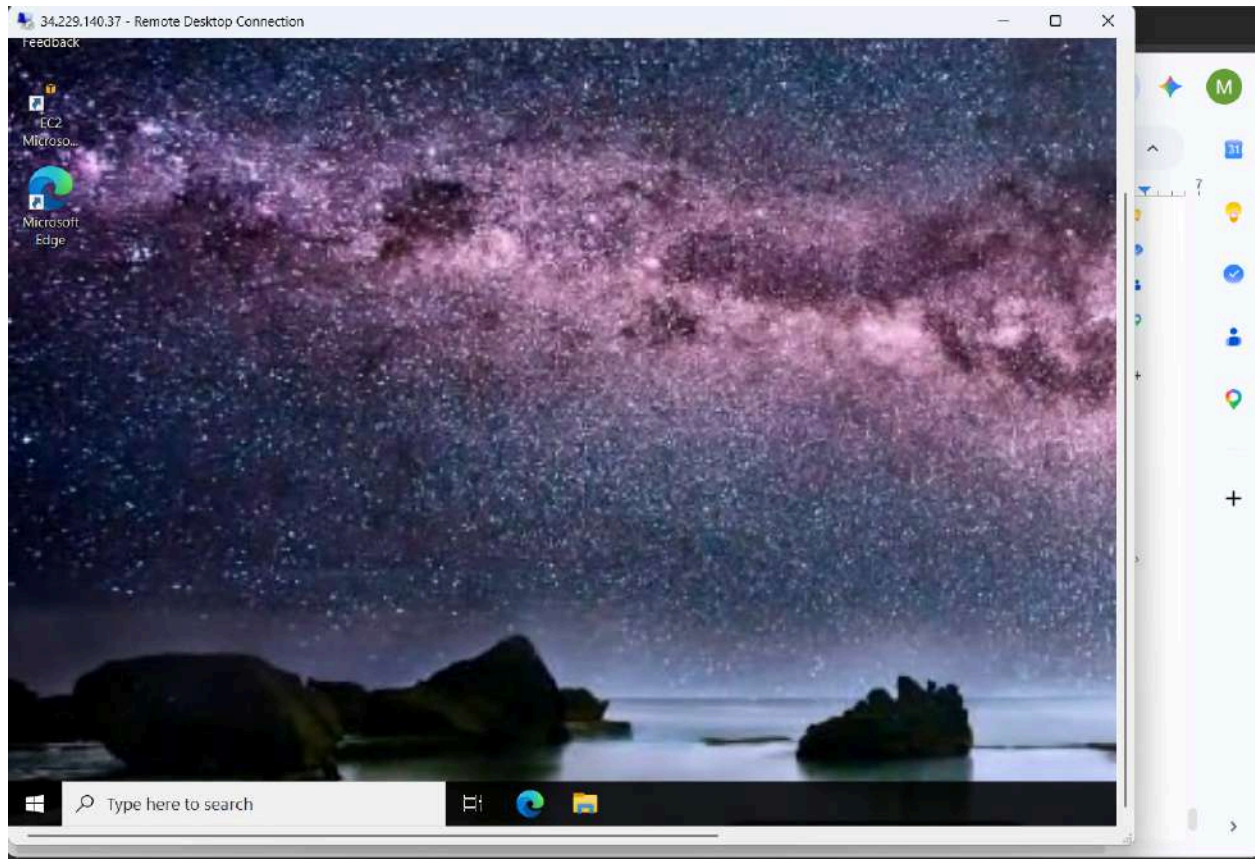
Within the Group Policy Management Editor in the left panel select **Computer Configuration** underneath **Desktop Wallpaper Policy** > **User Configuration** > **Policies** > **Administrative Templates** > **Desktop** > then I double click **Desktop Wallpaper** in the right pane.



I select **Enabled** in the following window, add the path `\\psdclab\\CompanyBranding\\wallpaper` for the Wallpaper Name, and then I select **Fill** for the Wallpaper Style so the wallpaper can fill the desktop screen properly. Then I hit **Apply** and **OK**.



Once again I will login to the client machine using a standard account within the Staff-OU and as you can see the wallpaper has been set.



PowerShell Method

In the domain controller instance, I run these lines in powershell to unblock the ports within the windows firewall responsible for filesharing, created a new directory called CompanyBranding in the C drive, turned it into an smb share file that everyone can access, created a new group policy object called Desktop Wallpaper Policy, set the gpo registry settings to enforce the path of the wallpaper, style it so it fits well in the desktop screen, and then linked the policy to the domain

Enable-NetFirewallRule -DisplayGroup "File and Printer Sharing"

New-Item -Path "C:\CompanyBranding" -ItemType Directory

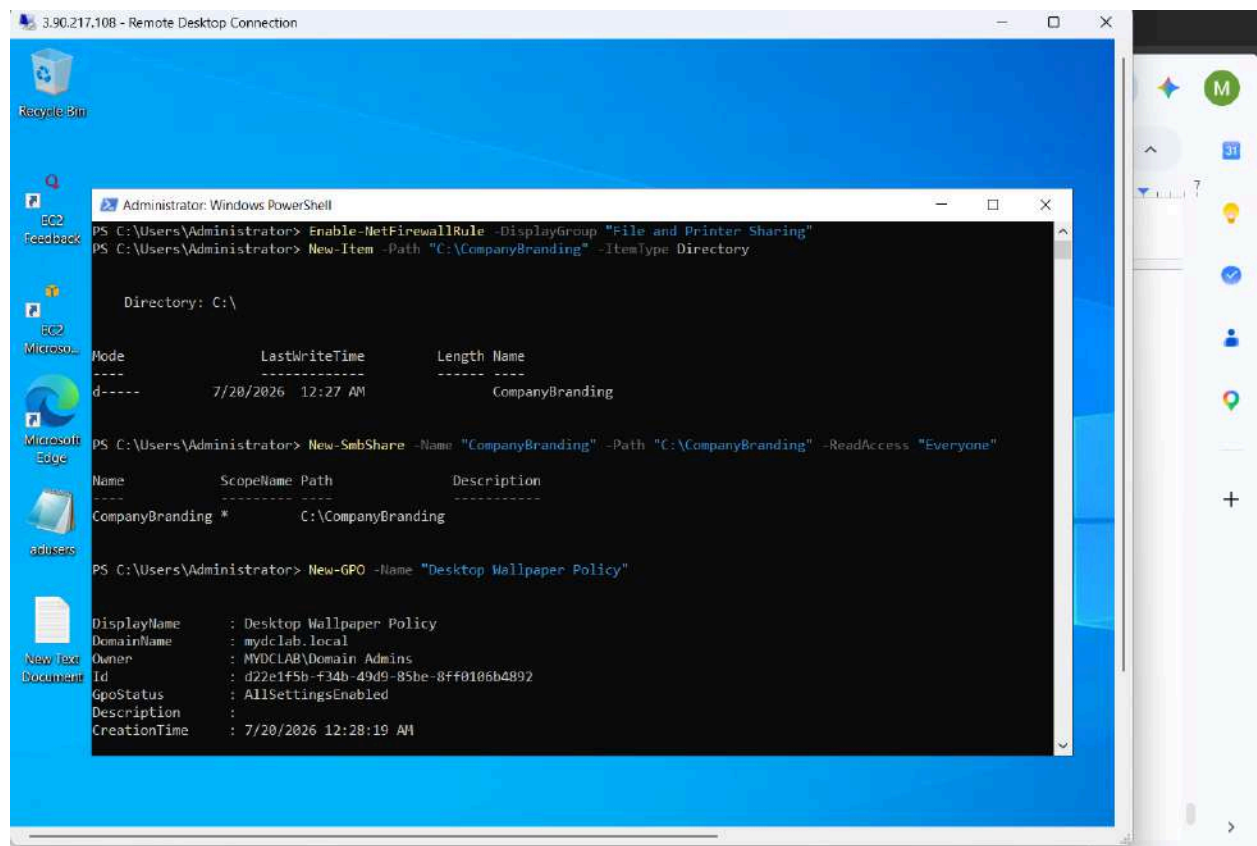
New-SmbShare -Name "CompanyBranding" -Path "C:\CompanyBranding" -ReadAccess "Everyone"

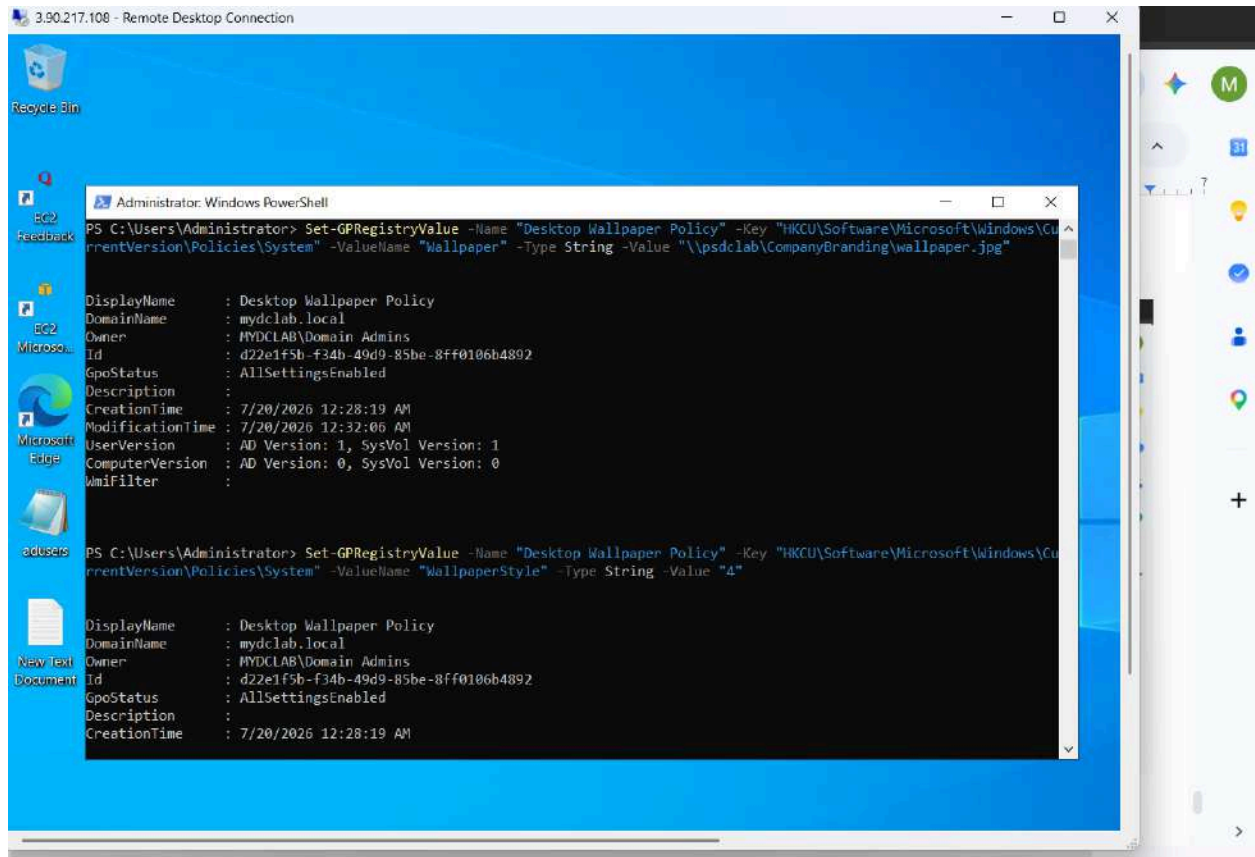
New-GPO -Name "Desktop Wallpaper Policy"

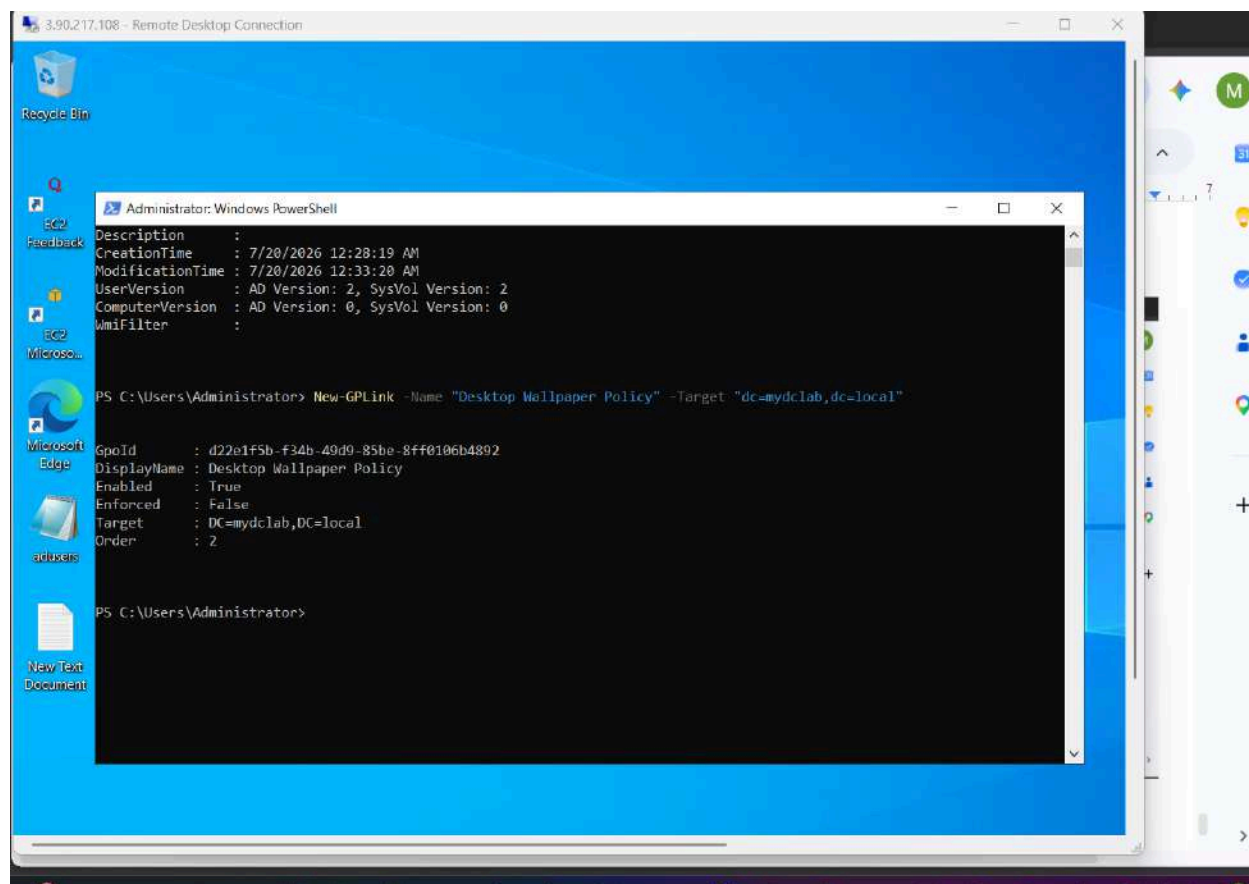
Set-GPRegistryValue -Name "Desktop Wallpaper Policy" -Key "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System" -ValueName "Wallpaper" -Type String -Value "\\psdclab\CompanyBranding\wallpaper.jpg"

Set-GPRegistryValue -Name "Desktop Wallpaper Policy" -Key "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System" -ValueName "WallpaperStyle" -Type String -Value "4"

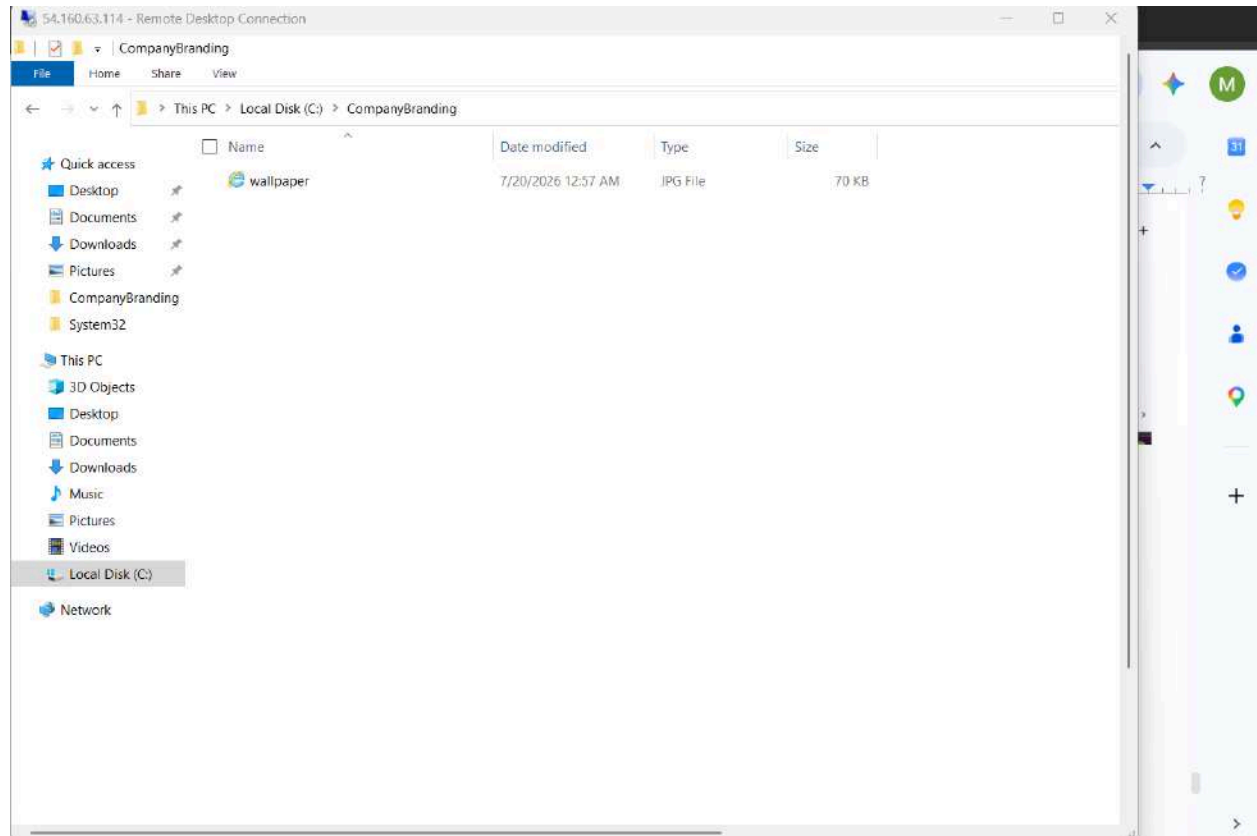
New-GPLink -Name "Desktop Wallpaper Policy" -Target "dc=mydclab,dc=local"







I then look for an image in the web that I save to directory that is now a shared folder and I will save it as wallpaper.jpg.



Now I will login into the client machine psdclab-client1 as a standard user from Staff-OU, I will choose the user Bob Ross. As a result you should see the new wallpaper in the background.



Windows Security



Enter your credentials

These credentials will be used to connect to 44.223.27.153.

bross

Password

••••••••

MYDCLAB\bross



Remember me

More choices



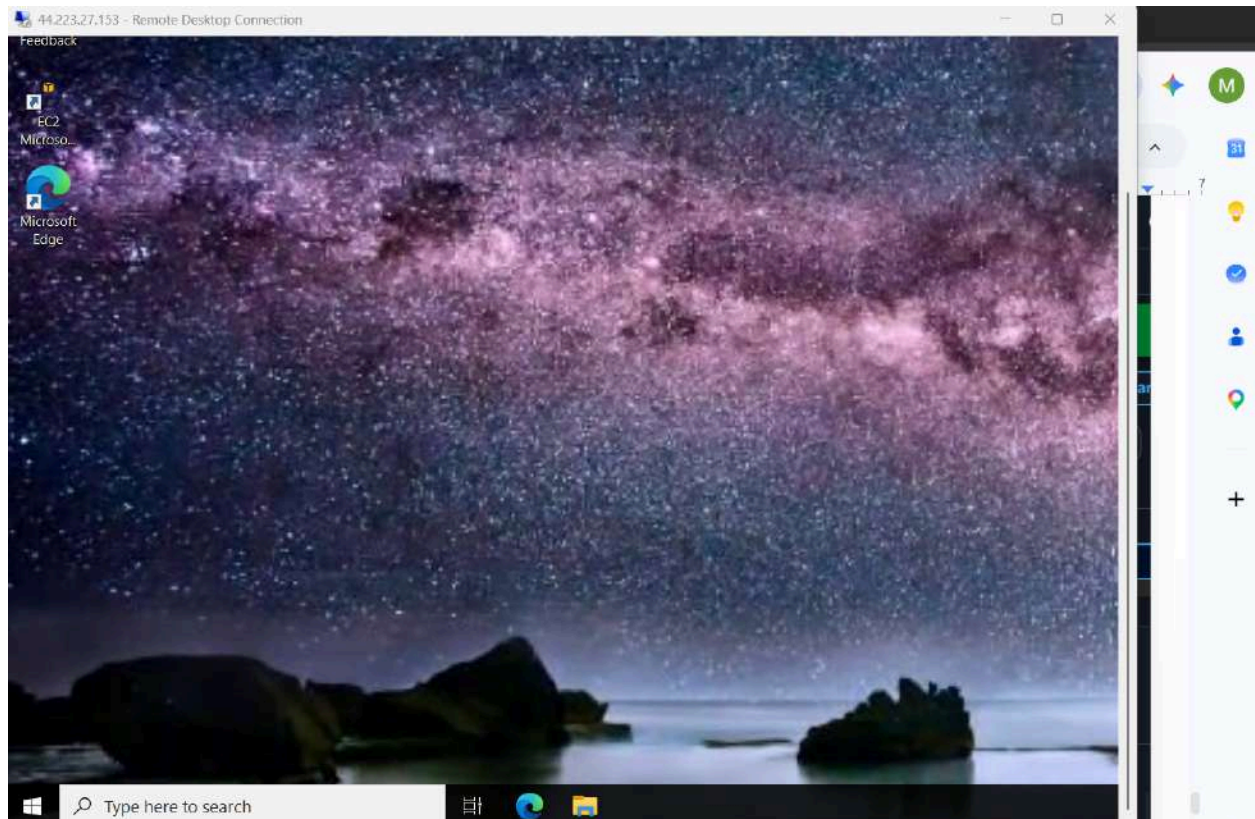
bross
MYDCLAB\bross



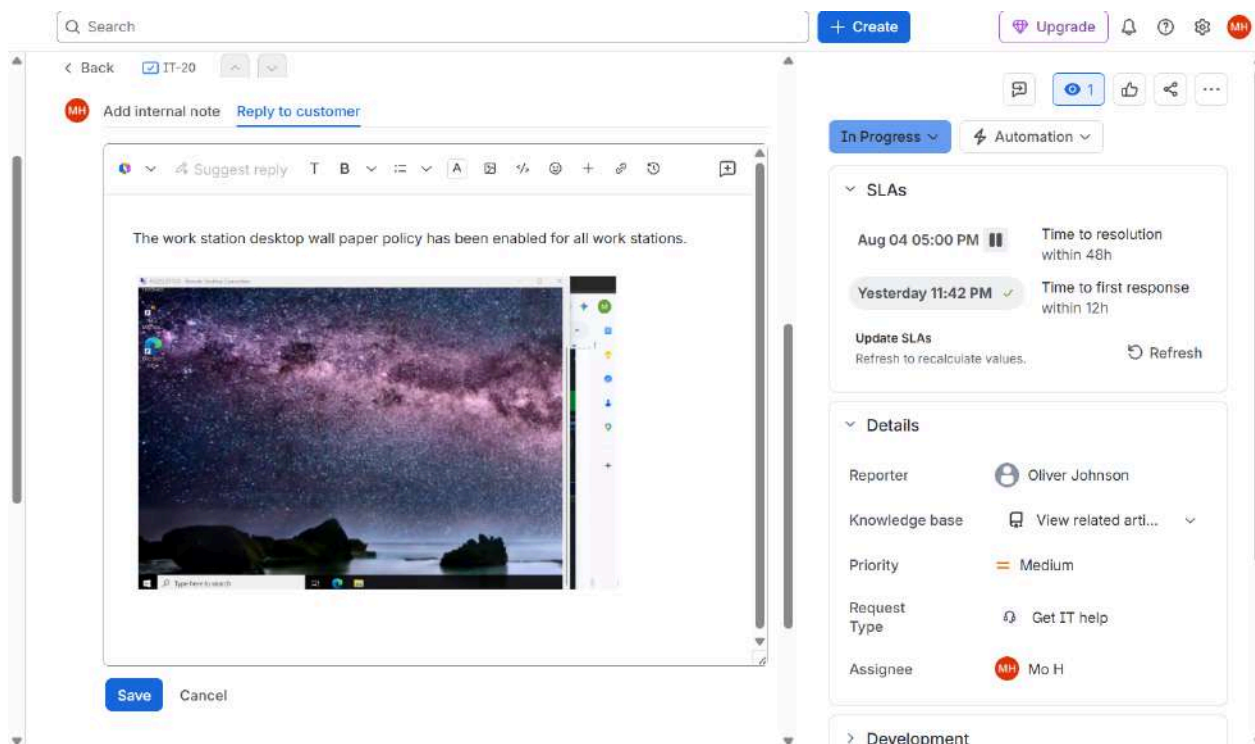
Use a different account

OK

Cancel



Now I will reply to the customer about the new desktop policy with evidence.



Next I write a resolution summary for the ticket and change the status to resolved.

The screenshot shows a web application interface for resolving a ticket. At the top, there is a search bar and a '+ Create' button. The main section is titled 'Resolve this issue'. It contains several dropdown menus: 'Resolution' set to 'Done', 'Linked Issues' set to 'blocks', and an empty 'Issue' dropdown. Below these is a text input field with a '+' icon and a hint: 'Begin typing to search for issues to link. If you leave it blank, no link will be made.' Underneath is a 'Comment' section with two buttons: 'Reply to customer' and 'Add internal comment'. A red lock icon and text state: 'Your comments will not be visible to customers on the portal.' Below this is a rich text editor with a toolbar containing options for style, bold, italic, underline, text color, background color, link, unlink, list, and more. The text area contains the following content: 'Problem / Request: Automate the configuration of network file sharing and Group Policy Object (GPO) deployment to enforce standard desktop branding across domain endpoints. Resolution Steps: Configured Firewall & Directory Structure: Enabled network file sharing rules: Enable-NetFirewallRule -DisplayGroup "File and Printer Sharing" Created the local asset directory:'. At the bottom right, there are two buttons: 'Resolve this issue' (highlighted in blue) and 'Cancel'.

Search

+ Create

Resolve this issue

Resolution: Done

Linked Issues: blocks

Issue: +

Begin typing to search for issues to link. If you leave it blank, no link will be made.

Comment

Reply to customer Add internal comment

🔒 Your comments will not be visible to customers on the portal.

Style B I U A A Link List More

Problem / Request:
Automate the configuration of network file sharing and Group Policy Object (GPO) deployment to enforce standard desktop branding across domain endpoints.
Resolution Steps:
Configured Firewall & Directory Structure:
Enabled network file sharing rules:
Enable-NetFirewallRule -DisplayGroup "File and Printer Sharing"
Created the local asset directory:

Resolve this issue Cancel

Finally I close the ticket.

Closed ▾

✓ Done

⚡ Automation ▾

▾ SLAs

Yesterday 11:42 PM ✓

Time to first response
within 12h

Today 08:52 PM ✓

Time to resolution
within 48h

Today 08:52 PM ✓

Time to close after
resolution
within 60h

Update SLAs

Refresh to recalculate values.

↻ Refresh

▾ Details

Reporter



Oliver Johnson

Knowledge base



View related arti...



Priority



Medium

Request
Type



Get IT help

Assignee



Mo H

Ticket Resolution Summaries Powershell and Manual(GUI) Methods:

Manual (GUI) Method Resolution Summary

Ticket Title: Deploy Standardized Corporate Desktop Wallpaper via Group Policy (GUI)

Category: Systems Administration / Active Directory / Group Policy

Problem / Request:

Enforce a standardized company desktop wallpaper across domain-joined client workstations to maintain brand compliance for domain users.

Resolution Steps:

1. Configured SMB Network Share:

- Created local folder C:\CompanyBranding on the Domain Controller.
- Configured Advanced Sharing permissions (Read for Everyone) to make the asset accessible over the network at \\psdclab\CompanyBranding.

2. Created & Configured Group Policy Object (GPO):

- Opened Group Policy Management Console (gpmc.msc) and created a new GPO named **Desktop Wallpaper Policy** linked at the domain level.
- Edited the GPO under User Configuration > Policies > Administrative Templates > Desktop > Desktop > Desktop Wallpaper.
- Enabled the policy, specified the UNC wallpaper path (\\psdclab\CompanyBranding\wallpaper), and set the Wallpaper Style to **Fill**.

3. Verification & Testing:

- Logged into domain client psdclab-client1 using a standard domain account within Staff-OU.
- Verified that the Group Policy successfully applied the corporate desktop wallpaper upon user session launch.

Status: Resolved / Closed

PowerShell Method Resolution Summary

Ticket Title: Automated Deployment of Corporate Desktop Wallpaper via PowerShell

Category: Systems Administration / Automation / Group Policy

Problem / Request:

Automate the configuration of network file sharing and Group Policy Object (GPO) deployment to enforce standard desktop branding across domain endpoints.

Resolution Steps:

1. Configured Firewall & Directory Structure:

- Enabled network file sharing rules:
Enable-NetFirewallRule -DisplayGroup "File and Printer Sharing"
- Created the local asset directory:
New-Item -Path "C:\CompanyBranding" -ItemType Directory

2. Provisioned SMB Share:

- Shared the directory with domain read access:
New-SmbShare -Name "CompanyBranding" -Path "C:\CompanyBranding" -ReadAccess "Everyone"

3. Automated GPO Creation & Registry Configuration:

- Provisioned the GPO:
New-GPO -Name "Desktop Wallpaper Policy"
- Configured User Profile Registry policies for wallpaper path and display style:
Set-GPRegistryValue -Name "Desktop Wallpaper Policy" -Key "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System" -ValueName "Wallpaper" -Type String -Value "\\psdclab\CompanyBranding\wallpaper.jpg"
Set-GPRegistryValue -Name "Desktop Wallpaper Policy" -Key "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System" -ValueName "WallpaperStyle" -Type String -Value "4"
- Linked GPO to the domain:
New-GPLink -Name "Desktop Wallpaper Policy" -Target "dc=mydclab,dc=local"

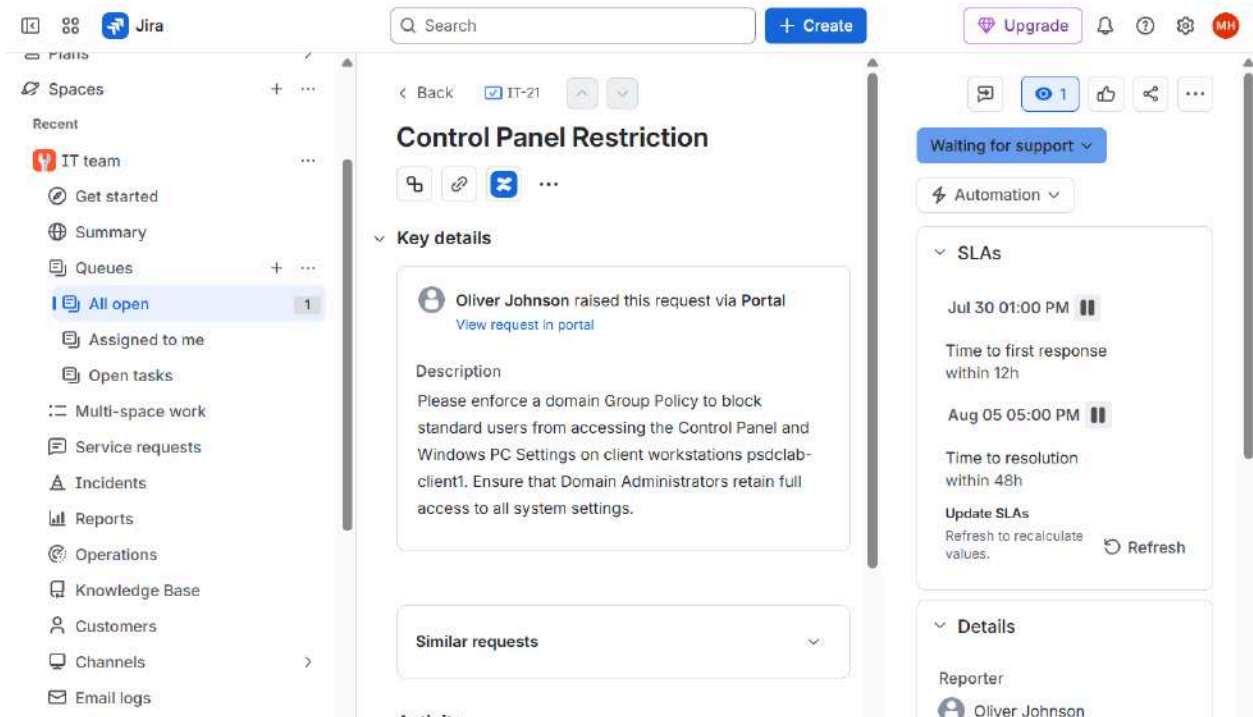
4. Verification & Testing:

- Placed wallpaper.jpg into C:\CompanyBranding.
- Logged into client workstation psdclab-client1 as standard user Bob Ross (MYDCLAB\bross).
- Confirmed the policy executed correctly and rendered the background wallpaper upon sign-in.

Status: Resolved / Closed

Restrict Control Panel Access

It looks like I've received a ticket to enforce a policy that locks the control panel for standard users but not administrative accounts.



I reply to the requester that I am actively working on the ticket, I assign the ticket to myself and change the status of the ticket to In progress.

In progress

Assignee
Mo H

[Assign to me](#)

Comment

[Reply to customer](#) [Add internal comment](#)

Your comments will not be visible to customers on the portal.

Style **B** *I* U A ²A

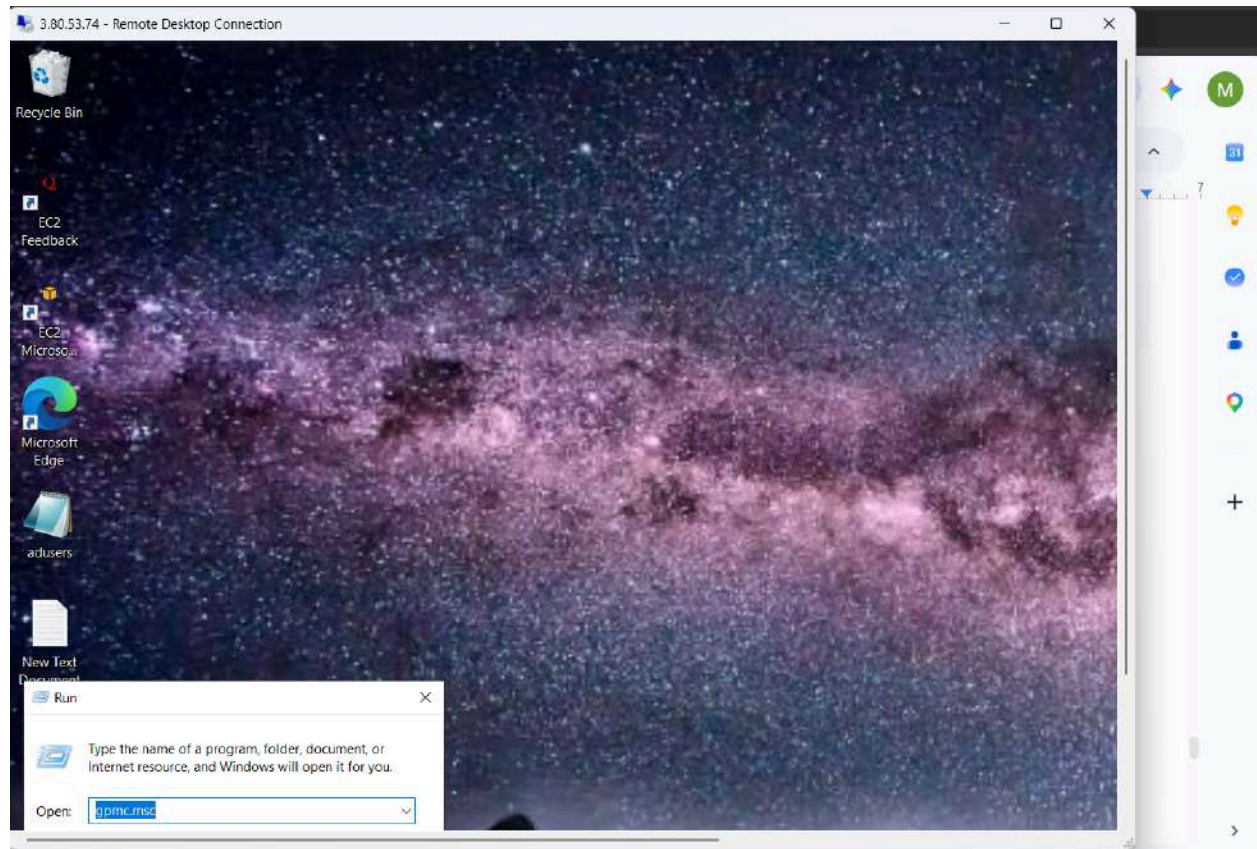
I have received your request and am currently configuring the Group Policy Object to restrict Control Panel access for standard users while keeping full access open for Domain Admins.

[preview](#) [syntax help](#)

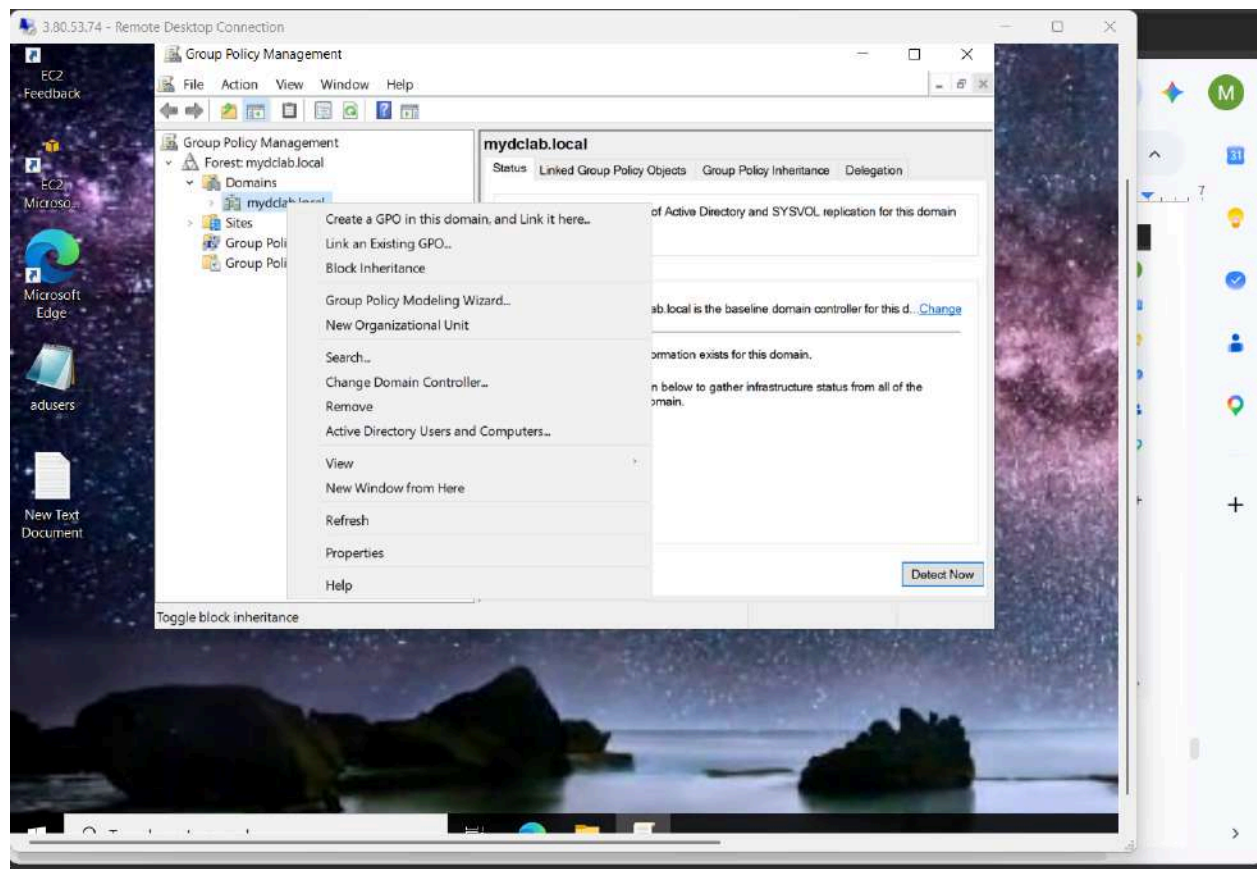
[In progress](#) [Cancel](#)

Manual Method

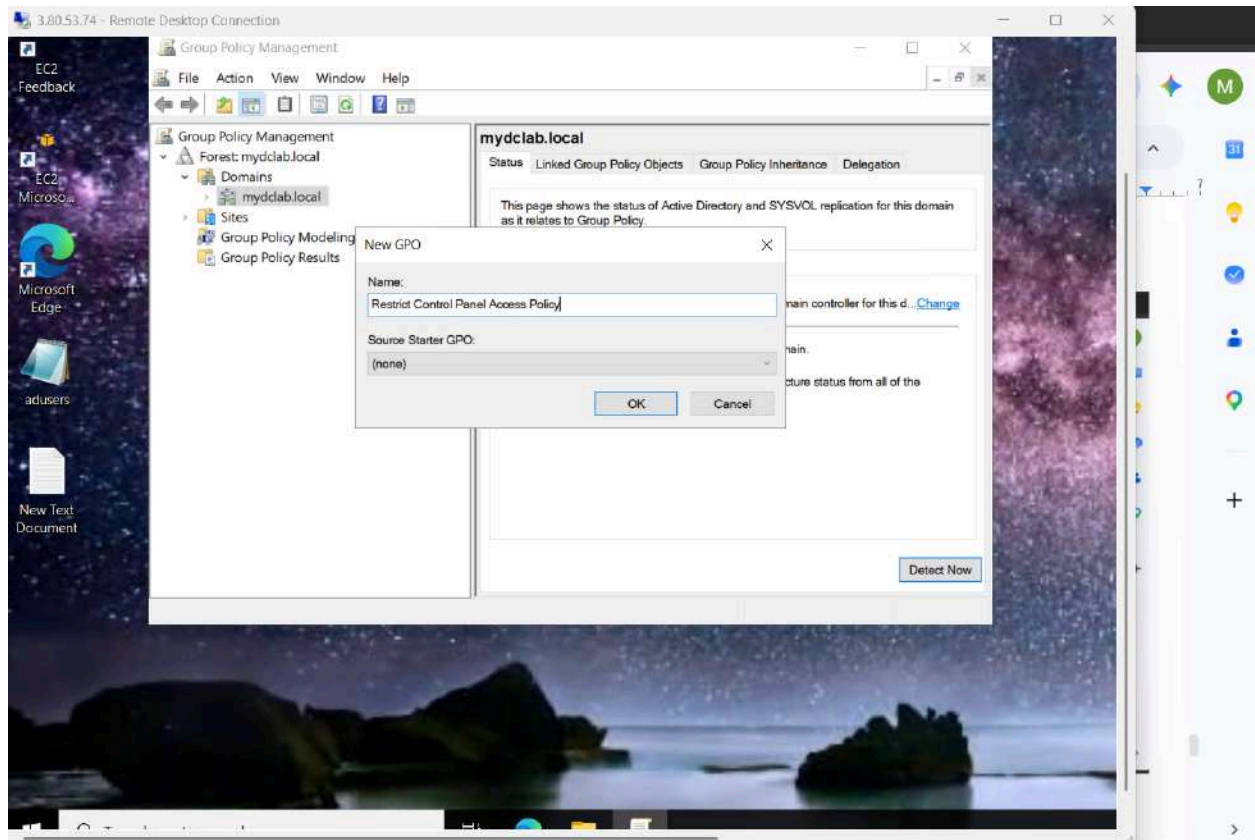
First I run gpmmc.msc.



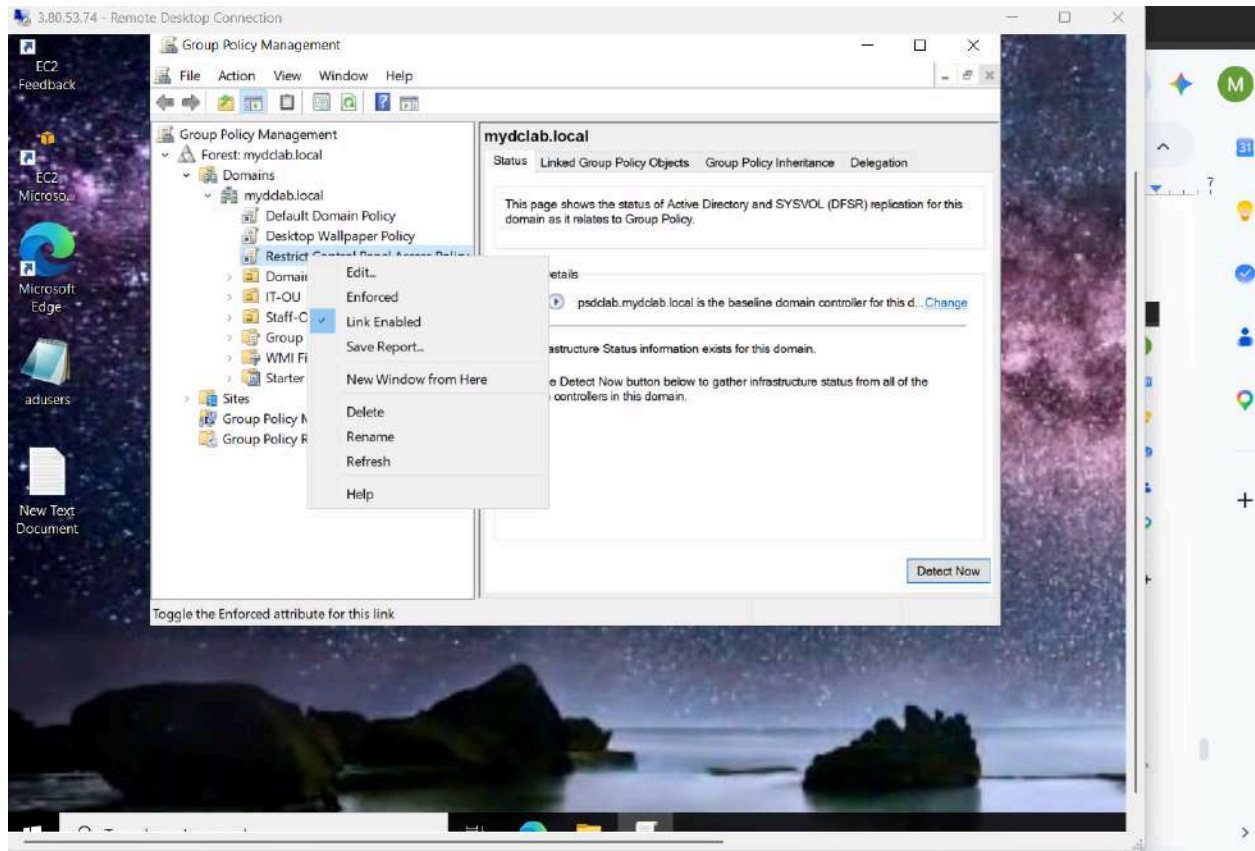
Then I right click my domain name in the left pane and select **Create a GPO in this domain,** and **Link it here.**



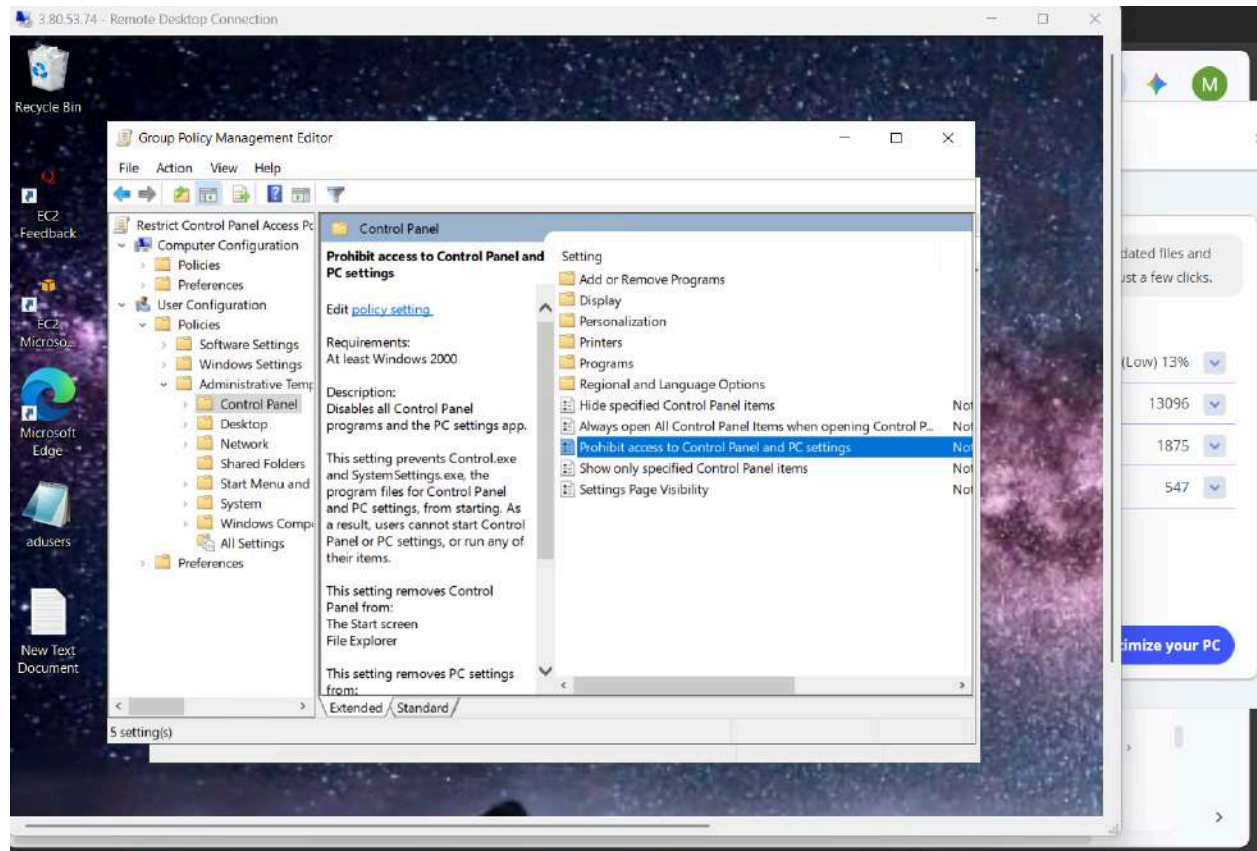
I name the group policy object "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy".



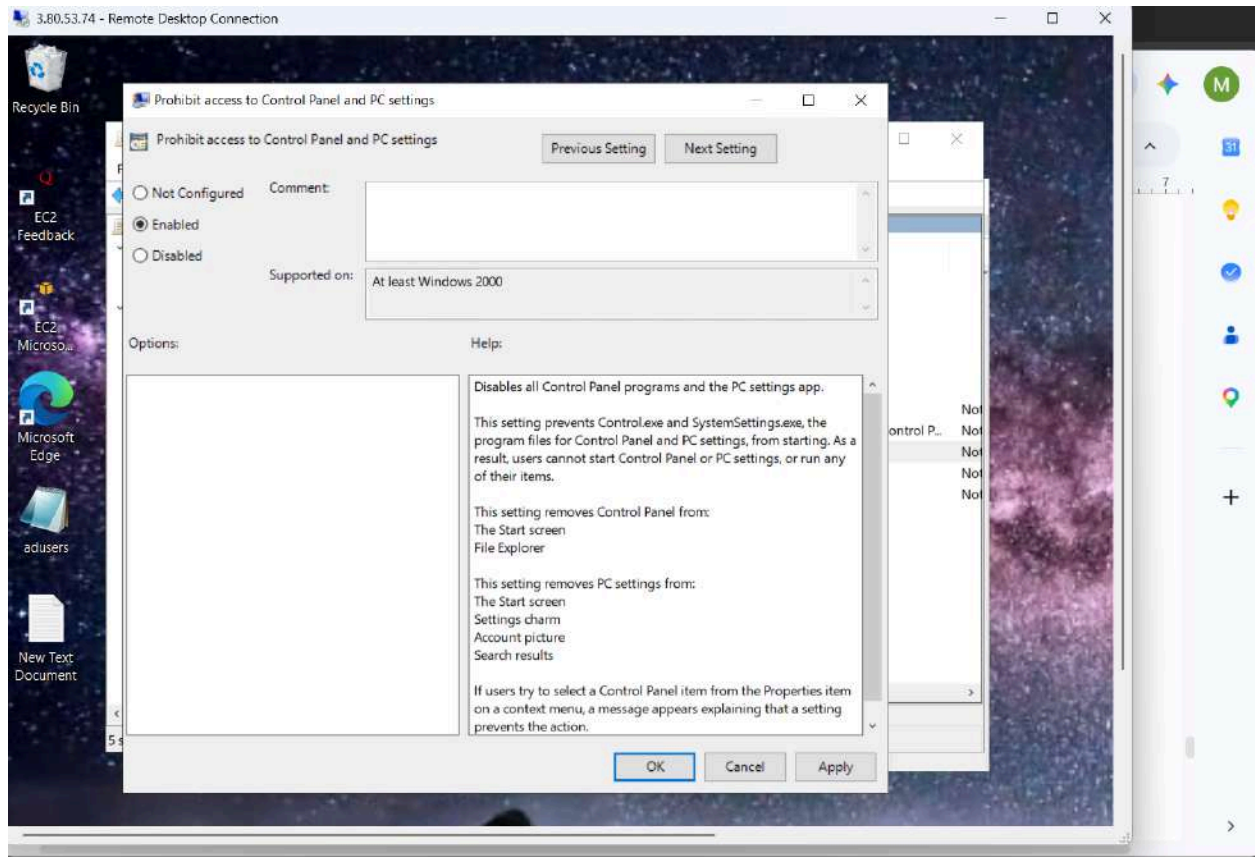
And then, in the left pane I expand the tree under my domain name and right click the newly created gpo name and select **Edit**.



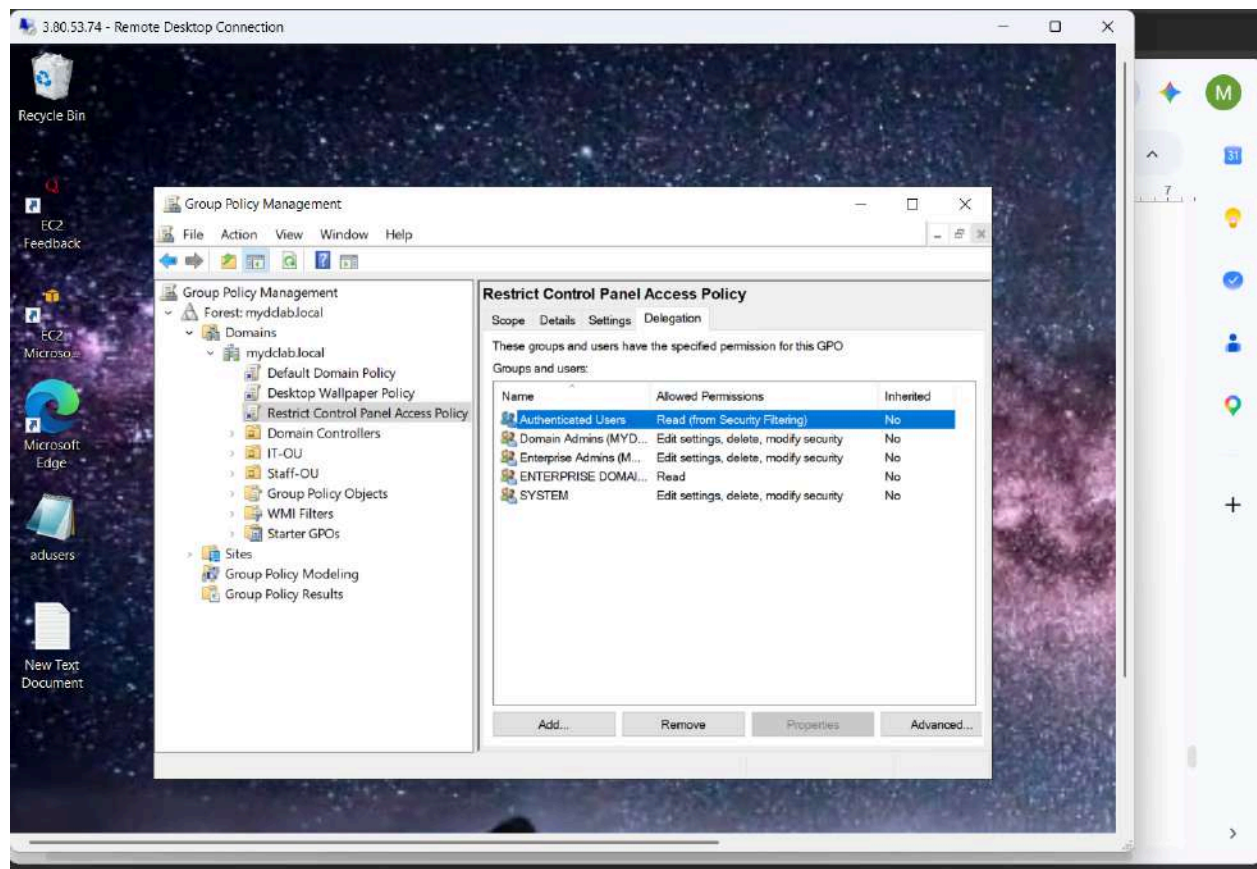
In the Group Policy Management Editor, in the left pane, I go to **User Configuration > Policies > Administrative Templates > Control Panel >** and then in the right pane I double click **Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings**.



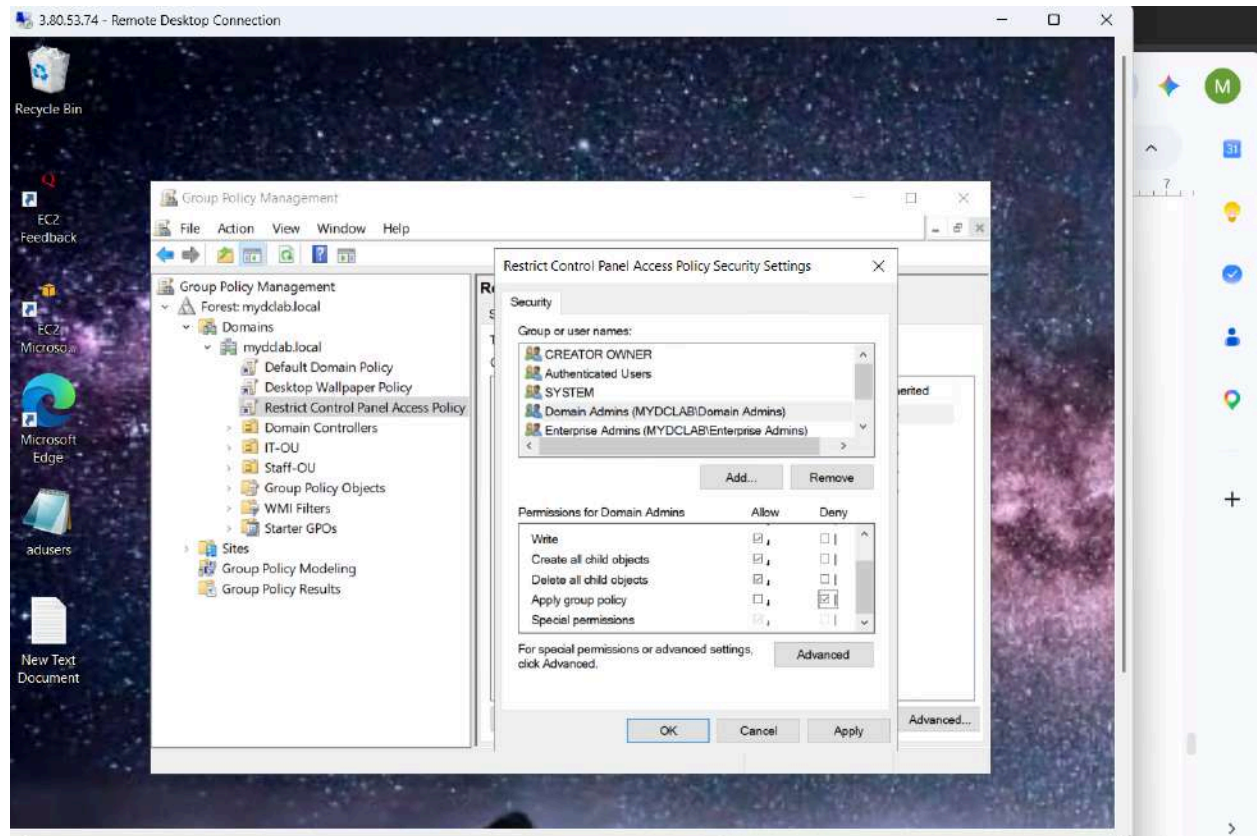
I select **Enabled** then hit **Apply** and **OK**.



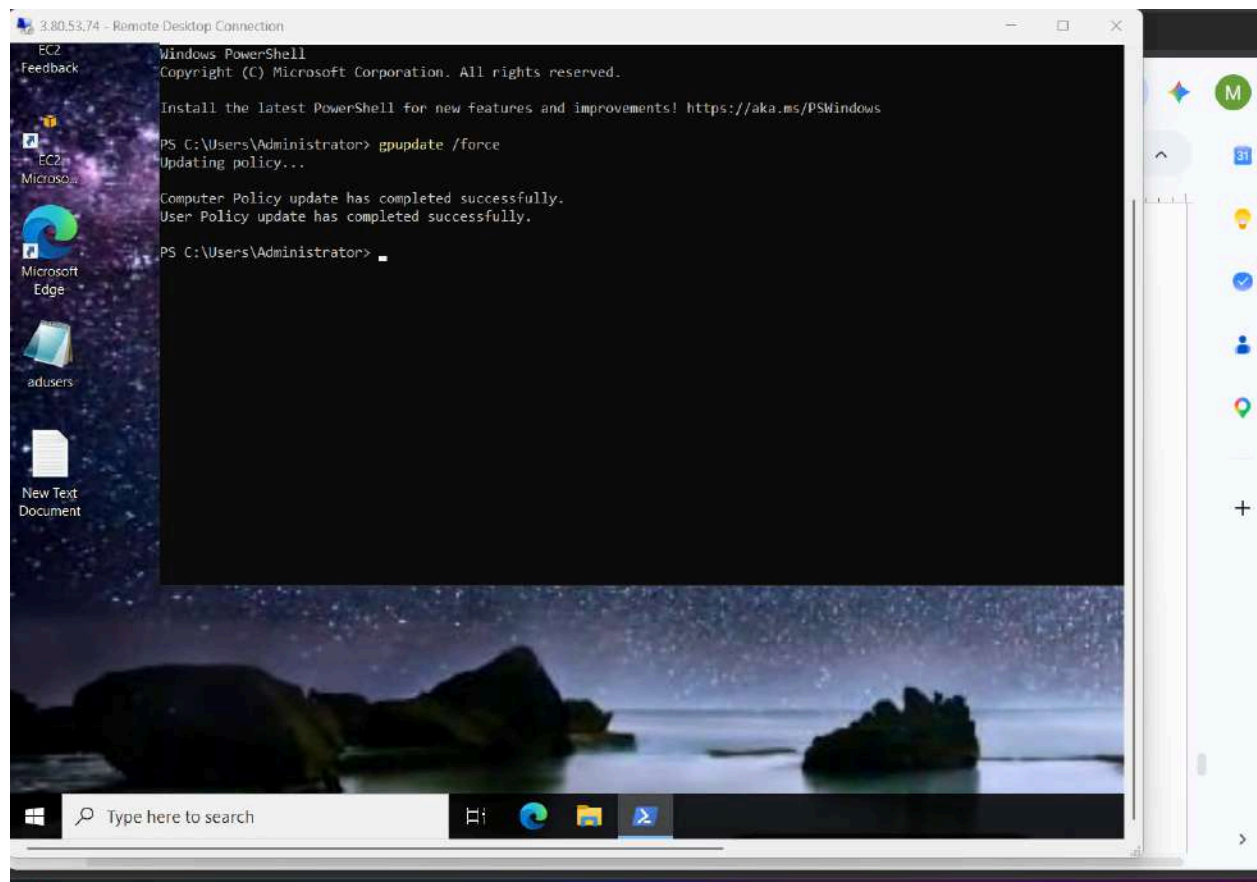
Now that the policy is created and enabled, the next thing I do is make sure that this policy doesn't affect admin accounts. I go back to the Group Policy Management window, select the gpo name and then I select **Delegation** in the right pane and then **Advanced** in the bottom right.



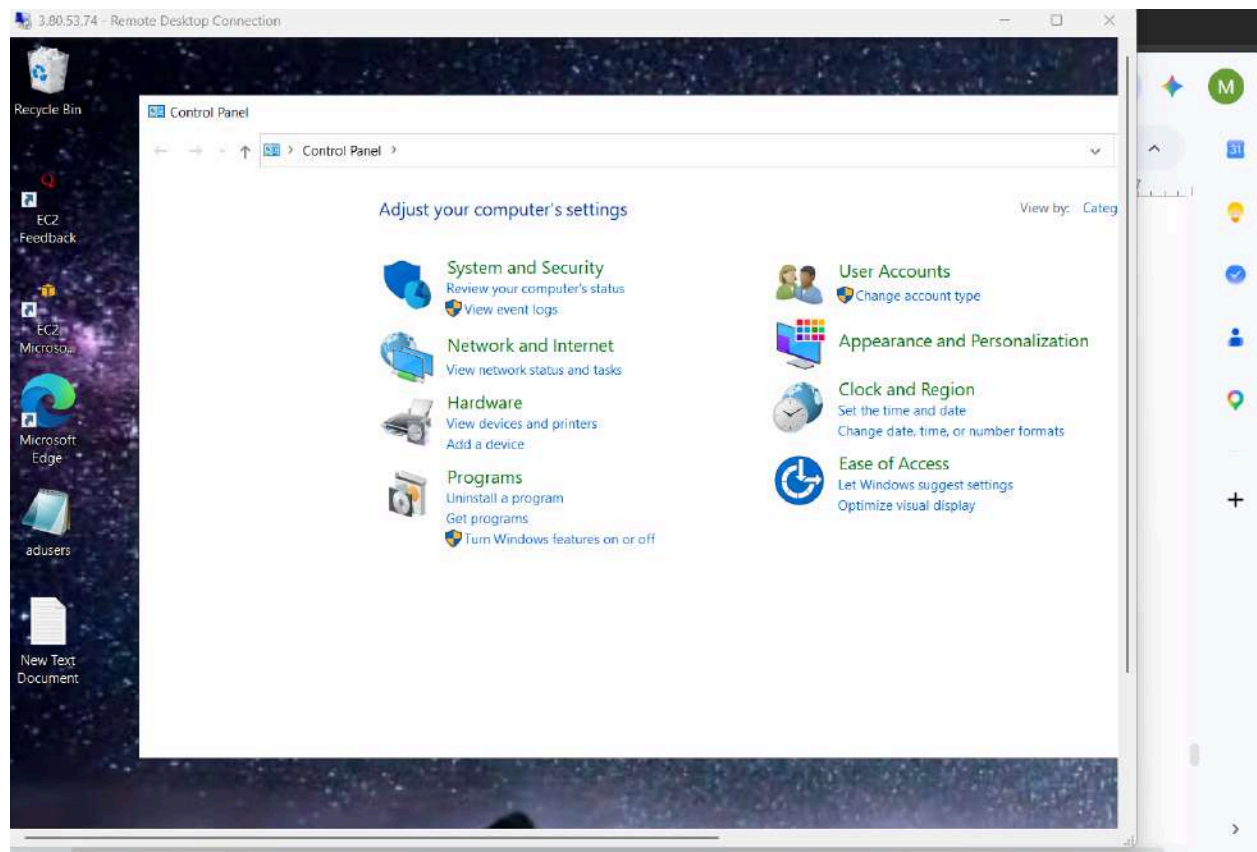
I select **Domain Admins** in the Group or user names box and then in the Permissions for Domain Admins box I check the **Deny options** for **Apply Group Policy**, I then select **Apply** and **OK**.



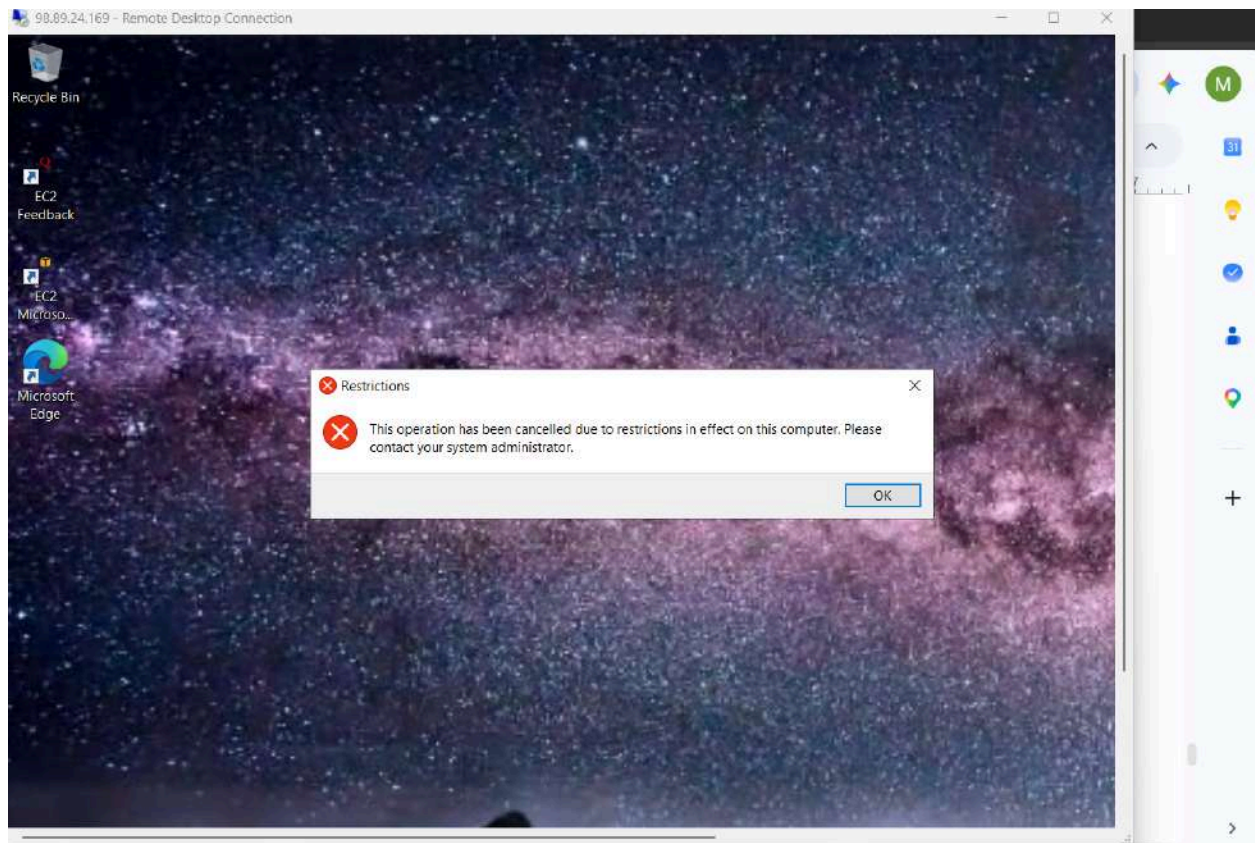
Run `gpupdate /force` for all instances to actually make sure that every machine within the domain actually gets the update.



As you can see the admin can still access the control panel.



But standard users in the client machine cannot.



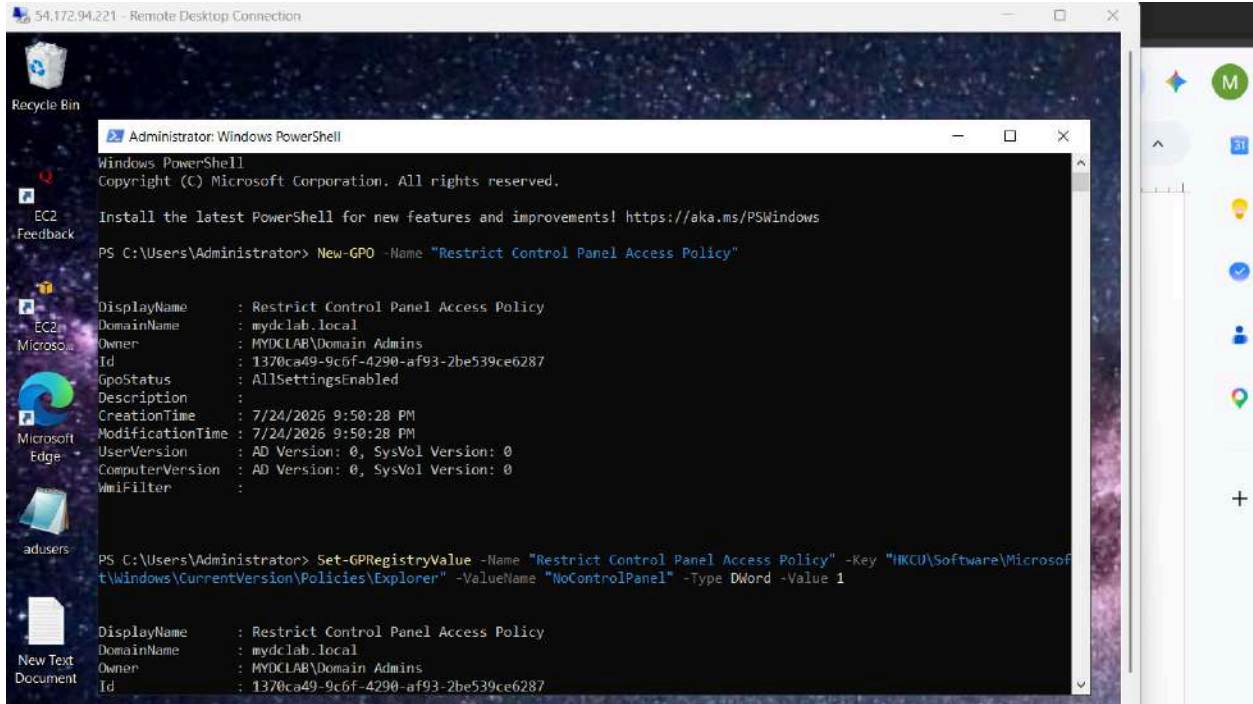
PowerShell Method

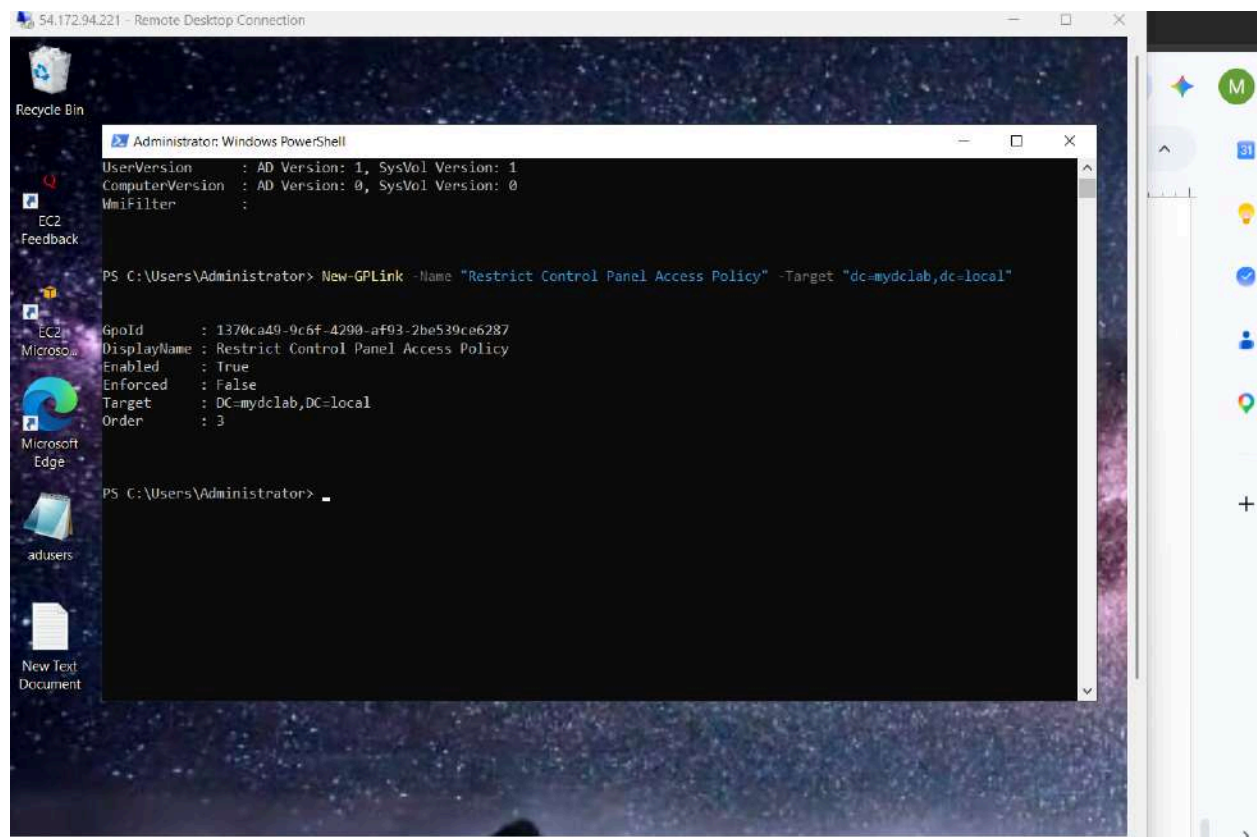
The first thing I do is run a powershell script that creates a new Group Policy Object called "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy", configure Registry Policy to Disable Control Panel & PC Settings, and then apply it to the whole domain by linking the policy.

New-GPO -Name "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy"

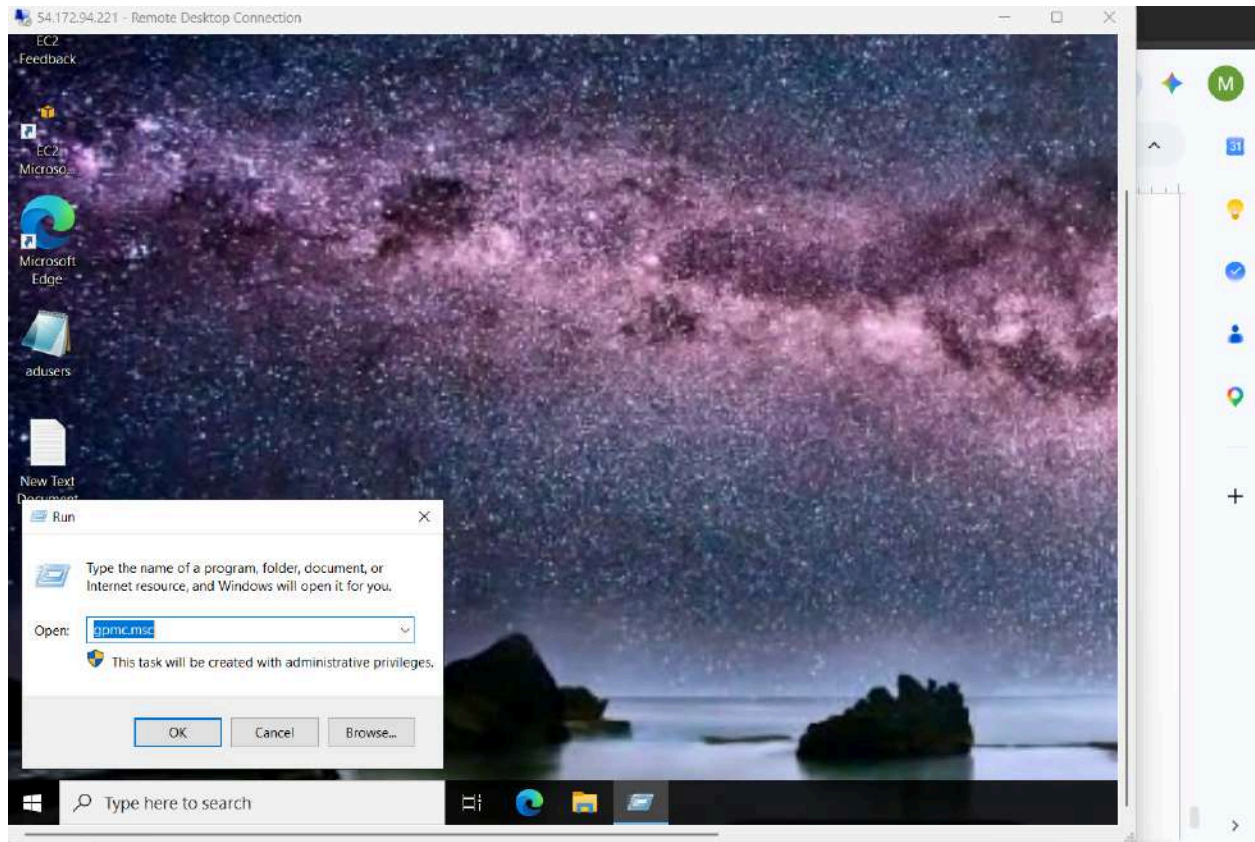
Set-GPRegistryValue -Name "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy" -Key "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer" -ValueName "NoControlPanel" -Type DWord -Value 1

New-GPLink -Name "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy" -Target "dc=mydclab,dc=local"

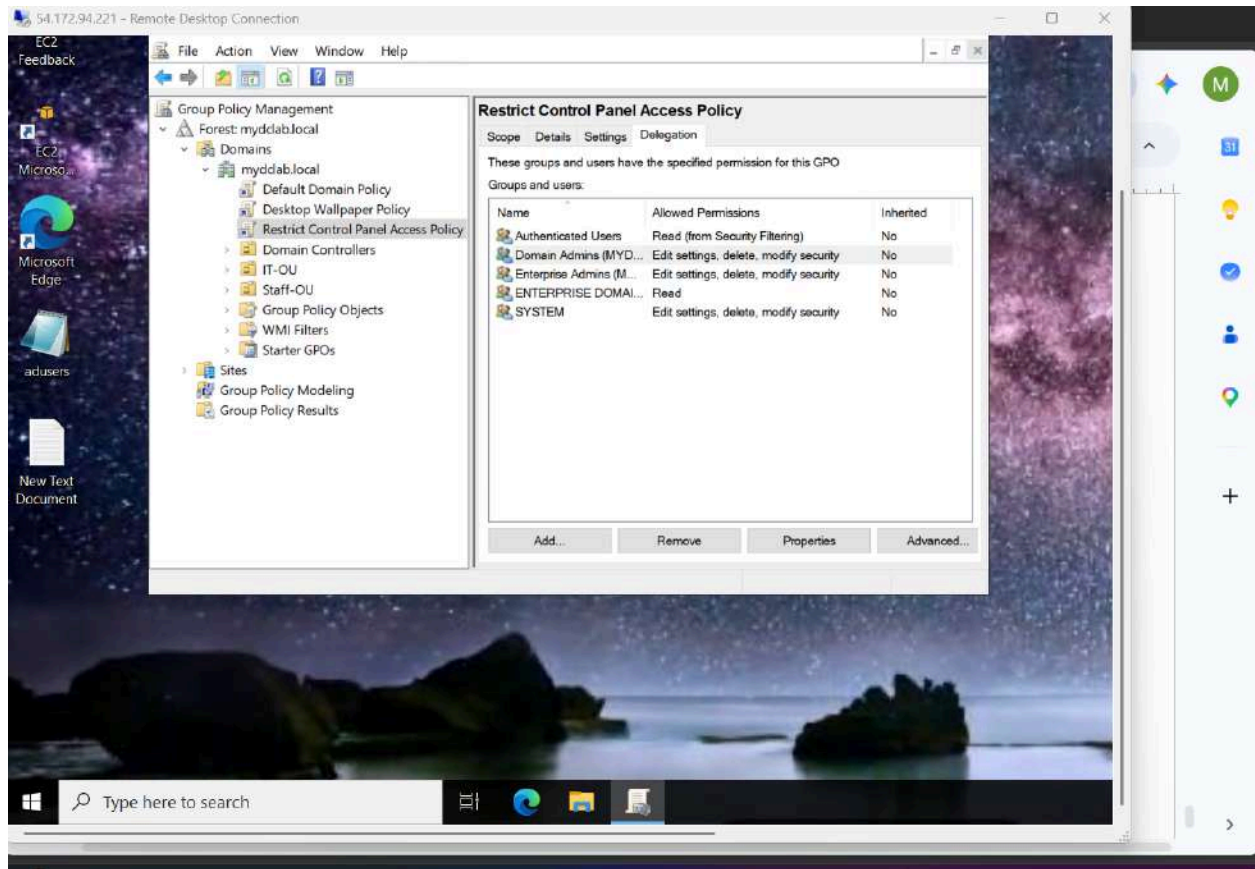




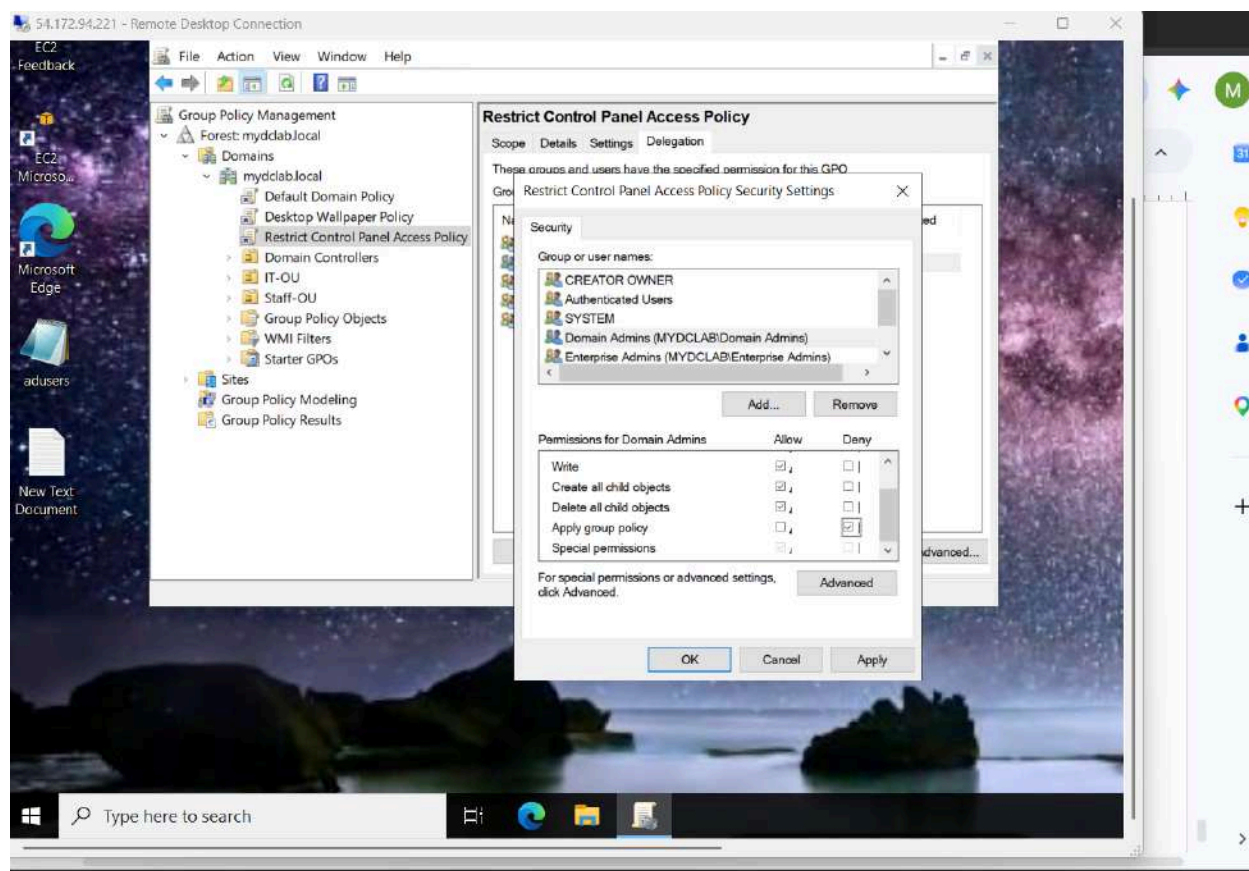
Now to make sure that the policy doesn't affect Domain admin accounts, I run gpmmc.msc.



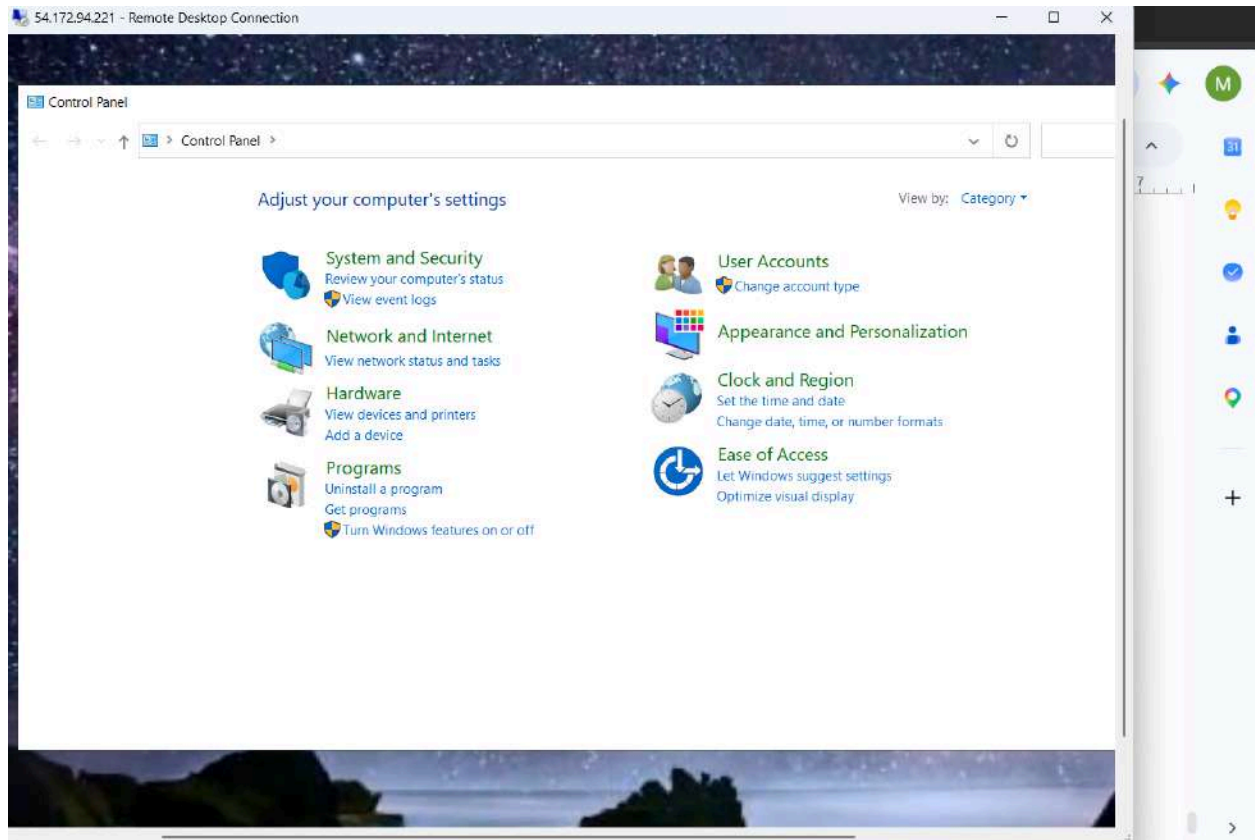
I click the name of the new policy I created and then select **Delegation** on the right hand side.



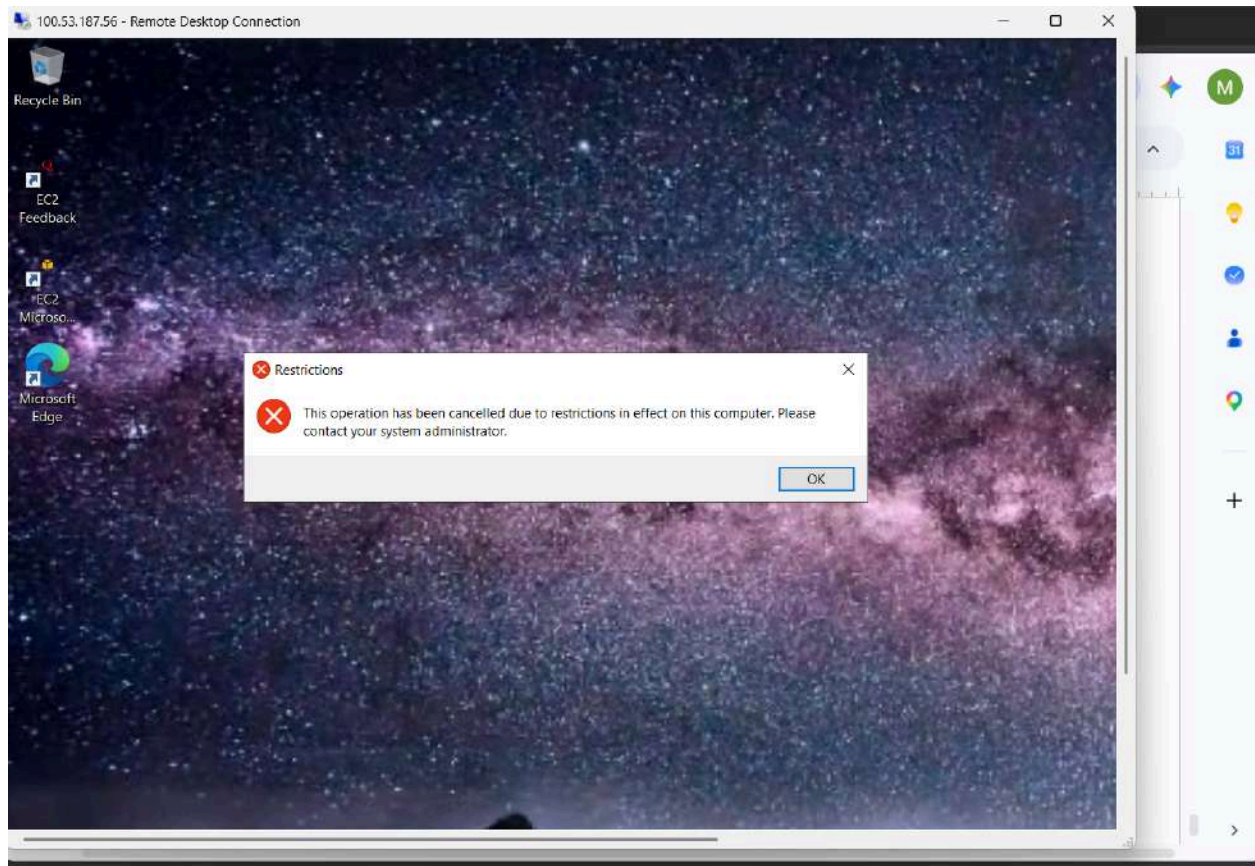
I select **Advanced** in the bottom right and in the Group or user names panel I select Domain Admins, then in the Permissions for Domain Admins panel I select **Deny** for **Apply Group Policy** and then hit **Apply** then **OK**.



As you can see, as an Admin account I am able to access the control panel.



But as soon as I sign into the client machine using Bob Ross's account and I try to access the control panel I get a deny message.



Ticket Resolution Summaries Powershell and Manual(GUI) Methods:

Manual (GUI) Method Resolution Summary

Issue / Request: Configure Group Policy to restrict access to the Control Panel and PC Settings across all domain-joined client machines while preserving administrative access for domain administrators.

Resolution Steps Taken:

1. **GPO Creation & Scope:** Opened `gpmc.msc` on the Domain Controller (`mydclab.local`) and created a new Group Policy Object named **Restrict Control Panel Access Policy**. Linked the GPO directly to the domain root.
2. **Policy Configuration:** Navigated to User Configuration > Policies > Administrative Templates > Control Panel and set **Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings** to **Enabled**.

3. **Admin Exemption:** Modified policy security settings under **Delegation > Advanced**. Selected the **Domain Admins** group and set a **Deny** permission on the **Apply group policy** right to prevent administrators from being restricted.
4. **Policy Enforcement:** Executed `gpupdate /force` in PowerShell to force immediate replication and application of group policies across the domain.
5. **Verification & Testing:**
 - **Admin Session:** Logged into the Domain Controller with a Domain Admin account and verified full access to the Control Panel.
 - **Standard User Session:** Logged into domain-joined workstation `psdclab-client1` as standard user Bob Ross. Attempted to open Control Panel and confirmed access was blocked with the restriction message: *"This operation has been cancelled due to restrictions in effect on this computer."*

Status: Resolved / Closed

PowerShell Method Resolution Summary

Issue / Request: Automate the deployment and configuration of a domain-wide Group Policy Object to prohibit Control Panel access for non-admin users using Active Directory PowerShell cmdlets.

Resolution Steps Taken:

1. **GPO Creation & Registry Provisioning:** Executed PowerShell commands on the Domain Controller to build and enforce the policy at the domain level:
2. PowerShell

Create the GPO

```
New-GPO -Name "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy"
```

Configure the registry setting (Disable Control Panel & PC Settings)

```
Set-GPRegistryValue -Name "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy" -Key  
"HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer" -ValueName  
"NoControlPanel" -Type DWord -Value 1
```

Link GPO to domain root

```
New-GPLink -Name "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy" -Target "dc=mydclab,dc=local"
```

- 3.
- 4.
5. **Admin Exemption Configuration:** Configured security filtering to explicitly exempt administrative accounts from policy enforcement:
6. PowerShell

Set-GPPPermission -Name "Restrict Control Panel Access Policy" -TargetName "Domain Admins" -TargetType Group -PermissionLevel GpoApply -Deny

- 7.
- 8.
9. **Verification & Testing:**
 - **Admin Verification:** Confirmed Domain Admin users retain unrestricted access to system management tools and Control Panel.
 - **Client Verification:** Logged onto psdclab-client1 under standard user Bob Ross. Attempted Control Panel access and verified restriction prompt was successfully triggered.

Status: Resolved / Closed